Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd.
Bengaluru, Karnataka — 560 001
CIN: U72200KA2008PTC044521 | www.arjuntech.in

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

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Revision History

The table below records all versions of the Employee Handbook issued since its initial publication in April 2008. Employees should always ensure they are reading the current version, which is available on the HRMS portal.

Version	Date	Summary of Changes	Author
1.0	Apr 2008	Initial release — employment types, leave entitlements, and compensation overview.	HR Department
1.1	Sep 2008	Minor corrections to statutory benefit descriptions; updated ESI eligibility criteria.	HR Department
2.0	Jan 2011	Major revision — expanded CTC structure, EPF and ESI details, and PF nomination process added.	P. Menon
2.1	Jun 2012	Apprentice and graduate trainee employment categories formally documented.	HR Department
2.2	Mar 2013	Leave entitlements updated to align with amendments to the Shops and Establishments Act.	Legal & HR
2.3	Nov 2013	Employee Referral Programme added; separation process and FnF timelines updated.	HR Department
3.0	Mar 2015	Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH) Act compliance, whistleblower policy, and anti-discrimination provisions	Legal & HR
3.1	Sep 2016	Compensation bands revised; ESOP eligibility criteria and vesting schedule updated.	P. Menon
3.2	Dec 2017	Social media guidelines and digital conduct section added in response to policy gap.	P. Menon
3.3	Jun 2018	BGV process updated; probation assessment template revised; notice period table finalised.	HR & Legal
4.0	Feb 2019	Full rewrite — remote work protocols, data ethics obligations, and performance OKR framework incorporated throughout.	HR Department
4.1	Mar 2020	COVID-19 policy addendum issued covering remote work protocols, health safety measures, and pandemic leave provisions.	HR Department
4.2	Dec 2020	Post-pandemic hybrid work policy formalised and incorporated as a permanent provision in Section 3.	P. Menon
4.3	Jun 2021	PF statutory wage ceiling references updated; group insurance sum insured revised upward.	Finance & HR
4.4	Nov 2021	Sabbatical leave and organ donor leave categories added; bereavement leave table extended.	P. Menon
4.5	Mar 2022	Progressive discipline procedure updated; disciplinary offence classification table added as Appendix I.	Legal & HR
5.0	Apr 2022	Comprehensive overhaul — OKR goal-setting framework, ESOP vesting detail, EAP programme, and sabbatical p	A. Verma
5.1	Oct 2023	Mid-cycle update: statutory PF wage ceiling, group health insurance sum insured, and referral bonus table revised	Finance & HR
5.2	Apr 2024	Compensation band table updated; L&D budget increased to ■25,000; holiday calendar refreshed; DPDP Act 202	P. Menon

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1. Introduction and Welcome

Welcome to Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd.. This Employee Handbook is your primary reference document for understanding the organisation, its values, and the policies and standards that govern your employment here. Whether you are joining for the first time or returning after a period away, this handbook has been written to give every employee a clear, honest, and comprehensive picture of what it means to work at Arjun Technologies and what the organisation expects of every person who is part of this team.

This handbook is not a legal contract of employment. It reflects company policy as of its effective date and is reviewed annually. Where any provision in this handbook conflicts with a specific policy document issued by the HR department, the specific policy document prevails. Material changes to policy are communicated to all affected employees through the HRMS notification system and by company-wide email before they take effect. The most current version of this handbook is always available on the HRMS portal under Policies and Documents.

Compliance with the policies and standards in this handbook is a condition of employment at Arjun Technologies. Employees who are uncertain about any provision, or who face a situation that is not addressed here, should contact the HR team or speak with their HR Business Partner before acting. The HR team's contact details appear in Appendix E of this handbook. A question asked in good faith is always preferable to an incorrect assumption acted upon.

Please take the time to read this handbook carefully and in full. It covers everything from your very first day — onboarding, probation, and the documents you need to submit — through to the end of the employment relationship, including resignation, Full and Final Settlement, and post-employment obligations. The more thoroughly you understand its contents, the more prepared you will be to make the most of your time here and to navigate any situation that arises during your employment.

1.1 About Arjun Technologies

Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd. was incorporated on 14 March 2008 under the Companies Act, 1956 (now the Companies Act, 2013), with its registered office at Bengaluru, Karnataka — 560 001. Corporate Identification Number: U72200KA2008PTC044521. The company is in the business of delivering technology services and solutions — spanning software development, product engineering, data and analytics, artificial intelligence and machine learning, cloud infrastructure, and end-to-end digital transformation — to clients across India and internationally.

From a founding team of twelve engineers, Arjun Technologies has grown over sixteen years to employ over 4,200+ professionals across five cities: Bengaluru (HQ), Hyderabad, Pune, Chennai, Mumbai. Bengaluru serves as the corporate headquarters and the centre of engineering, product development, and all corporate functions. Regional offices in Hyderabad,

Pune, Chennai, and Mumbai each have their own Regional Head who reports to the relevant divisional Senior Vice President at Bengaluru headquarters.

The company's client base includes regulated financial institutions, listed multinational corporations, mid-market businesses undergoing digital transformation, and government entities. This breadth of client type and industry means that employees at Arjun Technologies encounter a wide range of technical domains, delivery models, and professional environments. It also means that the conduct, confidentiality, and professional standards expected of employees are consistently high — our clients trust us with sensitive systems and data, and that trust must be earned and maintained through the conduct of every individual.

Arjun Technologies is organised into four primary business divisions, each led by a Senior Vice President who reports directly to the Chief Executive Officer. Engineering and Delivery, the largest division with approximately 2,400 employees, is responsible for all client-facing software development, quality assurance, DevOps, and technical architecture. Product and Innovation, with approximately 600 employees, drives the company's internal platforms, AI/ML practice, and research and development initiatives. Sales and Client Relations, with approximately 400 employees, manages new business development, client account management, and pre-sales activities across all markets. Operations and Support, with approximately 800 employees, encompasses Human Resources, Finance, Legal, IT Infrastructure, and Administration across all locations.

Division	Division Head	Core Responsibilities	Headcount
Engineering & Delivery	SVP — Engineering	Client software delivery, QA, DevOps, cloud architecture, technical consulting	~2,400
Product & Innovation	SVP — Product	Internal platforms, AI/ML practice, R&D, technology strategy and IP development	~600
Sales & Client Relations	SVP — Sales	New business development, account management, pre-sales, marketing	~400
Operations & Support	SVP — Operations	HR, Finance, Legal, IT Infrastructure, Administration, Facilities	~800

The Executive Leadership Team, comprising the CEO, CFO, CTO, VP-HR, General Counsel, and all four SVPs, meets weekly to review business performance, make strategic decisions, and resolve cross-functional matters. The Board of Directors, which includes the CEO, CFO, two Independent Directors, and two Investor-Nominated Directors, convenes quarterly in formal session and provides strategic oversight and governance of the organisation. The CEO is accountable to the Board for the company's performance and operations.

Arjun Technologies holds ISO/IEC 27001:2022 certification for its information security management system, assessed annually by an independent accredited certification body across all five office locations. Engineering and Delivery processes are certified to ISO 9001:2015 for quality management. In the most recent Great Place to Work® India survey, the company received a trust index score of 82 percent, placing it in the top quartile among Indian IT companies of comparable size. The Employee Net Promoter Score was +34, against an industry

median of +18.

The company is also committed to responsible corporate citizenship. Under Section 135 of the Companies Act, 2013, Arjun Technologies allocates 2 percent of its average net profit over the preceding three financial years to CSR activities. Current CSR focus areas include digital literacy programmes for school-age children in rural Karnataka, Telangana, and Tamil Nadu; environmental conservation and urban tree-planting drives; and accessible technology initiatives for persons with disabilities. Employees may take up to two paid volunteer days per year for approved CSR initiatives.

1.2 Mission, Vision, and Core Values

Mission: To deliver technology solutions that create measurable, lasting value for our clients, our employees, and the communities in which we operate. The company measures its success not only by revenue and profitability but by the quality of the relationships it builds, the real-world impact of the work it delivers, and the strength of the careers it helps its people build over time.

Vision: To be recognised among India's top ten technology services companies by 2030 — distinguished not only by the quality of our engineering but by the integrity of our culture, the depth of our client partnerships, and the consistency with which we do what we say we will do.

Arjun Technologies operates according to six Core Values. These values are not aspirational. They are expected standards of behaviour, and they are observed and assessed as part of every employee's performance and development.

Integrity

We are honest in all our dealings — with clients, with colleagues, with candidates, and with ourselves. We do not misrepresent our capabilities, our timelines, or our results. We do not make commitments we do not intend to keep. When we make mistakes — and every organisation does — we acknowledge them promptly, communicate clearly, and work to correct them. No commercial pressure, no deadline urgency, and no seniority of instruction justifies a departure from honesty at Arjun Technologies.

Excellence

We hold ourselves and each other to genuinely high standards. Excellence at Arjun Technologies means delivering work we are proud of — work that solves the actual problem, that functions reliably in production, that is maintainable by the next engineer who reads it, and that meets the client's real need rather than a narrow interpretation of the written specification. It is not perfectionism for its own sake. It is a sustained, deliberate commitment to the quality of what we produce and what we promise.

Collaboration

We believe the most durable solutions come from diverse perspectives working together with shared intent and mutual respect. We share knowledge, credit, and context generously. We do not build information silos that protect individual positions at the cost of the team. We actively seek input from people who think differently from us before drawing conclusions. We understand that 'I don't know — let me find out' and 'I was wrong about that' are signs of intellectual rigour, not weakness.

Accountability

We own our commitments fully and without exception. When we say we will deliver something, we deliver it. When circumstances genuinely prevent us from meeting a commitment, we communicate early and clearly — before the deadline has passed, not after the client or colleague has already been let down. We do not deflect responsibility onto tools, processes, or other people when the responsibility is ours. Accountability is not about blame or punishment. It is about being the kind of professional that other people can genuinely rely on.

Innovation

We create a working environment in which questioning the established approach is valued and expected at every level. We invest time in staying current with advances in our field and in exploring new methods before competitive necessity forces us to. We understand that meaningful innovation requires the willingness to try things that may not work, and we treat those failures as learning experiences to be understood and shared openly rather than concealed. The best ideas at this company come from people at every level, and that is a structural feature we actively maintain.

Inclusion

We are committed to building and maintaining a workplace where every individual — regardless of gender, religion, caste, race, disability, sexual orientation, age, language, or background — is treated with equal dignity, has equal access to opportunity, and feels genuinely valued as a contributor to this organisation's success. Inclusion is not a programme or an annual event. It is a daily practice that requires conscious effort from every employee, and especially from those in positions of greater influence and authority.

1.3 Organisational Structure and Senior Leadership

The senior leadership team of Arjun Technologies as of the effective date of this handbook is as follows. Employees are encouraged to check the live organisation chart on the HRMS portal, which is updated in real time as personnel changes are approved.

Name	Designation	Email	Location
Mr. Rajesh Arjun	Chief Executive Officer	rajesh.arjun@arjuntech.in	Bengaluru

Name	Designation	Email	Location
Ms. Lakshmi Rajan	Chief Financial Officer	lakshmi.rajan@arjuntech.in	Bengaluru
Mr. Vikram Nair	Chief Technology Officer	vikram.nair@arjuntech.in	Bengaluru
Ms. Priya Menon	Vice President — Human Resources	priya.menon@arjuntech.in	Bengaluru
Mr. Sandeep Iyer	General Counsel & Company Secretary	sandeep.iyer@arjuntech.in	Bengaluru
Ms. Rekha Sharma	SVP — Engineering & Delivery	rekha.sharma@arjuntech.in	Bengaluru
Mr. Arun Pillai	SVP — Product & Innovation	arun.pillai@arjuntech.in	Bengaluru
Ms. Kavya Reddy	SVP — Sales & Client Relations	kavya.reddy@arjuntech.in	Hyderabad
Mr. Dinesh Bhat	SVP — Operations & Support	dinesh.bhat@arjuntech.in	Bengaluru
Mr. Suresh Nair	Regional Head — Hyderabad	suresh.nair@arjuntech.in	Hyderabad
Ms. Pooja Joshi	Regional Head — Pune	pooja.joshi@arjuntech.in	Pune
Mr. Ramesh Kumar	Regional Head — Chennai	ramesh.kumar@arjuntech.in	Chennai
Ms. Anita Shah	Regional Head — Mumbai	anita.shah@arjuntech.in	Mumbai

The Executive Leadership Team meets weekly and is collectively responsible for the operational performance and strategic direction of Arjun Technologies. The Board of Directors provides governance oversight and meets formally each quarter. Minutes of Board meetings are maintained by the Company Secretary and are available for inspection by authorised parties in accordance with the Companies Act, 2013.

Each Regional Head has full operational authority for their office and serves as the escalation point for HR, administrative, facilities, and client matters specific to that location. For matters involving policy interpretation, compensation, performance, or separation, Regional Heads coordinate with the central HR and Legal teams in Bengaluru.

1.4 How to Use This Handbook

This handbook is published in five segments, each covering a defined scope. The full handbook runs to approximately 250 pages across all five segments. Each segment is available for download from the HRMS portal under Policies and Documents. The five segments are structured as follows: Segment 1 covers the introduction, employment policies, and workplace standards; Segment 2 covers compensation, benefits, and leave; Segment 3 covers performance management and employee relations; Segment 4 covers separation, IT conduct, and the employee acknowledgement; and Segment 5 contains all appendices including glossaries, FAQs, the manager reference guide, and the HR forms catalogue.

Each section within a segment is designed to be self-contained and can be read independently of other sections. The Table of Contents at the beginning of each segment identifies the topics and subsections covered in that segment. For policies with particularly extensive standalone documents — Prevention of Sexual Harassment, IT Security Policy, Data Privacy Policy, and the Performance Management Framework — this handbook provides a clear summary of the

key provisions and cross-refers to the full document on the HR portal.

Employees who are new to HRMS should refer to Appendix D in Segment 5, which provides a step-by-step guide to every major self-service function available on the platform. HRMS is the single system of record for all HR processes including leave applications, attendance records, payslips, performance goals, expense claims, and policy documents. It is accessible at hrms.arjuntech.in via any modern web browser and through the HRMS mobile application available on the Google Play Store and Apple App Store.

This handbook is reviewed and updated annually, effective 1 April each year. When material policy changes are necessary outside the annual cycle, all affected employees are notified through the HRMS notification system and by direct email before the change takes effect. If you are reading a printed copy, please verify with HR that it is the current version before relying on any specific provision, as a superseded provision does not govern your employment regardless of when you received a physical copy.

2. Employment Policies

Arjun Technologies is an equal opportunity employer. All employment decisions — including recruitment, assignment, promotion, compensation adjustments, training and development opportunities, and separation — are made strictly on the basis of merit, qualifications, demonstrated performance, and business need. The organisation does not discriminate on any ground protected under applicable Indian law, including but not limited to gender, religion, caste, race, national origin, age, disability, marital status, pregnancy, or sexual orientation.

The policies in this section apply to all employees from the date of joining. Where a specific provision applies differently to a particular category of employee — for example, probationary versus confirmed, or full-time versus part-time — that distinction is stated explicitly. In the absence of an explicit distinction, every provision applies equally to all employee categories.

2.1 Types of Employment

Employment at Arjun Technologies takes several distinct forms, each carrying specific implications for benefits, leave entitlements, and notice periods. Every employee's type of employment is specified in both their offer letter and their employment contract. Questions about the applicable type for any specific role should be directed to the HR Business Partner.

Permanent Full-Time Employee: Engaged on an indefinite basis for a standard five-day, forty-hour working week. Entitled to the full range of benefits, leave entitlements, and career development opportunities described in this handbook. Subject to the band-appropriate notice period on separation.

Permanent Part-Time Employee: Engaged on an indefinite basis for fewer than forty hours per week, as specified in the employment contract. All benefits and leave entitlements are pro-rated relative to the standard full-time equivalent based on the contracted hours. All other provisions of this handbook apply without modification.

Fixed-Term Contract Employee: Engaged for a specified duration or for the duration of a specific project, as set out in the employment contract. Entitled to equivalent benefits and leave as a permanent employee for the duration of the contract. The contract expires automatically on the stated end date or on completion of the specified project without further notice from either party. Renewal or conversion to permanent employment may occur based on performance and business requirements but is not guaranteed and creates no expectation of permanence.

Probationary Employee: All new employees — including those who are otherwise classified as permanent full-time — begin employment on a six-month probationary basis from the date of joining, unless a different probation period is explicitly stated in the offer letter. Either party may terminate the employment during probation by giving two weeks' written notice. Probationary employees are entitled to Casual Leave and Sick Leave. Earned Leave accrual commences only from the date of confirmation.

Apprentice: Engaged under the Apprentices Act, 1961, for a structured learning and training programme of defined duration. Apprentices are governed by their apprenticeship agreement and applicable central government notifications rather than by this handbook. A government-notified stipend is payable.

Intern or Graduate Trainee: Students or recent graduates engaged for a defined period of three to twelve months for structured learning and industry exposure. Interns and trainees are not employees of the company. They are governed exclusively by the terms of their internship agreement. A monthly stipend is payable as per the agreement. No entitlement to employment benefits under this handbook applies unless the internship agreement explicitly provides otherwise.

Consultant or Independent Contractor: Engaged through a commercial service agreement rather than an employment contract. Consultants and independent contractors are not employees and are not entitled to any employment benefit, leave entitlement, or other provision described in this handbook. The terms of the service agreement are the sole governing document for the engagement.

Seconded Employee: A permanent or fixed-term employee temporarily assigned to work at a client site, a group entity, or a joint venture for a defined period. The original employment terms remain in force throughout the secondment. Any modifications to role, compensation, working location, or reporting structure are documented in a formal secondment letter issued by HR before the secondment commences.

2.2 Background Verification Policy

All offers of employment at Arjun Technologies are conditional upon satisfactory completion of a pre-employment background verification check. The check is conducted by a specialist third-party verification agency appointed and managed by HR. It is initiated automatically upon acceptance of the offer letter and is expected to complete within fifteen to twenty-one working days of the employee joining.

Employees are required to cooperate fully with the verification process. This means: providing accurate, complete, and honest information on all employment application documents; producing original documents for physical inspection at the time of joining; responding to any additional request from the verification agency within five working days of the request; and not

attempting to impede or delay the verification process in any way.

Any material misrepresentation or omission in employment application documents — whether discovered before or after the employee has joined — may result in withdrawal of the offer or immediate termination of employment, regardless of the length of service at the time of discovery. The company treats honesty in the recruitment process as a fundamental expression of the Integrity value.

Verification Component	Details Verified	Timeline	Documentation Required
Identity	Identity confirmed against government-issued photo ID	Day 1–5	Aadhaar Card, Passport, PAN Card
Educational Qualifications	All degrees, diplomas, and professional certifications listed in the CV	Day 5–15	Degree certificates and mark sheets
Employment History	All prior employment listed in the CV for the past seven years	Day 7–21	Relieving letter and experience certificate from each employer
Professional References	Minimum two professional referees contacted to corroborate employment history and professional conduct	Days 7–14	Names and contact details of two referees
Address Verification	Current and permanent residential address confirmed	Day 7–21	Utility bill, bank statement, or rental agreement
Criminal Record	Criminal record check conducted through legally permissible channels	Day 10–21	Consent form; no documents required from employee
Credit History	Conducted for roles involving financial authority or access to sensitive financial data	Day 10–21	Consent form required; not applicable for all roles
Social Media Review	Publicly accessible social media profiles reviewed for content materially inconsistent with the company's	Day 1–7	None — automated review

In the event of adverse findings, the employee will be notified in writing and given a reasonable opportunity to provide a written response before any employment decision is made. All background verification information is treated as strictly confidential and is accessible only to authorised personnel in HR and Legal. Third-party verification agencies are contractually bound to the same confidentiality standards that apply to company employees.

Employees who join the company while background verification is still pending are employed on a conditional basis until the verification is satisfactorily concluded. Where verification reveals a discrepancy that was not voluntarily disclosed by the employee at the point of recruitment, this is treated as a failure of the Integrity standard and may be treated as grounds for termination independently of any consequential employment decision based on the findings themselves.

2.3 Probation and Confirmation

Every new employee begins employment on a probationary period of six months from their date of joining, unless the offer letter explicitly specifies a different probation period. The probation period is a structured evaluation period for both the employee and the organisation. It exists to give both parties enough time and information to make a considered, evidence-based decision about whether the employment relationship should be confirmed on a permanent basis.

Probation is not a formality. It carries real and clearly defined obligations for the line manager, not only for the employee. Managers who fail to engage seriously with the probation process — who do not set goals, do not provide regular feedback, and do not make a deliberate confirmation decision — are not fulfilling their management responsibilities. HR Business

Partners are empowered to escalate cases where managers are not meeting probation obligations.

The line manager's obligations during the probation period are as follows:

1. Set specific, measurable, and achievable goals for the employee within the first thirty days of joining, documented and agreed in HRMS. Goals that are set informally or verbally but not recorded in HRMS do not provide a valid basis for probation assessment.

2. Maintain daily check-ins during the first week of employment and weekly thereafter. These need not be long — fifteen to twenty minutes is sufficient — but they must be consistent and must provide the employee with substantive guidance, orientation, and feedback.

3. Conduct a structured mid-probation review conversation at the three-month mark, covering: progress against the documented goals; observations about the employee's technical competency, communication, and conduct; areas requiring improvement before confirmation; and the support the company will provide. Key feedback points must be documented in HRMS within five working days of the conversation.

4. Complete the Probation Assessment Form (HR-016) in HRMS at least ten working days before the probation end date, with specific evidence supporting the recommended outcome.

5. Communicate concerns about performance or conduct during probation promptly and in writing — not as a single surprise at the six-month mark. An employee who is non-confirmed because of issues that were never raised during probation has been failed by their manager, and HR treats this as a management deficiency.

6. Initiate the probation extension or non-confirmation process through HR with at least five working days' notice before the original probation end date, if concerns have been identified.

Outcome	Criteria for This Outcome	Process	Communication
Confirmed	Employee has met all documented	Manager submits HR-016 in HRMS	Written confirmation letter issued
Extended	Employee has demonstrated genuine effort and	Manager and HR Business Partner agree	Extension letter issued,
Not Confirmed	Performance	Written notice	Written letter issued,

The confirmation date — which is the date recorded in the written confirmation letter — is the date from which all full employment rights activate: Earned Leave accrual begins, the full family floater health insurance plan takes effect, and the band-applicable notice period obligations come into force. The confirmation letter is retained in the employee's permanent HR file.

Probation may not be waived or shortened except by written agreement between the relevant business unit head and the VP-HR. Requests for probation waiver are considered only in genuinely exceptional circumstances — for example, where a highly experienced professional is hired directly into a Band 5 or above role and the waiver is supported by strong evidence of immediate performance at the required level.

2.4 Employment Contracts and Offer Letters

Every employee receives a formal offer letter before joining and a comprehensive employment contract on or before their date of joining. The offer letter is the primary document governing the relationship from acceptance to the date of joining. The employment contract is the definitive legal document governing the relationship thereafter, and it supersedes the offer letter on all matters it addresses.

Employees must sign and return a copy of the employment contract to HR within five working days of joining. Questions or concerns about any provision of the contract should be raised with HR before signing, not after. The company will not accept post-signature challenges to contract terms on the basis that the employee did not fully understand what they were agreeing to at the time of signing.

Any change to the substantive terms of employment — including changes to role title, band, reporting structure, compensation, principal place of work, or standard working hours — must be documented in a formal written amendment to the employment contract or a revised offer letter issued and signed by both parties. Such amendments take effect from the date specified in the written document. Verbal instructions, email correspondence, and informal agreements, regardless of the seniority of the person making them, do not constitute a binding change in the terms of employment.

The employment contract includes a Non-Disclosure Agreement, non-solicitation obligations covering clients, employees, and suppliers, and an intellectual property assignment clause covering all work created in the course of employment. Each of these clauses survives termination of employment for the periods specified in the contract. Employees are strongly encouraged to read these clauses carefully and to seek independent legal advice if they have concerns about the scope or effect of any provision before signing.

2.5 Employment of Relatives

The employment of relatives and close personal associates of existing employees is permitted at Arjun Technologies, subject to one firm and non-negotiable structural condition: there must be no direct reporting relationship between the related employees, and neither party may have supervisory, evaluative, budgetary, or disciplinary authority over the other. This condition exists to protect the integrity of performance management processes, compensation decisions, and

team dynamics, and to prevent the appearance or reality of favouritism.

Employees must disclose any existing or developing familial or close personal relationship with another employee, candidate, or contractor at Arjun Technologies to HR in writing, using the Conflict of Interest Disclosure Form (HR-012) available on the HRMS portal. Disclosure must be made at whichever of the following points comes first: at the time of the employee's own recruitment, if the relationship already exists; when the employee becomes aware that a related person is applying for a role or contract at the company; or at the point when a personal relationship with a current employee develops to a level of closeness that could create a reasonable perception of conflict.

Failure to disclose such a relationship is a breach of the Conflict of Interest Policy and is treated as a disciplinary matter that may result in formal disciplinary action. Where a relationship between two existing employees develops in a manner that creates or threatens a direct reporting conflict, both employees must notify HR immediately. HR will work with the relevant business unit to identify an appropriate resolution, which typically involves the reassignment of one employee to a different team or reporting structure.

2.6 Re-Employment Policy

Former employees of Arjun Technologies who left their employment in good standing are eligible to be considered for re-employment at the company. Good standing for the purposes of this policy means that the employee served their full contractual notice period, had no unresolved disciplinary matters at the time of separation, met all obligations in the exit checklist including the return of company assets, and did not breach any post-employment obligation under their employment contract — including the NDA, non-solicitation clause, or intellectual property assignment.

Re-employed individuals are treated as entirely new employees for all purposes, including Earned Leave accrual, gratuity calculation, PF contribution continuity, seniority-based entitlements, and performance history, unless the terms of the re-employment letter explicitly provide otherwise in writing. No assumed continuity of prior service applies by default. The company reserves the right to decline re-employment applications without providing reasons. Eligibility for re-employment consideration does not create any entitlement to re-employment or any expectation that an application will be successful.

2.7 Retirement Policy

The normal retirement age at Arjun Technologies is 60 years. Employees approaching their normal retirement age are encouraged to discuss their plans with their line manager and HR Business Partner at least six months in advance of their anticipated retirement date, in order to allow adequate succession planning and knowledge transfer arrangements to be put in place.

Formal resignation with the notice period applicable to the employee's band is required to initiate the retirement process.

The company may, at its sole discretion and with the written agreement of the employee, extend the employment of a retiring employee beyond the normal retirement age on a yearly fixed-term basis. Such extension decisions are made by the relevant business unit head in consultation with HR, based on the employee's continued performance, health and capacity to fulfil the requirements of the role, and the company's business requirements at the time. There is no automatic right to employment extension beyond the normal retirement age, and the company is under no obligation to offer or agree to extension on any occasion.

Employees who retire after completing five or more years of continuous service are entitled to gratuity under the Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972, calculated at the statutory rate on the last drawn basic salary. All provident fund accumulations — both employee and employer contributions plus accrued interest — are settled through the EPFO process on the employee's application following retirement. Full details of gratuity calculation and PF settlement procedures are provided in Section 4 and Appendix M.

3. Workplace Standards and Conduct

The conduct of every individual at Arjun Technologies — whether in the office, at a client site, at a company-sponsored event, in any digital communication, or in any public or professional context in which they are identifiable as an employee of this company — shapes the culture of this organisation and directly determines its reputation with clients, partners, talent, and the public. Professional conduct is not a compliance requirement to be satisfied at the minimum level. It is the daily, practical expression of the values to which every employee has committed.

The standards in this section apply to all employees without exception. Seniority does not reduce the obligation to meet these standards. If anything, employees in senior or leadership roles carry a heightened responsibility because their conduct sets the tone for everyone around them and below them in the organisation. A senior employee who does not hold themselves to the standards described here undermines those standards for the entire team.

3.1 General Conduct Standards

The following fifteen standards represent the non-negotiable foundations of professional conduct at Arjun Technologies. They are described in sufficient detail to make clear what each standard means in practice and how it should be applied in the situations that employees commonly encounter. This is not an exhaustive list of every possible conduct expectation — it is a statement of the minimum.

Standard 1 — Treat every person with respect

Treat every colleague, client, vendor, candidate, visitor, and member of the public with courtesy, patience, and professional respect — regardless of their role, seniority, gender, religion, caste, nationality, age, or any other personal characteristic. The standard of respect required at Arjun Technologies is not the minimum needed to avoid a formal complaint. It is the standard of treating every person as a competent professional deserving of genuine consideration. This applies equally in high-pressure situations and in routine daily interactions.

Standard 2 — Communicate professionally and accurately

Communicate — in writing and verbally — in a manner that is clear, accurate, professional, and constructive, across all channels including emails, Slack messages, code review comments, document annotations, and spoken conversations. Avoid language that is dismissive, condescending, sarcastic, passive-aggressive, or aggressive. This standard applies in both formal and informal communications. When delivering critical feedback or navigating a professional disagreement, the manner of communication is as important as its substance.

Standard 3 — Protect confidential information at all times

Maintain the confidentiality of sensitive business, client, and personal information at all times — including after working hours, outside company premises, and after leaving the organisation. The confidentiality obligation is not limited to information formally classified or marked as confidential. It extends to any information that a reasonable professional would recognise as sensitive by its nature — client requirements, system architectures, financial data, personnel matters, and commercial terms. See Section 9 and the standalone Data Privacy Policy for detailed handling requirements by classification level.

Standard 4 — Honour professional commitments fully

Honour every professional commitment — to clients, to colleagues, and to management — without exception. Arrive at meetings on time and prepared. Deliver work by the agreed deadline or communicate proactively, before the deadline arrives, when delivery is not possible. If you attend a meeting, participate in it fully. Presence at a meeting while simultaneously working on other tasks is disrespectful to the meeting's other participants and reduces the quality of the meeting's outcome.

Standard 5 — Report concerns and cooperate with processes

Report suspected violations of company policy, client obligations, applicable law, or the ethical standards described in the Code of Conduct through the appropriate channels without delay. Cooperate fully with internal investigations, compliance reviews, and audit processes when requested by HR, Legal, IT Security, or management, without requiring specific justification beyond what a reasonable professional would consider proportionate to the context.

Standard 6 — Represent the organisation professionally in all external contexts

Represent Arjun Technologies professionally in all external-facing interactions — client meetings, industry events, public speaking engagements, published articles, social media posts in which you are identifiably an employee of the company, and any other public context. Do not make statements to the media, at public forums, or in published materials on behalf of the company without prior written authorisation from the Communications team. In any public forum, your conduct reflects on the organisation.

Standard 7 — Comply with all applicable laws and obligations

Comply fully with all applicable laws, regulations, and contractual obligations in every aspect of your work — including the laws of India and the laws of any country in which you carry out work on behalf of the company or its clients. If you are uncertain whether a proposed action or decision is legally permissible under applicable law or under a client contract, consult the Legal team before proceeding. Relying on personal legal knowledge to make consequential judgements without Legal review is not acceptable.

Standard 8 — Use company resources appropriately

Use company resources — including working time, equipment, software licences, systems, network infrastructure, and office facilities — primarily for legitimate business purposes. Incidental, brief personal use of communication tools and internet access is tolerated in moderation, but must not impair your work performance, consume significant network or computing resources, interfere with the work of colleagues, or violate any policy or applicable law. Company resources must not be used for personal commercial activities, secondary employment, or any activity for personal financial gain.

Standard 9 — Maintain a secure and organised workspace

Maintain a clean, organised workstation and observe the clear-desk policy at all times: documents classified as Confidential or Restricted under the company's information classification scheme must be secured in locked drawers or cabinets at the end of each working day, and must not be left visible on unattended desks or accessible to passers-by during the working day. Lock your computer screen whenever you leave your workstation, even briefly. At client sites, observe the client's own clean-desk and physical security policies.

Standard 10 — Follow all safety procedures without exception

Follow all health, safety, and emergency procedures as instructed by the Safety Officer and as posted at each office location. Participate in all mandatory safety training programmes and emergency evacuation drills. Report any hazard, unsafe condition, defective equipment, or near-miss incident to the Safety Officer immediately and without delay, regardless of how minor the hazard appears. Do not interfere with, modify, or bypass any safety equipment or emergency system under any circumstances.

Standard 11 — Avoid all forms of harassment, bullying, and intimidation

Do not engage in conduct that is disruptive, threatening, harassing, bullying, or intimidating — in any form, through any channel, and in any setting connected to work. Do not create, contribute to, or tolerate a workplace environment that is hostile, exclusionary, or that makes any colleague feel unsafe or unwelcome. This standard applies equally in informal social settings — company events, team dinners, and messaging channels — as in formal professional settings. Bystander intervention by colleagues who witness such conduct is encouraged.

Standard 12 — Declare conflicts of interest promptly

Disclose any actual or potential conflict of interest to HR promptly and in writing using the Conflict of Interest Disclosure Form (HR-012). A conflict of interest exists when your personal financial interests, personal relationships, or outside commitments have the potential to influence — or could reasonably be perceived to influence — your professional judgement in a way that is not in the best interests of the company or its clients. The obligation to disclose applies even where you are genuinely uncertain whether a conflict exists. When in doubt, disclose.

Standard 13 — Care for company property

Treat company property — equipment, devices, software licences, vehicles, intellectual property, and physical materials — with reasonable care and professional responsibility. Report any damage, loss, or malfunction to the Administration or IT team promptly. Do not misuse, misappropriate, or convert company property to personal use. Upon separation from employment, return all company property on or before the last working day as specified in the exit checklist.

Standard 14 — Separate personal matters from professional obligations

Do not allow personal disputes, domestic difficulties, or private grievances to affect your professional conduct, impair your work performance, or create a disruptive environment for colleagues. Where personal circumstances are genuinely affecting your ability to work effectively, speak confidentially with your manager or HR Business Partner about what support is available, including through the Employee Assistance Programme. Acting on colleagues' behalf — raising a matter on behalf of a colleague without their knowledge or consent — is not appropriate unless directed through a formal reporting channel.

Standard 15 — Actively uphold and model the company's values

In all professional conduct, actively uphold the six Core Values of Arjun Technologies: Integrity, Excellence, Collaboration, Accountability, Innovation, and Inclusion. These values are not decorative — they define the kind of organisation we have chosen to be, and maintaining them requires active participation from every individual. When you observe conduct that is materially inconsistent with these values, address it through the appropriate channel — informal discussion, grievance procedure, or Whistleblower hotline as the situation warrants. Silence in the face of visible values violations is not a neutral position.

3.2 Professional Appearance

Arjun Technologies does not impose a prescriptive or uniform dress code for most roles. Employees are expected to exercise sound professional judgement about appropriate attire based on the nature of their role, the requirements of their specific day, and the professional

context of a technology services company that regularly hosts clients, partners, and senior visitors. The general standard is attire that is clean, neat, well-maintained, and appropriate for a professional environment.

On days when client visits, formal external presentations, recruitment interviews, Board or investor meetings, or significant internal events with senior management are scheduled, business or business-casual attire is expected of all employees in attendance or in roles where they may encounter these visitors. Managers may specify an attire standard for a specific event with reasonable advance notice — typically at least three working days. Company-wide events such as annual all-hands meetings, client appreciation days, and formally organised team off-sites may carry specified attire standards that will be communicated in advance by the organising team or HR.

Clothing, accessories, or branded merchandise displaying offensive, discriminatory, political, or otherwise inappropriate imagery, slogans, or language is not permitted in the workplace or at company events under any circumstances, regardless of any general dress flexibility that applies in a given context. Attire that creates a safety hazard — including open-toed footwear in areas where closed-toe shoes are required for safety, or loose-fitting clothing near industrial or mechanical equipment — must not be worn in those specifically designated areas, regardless of personal preference.

The company makes reasonable accommodations for religious dress requirements consistent with applicable Indian law and with the company's Inclusion value. Employees whose religious observance requires specific attire — including headwear, religious threads, or modest dress — should inform HR at the time of joining or at any point when a relevant requirement arises. All accommodation requests are treated with confidentiality and are considered promptly and respectfully. No employee will be disadvantaged in any employment-related decision by virtue of their religious dress requirements.

3.3 Working Hours and Attendance

Standard working hours at all Arjun Technologies offices are 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM, Monday through Friday, inclusive of a one-hour unpaid lunch break. The standard net working day is eight hours. Where a specific team operates on a flexible working arrangement formally approved by HR and the relevant business unit head, core hours of 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM apply — all team members must be available, responsive, and present (or connected) during this window regardless of their personalised start and finish times.

Employees are required to record attendance daily through the HRMS system. At offices equipped with biometric or proximity access-card systems, attendance is captured automatically at entry and exit through the physical access control infrastructure. Remote employees and employees at locations without automated recording must mark attendance manually through

the HRMS mobile application by 9:30 AM on each working day. The application records the precise time of marking and, where the employee has enabled location services, the GPS coordinates at the time of marking.

Attendance records generated through HRMS are the official and definitive records used for payroll computation, leave reconciliation, statutory compliance reporting, and any attendance-related investigation. Employees who identify discrepancies in their HRMS attendance record must submit an Attendance Correction Request through the HRMS portal (HR Services → Attendance → Correct Attendance) within five working days of the date in question. All corrections require manager approval before they take effect. Corrections to dates more than thirty calendar days prior require manager approval plus HRBP approval and, if they affect salary, Finance sign-off.

Employees who will be absent or significantly late on any working day must inform their line manager by 9:30 AM on that day, by phone or through the team's designated messaging channel. This obligation applies regardless of the reason for the absence. Where the absence is planned in advance, the leave application must be submitted and approved in HRMS before the leave period begins. Where the absence is unplanned, the leave application must be submitted in HRMS on the day of the employee's return. Failure to comply with these notification and application procedures will result in the absence being classified as Leave Without Pay, and salary will be deducted accordingly.

Attendance Situation	Classification	Action Taken	HR Involvement
Absent without any notice — 1 day	Leave Without Pay	Salary deduction for the day; line manager to record reason	Not required
Absent without notice — 2 to 4 consecutive days	Leave Without Pay	Salary deduction; HR makes a welfare call to the employee on the second day	HR verifies the employee is safe; may escalate
Absent without notice — 5 or more consecutive days	Potential abandonment	HR issues a 48-hour written notice requiring the employee to report for duty or provide explanation	HR and Legal to be involved
3 or more late arrivals in any calendar month	Attendance concern	Line manager has a counselling conversation; HRBP is informed	HRBP is informed; formal notation on file
10 or more unexplained absent days in a leave year	Persistent issue	Formal HR attendance counselling. Continued non-improvement may lead to disciplinary action	HRBP and HR Director involved
Pattern of absence adjacent to public holidays	Attendance concern	Supportive conversation with manager; HRBP advises if medical issue may be involved	HRBP advises if medical issue may

The company's approach to attendance management is to address concerns early, constructively, and with genuine interest in understanding the underlying reason before applying any consequence. Where attendance issues are linked to a health condition, mental health concern, family difficulty, or other legitimate personal circumstance, HR will work proactively with the employee to find a workable solution — which may include flexible working adjustments, a phased return to full attendance, or EAP support — rather than defaulting to a disciplinary response.

3.4 Remote and Hybrid Work Policy

Arjun Technologies supports a hybrid working model for roles and functions where remote work is operationally feasible, does not compromise client delivery quality, and can be sustained without adversely affecting team collaboration or knowledge transfer. The hybrid arrangement allows eligible confirmed employees to work from a location other than the office for up to two designated days per week, with the remaining three days in the office. This balance is designed to preserve the benefits of in-person collaboration and team cohesion while offering employees the flexibility of some remote working.

The hybrid arrangement is not available to employees during the probationary period, employees currently subject to an active Performance Improvement Plan, employees in roles whose nature requires physical presence (such as facilities management, in-person IT infrastructure support, and reception functions), or employees whose arrangement has been formally suspended due to conduct, performance, or operational concerns. In periods of elevated business demand — such as during a major go-live, a significant client audit, or a critical delivery milestone — full office attendance may be temporarily required for specific teams or roles, and the hybrid arrangement is suspended accordingly.

The hybrid work arrangement is a professional privilege that is granted and managed at the discretion of the line manager. It may be modified or revoked at any time based on legitimate business requirements, team coordination needs, or a change in the employee's performance or conduct. The decision to grant, modify, or revoke a hybrid arrangement is not subject to the grievance process unless the employee can demonstrate to the HR Business Partner's satisfaction that the decision was made on discriminatory or otherwise unlawful grounds.

The following conditions apply to all employees on any day they are working remotely under the hybrid arrangement:

1. Maintain a suitable, private, and professional remote work environment. This means a dedicated workspace that is free from significant background noise and visual distractions during video calls, with stable broadband internet connectivity sustaining a minimum of 10 Mbps upload and download speed, and the ability to participate in video calls with the camera activated without significant interruption.

2. Connect to all company systems, applications, and data exclusively through the company-approved and company-managed VPN at all times during the remote working day. Accessing any company system — email, HRMS, internal tools, client systems, or any cloud service accessed through company credentials — over a public Wi-Fi network, hotel Wi-Fi, café Wi-Fi, airport Wi-Fi, or an unmanaged mobile hotspot, without an active VPN connection, is strictly prohibited.

3. Be fully reachable through official communication channels — company email, Slack, and telephone — during the core working hours of 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM. Response times

to messages, emails, and calls during core hours must be equivalent to those that would be expected if the employee were in the office.

4. Attend all mandatory meetings, client calls, standup sessions, and scheduled reviews on time and fully prepared, exactly as if the employee were physically present in the office. The fact that a day is a designated remote working day does not reduce in any way the employee's obligation to attend any committed meeting.

5. Maintain all company-provided equipment in good working condition and ensure it is physically secured against loss, theft, or damage when not in active use. Under no circumstances may any unauthorised person — including household members, family, and visitors — use, handle, or access any company equipment or company system.

6. Ensure that all company data accessed, created, or processed during the remote day is handled strictly in accordance with the IT Security Policy and the Data Privacy Policy. Confidential or Restricted data must not be accessed through personal devices, stored in personal cloud services, printed on personal printers, or transmitted through any unsecured channel.

7. Comply promptly and without objection with a manager's legitimate request to attend the office on a day that is otherwise a scheduled remote day, given at least 24 hours' advance notice except where a genuine emergency makes that timeline impractical.

8. Maintain work output, task completion, and professional availability at a level fully consistent with the standard expected on in-office working days. The hybrid arrangement will be reviewed and may be suspended if the manager observes a sustained and demonstrable reduction in responsiveness, quality, or output on remote working days.

Employees who wish to formalise a hybrid working arrangement must complete the Work from Home Agreement (HR-017), available on the HRMS portal, which records the agreed weekly schedule and the specific terms and conditions applicable to their arrangement. The agreement must be approved by the line manager and acknowledged by HR before the arrangement begins. Informal hybrid working arrangements that have not been formalised through this process are not recognised under the company's remote work provisions and do not carry the protections or entitlements that formal arrangements carry.

3.5 Workplace Safety and Health

Arjun Technologies is committed to providing and maintaining a safe, healthy, and hazard-free working environment for all employees, contractors, and visitors at all company locations. The company complies fully with all applicable provisions of the Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions Code, 2020, the applicable state-level workplace safety and health legislation at each office location, and any specific safety or health requirements imposed by

client contracts or client site rules where employees are deployed.

Workplace safety is a genuinely shared responsibility. The company is responsible for providing a physically safe environment, adequate personal protective equipment where required, thorough safety training, well-maintained emergency systems and first-aid resources, and clear documented emergency procedures. Each individual employee is simultaneously responsible for working safely at all times, following all posted safety instructions and procedures, reporting hazards without delay, participating fully in safety training and emergency drills, and not interfering with, modifying, or bypassing any safety equipment or emergency system.

A Safety Officer is designated at each of the company's office locations. The Safety Officer is responsible for conducting regular safety inspections, maintaining emergency preparedness plans, managing the first-aid equipment inventory, delivering safety training programmes, and coordinating the response to any workplace incident or emergency. Emergency evacuation plans showing all exit routes, assembly points, floor warden responsibilities, and emergency contact numbers are posted at all fire exits and in common areas across every floor of every office.

Fire and emergency evacuation drills are conducted at least twice per year at all office locations. Attendance at evacuation drills is mandatory for all employees present in the office on the drill day. Employees who are absent during a drill should familiarise themselves with the evacuation plan and confirm their designated assembly point with the floor warden. A minimum of two employees per occupied floor hold current basic first-aid training at all times. First-aid kits are maintained at clearly marked, easily accessible locations in each office and are inspected and restocked monthly by the Safety Officer.

Any workplace injury, accident, or occupational illness — regardless of perceived severity — must be reported to both the line manager and the Safety Officer on the same working day on which it occurs. A formal workplace incident report must be submitted by HR within twenty-four hours of the incident. The company investigates every reported incident, however minor, to identify root causes and implement corrective measures that prevent recurrence. Employees who sustain a workplace injury are entitled to treatment covered by the company's group health insurance plan and, where applicable, to statutory benefits under the Employees' State Insurance scheme.

Stakeholder	Specific Safety Responsibilities
Individual Employee	Work safely at all times; follow all posted safety instructions; report any hazard or unsafe condition to the Safe
Line Manager	Ensure all direct reports have completed mandatory safety training; ensure workstations and team equipment
Safety Officer	Conduct monthly safety inspections; maintain and test emergency equipment; deliver safety training; manage
HR Department	Maintain safety training completion records; process any applicable injury compensation claims; incorporate s
IT Department	Maintain ergonomic workstation standards and guidelines for employee workstations; manage access control

Stakeholder	Specific Safety Responsibilities
Administration	Maintain the physical office infrastructure in safe and compliant condition; manage contractor safety inductions

3.6 Substance-Free Workplace Policy

Arjun Technologies maintains a strictly substance-free workplace. The possession, consumption, purchase, distribution, or sale of alcohol, narcotics, cannabis (including medical cannabis where not relevant to a disclosed prescription), or any other controlled or illegal substance — on company premises, at company-sponsored events, during company-funded travel, or at any location or context during the employee's working hours — is strictly prohibited without exception. This prohibition applies regardless of the legal status of the substance in the jurisdiction in question and regardless of any general social acceptance of the substance concerned.

This prohibition extends to arriving at any work-related engagement — including a client meeting, a business dinner, a team event, or an industry conference where the employee is representing the company — in a state of meaningful impairment from any substance, including alcohol. The company recognises that alcohol is legitimately present in some professional social contexts and does not prohibit all adult consumption in personal time. The prohibition applies specifically to impairment in a professional or work-connected context.

Violation of the substance-free workplace policy is a serious disciplinary offence. Where an employee is found to be under the influence of a controlled substance while at work, the likely outcome following a fair investigation is immediate suspension during the investigation period and summary termination following conclusion of the investigation. Where an employee's impairment has directly caused or contributed to a safety incident, equipment damage, or harm to a colleague or client, the matter will additionally be referred to the relevant legal authorities.

The company recognises that substance dependency is a health condition and not primarily a matter of moral failing. Employees who come forward voluntarily — before any conduct issue has been identified or a complaint has been made — to disclose a substance dependency and seek support will be treated with full confidentiality and genuine compassion. HR will work with such employees to arrange access to appropriate treatment and counselling through the Employee Assistance Programme, and to make reasonable, time-limited adjustments to their working arrangements during the treatment period where this is operationally feasible.

Employees who are taking prescribed medication — whether for chronic conditions, post-surgical recovery, or short-term illness — that may impair cognitive function, coordination, judgment, or the safe performance of their duties must inform their line manager and HR in confidence as soon as the prescription begins. The company will work with the employee to make reasonable temporary adjustments to their work schedule, tasks, or responsibilities for the duration of the prescription period where such adjustments are operationally feasible and are

supported by medical advice.

3.7 Workplace Violence Prevention Policy

Arjun Technologies has a clear and unambiguous zero-tolerance policy toward all forms of violence, threats of violence, intimidation, and aggressive behaviour in the workplace and in any context connected to employment at the company. This policy applies to all employees, contractors, consultants, clients, and visitors at all company premises and at all company-sponsored events, and its scope extends to digital communications, social media posts, and any other medium through which threatening or intimidating behaviour is communicated.

Conduct prohibited under this policy includes — but is not limited to — the following: any act of physical violence or physical assault; any verbal threat of violence or physical harm, whether made directly or indirectly; any written threat of violence communicated through any medium including email, instant messaging, social media, handwritten notes, or online forums; any behaviour involving intimidating gestures or physical posturing intended to create fear; conduct that causes a reasonable person to genuinely fear for their personal safety or the safety of others; deliberate destruction or threatened destruction of company or personal property; and any sustained pattern of hostile or aggressive behaviour toward a colleague, regardless of physical harm.

Any employee who experiences, witnesses, or becomes aware of conduct covered by this policy must report it to HR or the Safety Officer as soon as it is safe to do so — either through direct contact with the HRBP, through the Whistleblower hotline, or directly to the Safety Officer at the relevant office. All reports under this policy are treated as urgent. The company will initiate an investigation within one working day of receiving a report and will keep the reporting employee informed of the status of the investigation on a regular basis.

Employees who make a good-faith report under this policy are fully protected from any form of retaliation. Any employee found to have retaliated against a colleague for making a report of workplace violence or intimidation will themselves be subject to serious disciplinary action, including potential termination.

Threat Level	Description	Immediate Response Required	Company Action
Level 1 — Minor	Isolated offensive remark, dismissive gesture, or single instance of aggressive posture, no physical threat	Report to HRBP within 24 hours	Verbal warning and documented counselling
Level 2 — Moderate	Persistent pattern of intimidating behaviour, explicit verbal threat, or threatening written communication	Report to HRBP immediately	Formal investigation within 1 working day; written warning or suspension pending outcome
Level 3 — Serious	Physical assault or a credible, immediate threat of physical harm, or any conduct that places employees in fear for their safety	Evacuate the area if safe to do so; call emergency services (100) if needed	Immediate suspension of the accused; police complaint supported by the company; termination proceedings initiated

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EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

Segment 2 of 5 — Compensation, Benefits & Leave Policy

Version	5.2	**Effective Date**	01 April 2024
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HR Contact	hr@arjuntech.in	**Department**	Human Resources
Document Ref.	HR-POL-001-v5.2	**Segment**	2 of 5 (Pages 51–100)

This segment covers Section 4 (Compensation and Benefits) and Section 5 (Leave Policy) of the Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd. Employee Handbook. It is classified as Internal Use Only and must be read in conjunction with the full handbook. The current version of all segments is available on the HRMS portal under Policies and Documents.

4. Compensation and Benefits

Arjun Technologies's compensation philosophy is to pay competitively, transparently, and fairly. Total compensation is benchmarked annually against market data from recognised industry surveys covering the Indian IT and technology services sector. The company targets total compensation at or above the 60th percentile of the relevant market for each role and band. The intent is to attract and retain talented professionals while maintaining internal equity and financial discipline.

This section describes every element of the total rewards package available to employees. Employees are encouraged to read it carefully and in full. The non-cash elements — group insurance, provident fund, gratuity provisioning, and the Employee Assistance Programme — represent a significant portion of the total cost of employment and provide material financial protection that is easy to underestimate when evaluating compensation purely on the basis of take-home salary.

Compensation decisions are based on four factors applied together: the current market rate for the role and level based on the annual benchmarking exercise; the employee's placement within the compensation band for their level; the employee's performance rating in the most recent appraisal cycle; and the available merit budget approved by Finance for the financial year. All compensation decisions are reviewed by HR and the relevant business unit head to ensure internal equity within teams.

4.1 Compensation Philosophy and Structure

Total compensation at Arjun Technologies is structured in three layers. The first layer is fixed pay — the guaranteed monthly salary comprising basic salary, house rent allowance, special allowance, and the flexible benefit plan allocation. The second layer is variable pay — an annual performance-linked cash payment that is not guaranteed and is entirely dependent on individual performance and the company's financial results. The third layer is benefits — the group insurance plans, statutory employer contributions, and the employee assistance programme, none of which appear as salary credits but all of which represent real economic value.

For senior employees, ESOPs represent a fourth long-term incentive layer, described in Section 4.10. The combination of all four layers is the employee's Total Reward. Employees are encouraged to consider the full Total Reward picture — not only the cash component — when evaluating their compensation relative to market alternatives, since the benefits and insurance provisions at Arjun Technologies are materially more comprehensive than those offered by many comparable employers.

The company conducts an annual compensation benchmarking exercise in January and February of each financial year, comparing the compensation of each band against data from

three primary surveys: the Mercer India IT Compensation Survey, the Hewitt Associates India Compensation Report, and the Naukri Insights Compensation Benchmarking Study. Where the benchmarking exercise reveals that a specific band or skill cluster has moved materially above the company's current pay range, HR proposes a range adjustment to the Compensation Committee for approval.

4.2 Salary Structure and Components

All employee compensation is expressed as an annual Cost-to-Company figure. The CTC is the total annual cost incurred by the company in employing the individual, and it includes both the amounts paid directly to the employee and all employer-borne statutory contributions and insurance premiums. The employee's monthly take-home salary is always materially lower than the monthly equivalent of the CTC, because the CTC includes items that are provisioned for the employee's long-term benefit but not paid as a current cash credit — including the employer's PF contribution, the gratuity provision, and the insurance premiums.

Component	Basis of Calculation	Tax Treatment	Statutory Basis	Key Notes
Basic Salary	40% of annual CTC	Fully taxable as salary income	Employer discretion	Foundation for PF, HRA, and gratuity. Set
House Rent Allowance	50% of Basic (metro) / 40% (non-metro)	Partially exempt — Sec 10(13A)	Employer discretion	Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Pune, Chennai, Mu
Special Allowance	Balance of CTC after all other components	Fully taxable as salary income	Employer discretion	Residual component that adjusts to achiev
Performance Variable Pay	10%–20% of CTC; paid post appraisal	Fully taxable; TDS deducted at source	Employer discretion	Not guaranteed. Modulated by individual ra
Employer PF Contribution	12% of Basic (subject to ■15,000 ceiling)	Exempt up to ■1.5L/yr under employee's 80C limit	EPF & MP Act, 1952	Split: 3.67% to EPF account, 8.33% to EPS
Gratuity Provision	4.81% of Basic, provisioned monthly	Exempt up to ■20L at separation	Payment of Gratuity Act	Provisioned by Finance monthly. Paid only
Group Health Insurance	Company-paid; zero deduction from salary	Exempt as employer benefit	Employer discretion	■5,00,000 family floater for confirmed emp
Group Term Life Insurance	Company-paid; zero deduction from salary	Exempt as employer benefit	Employer discretion	Sum assured ■50,00,000. Effective from c
Personal Accident Insurance	Company-paid	Exempt as employer benefit	Employer discretion	Sum assured ■10,00,000. Covers acciden
Flexible Benefit Plan	■18,000 per year; employee allocated	Tax treatment varies by component category	Employer discretion	Allocable to LTA, medical reimbursement,

The Basic Salary is set at 40 percent of CTC as a deliberate balance between two competing objectives. A higher Basic Salary increases the mandatory PF deduction from the employee's salary (reducing take-home pay), increases the employer's gratuity provision liability, and increases the employer's PF contribution cost. A lower Basic Salary reduces these obligations but also reduces the HRA component, which reduces the tax exemption available to the employee under Section 10(13A). The 40 percent ratio achieves a reasonable and widely accepted balance between these competing factors.

The Special Allowance component is the residual — it absorbs whatever is required to make the sum of all components equal exactly the agreed CTC. As a result, the Special Allowance amount will differ between two employees at the same CTC if their Basic Salaries differ slightly due to historical revisions at different points in time. This is normal and expected. Finance will provide a personalised salary component breakdown on request for any employee who wishes

to understand their structure in detail.

4.3 Payroll Processing, Payslips, and TDS

Salaries are processed on the last working day of each calendar month and credited by direct electronic transfer to the employee's registered bank account. Employees receive a detailed digital payslip through the HRMS portal on the same day as the salary credit. The payslip is itemised to show every gross component by name and amount, every deduction including the statutory basis for each, the TDS deducted for the month, the year-to-date TDS position, and the net amount credited.

Employees are responsible for maintaining current and accurate bank account details in HRMS at all times. If a salary credit is returned by the bank due to an incorrect account number, a closed account, or a name mismatch, Finance will attempt to reprocess the payment in the following payroll cycle after the employee has updated their bank details. The company is not liable for delays in salary receipt that result from incorrect bank information provided by the employee.

Tax Deducted at Source is computed each month by the Finance team on the basis of the employee's projected annual taxable income and the tax-saving investment declarations submitted through Form 12BB at the beginning of the financial year. The TDS is calibrated to spread the annual tax liability evenly across twelve months. Employees who do not submit Form 12BB by the Finance-published deadline will have TDS computed at the maximum applicable income tax slab rate on their projected income, which may result in significantly higher monthly deductions in the second half of the year as arrear tax is recovered.

Investment declarations must be supported by actual proof documents submitted by a separate Finance deadline, typically in late January or early February. Declarations without supporting proof are excluded from the TDS computation, which may again result in increased deductions in the final months of the year. Employees are strongly advised to maintain organised records of all eligible investments and to submit both the declaration and the proof by the published deadlines.

Form 16 — the annual TDS certificate — is issued by 31 May each year following the close of the financial year on 31 March. Form 16 is available for download from the HRMS portal under Payroll → Tax Documents. It is used by employees to file their annual income tax return. Employees who identify discrepancies between the amounts shown in Form 16 and the actual tax deducted during the year should raise these with the Payroll team at payroll@arjuntech.in before filing their return.

Payroll queries must be raised through the HRMS ticket system within five working days of the salary credit date. Queries submitted after this window may not be addressable in the same

payroll cycle and will be resolved in the following month. Systemic payroll errors affecting multiple employees are escalated by Finance to the Payroll Manager and resolved within three working days of identification.

4.4 Statutory Benefits

Arjun Technologies complies fully with all statutory benefit obligations under Indian labour law. The following table summarises the key statutory schemes, the applicable legislation, and the obligations on the company and the employee. Employees who believe any statutory deduction has been incorrectly computed or that a statutory benefit has not been correctly applied should contact the Finance team at payroll@arjuntech.in.

Statutory Benefit	Governing Legislation	Employee Rate	Employer Rate	Applicability
Employees' Provident Fund	EPF & MP Act, 1952	12% of Basic Salary	12% of Basic Salary (3.67% to EPF + 8.33% to EPS)	All employees; mandatory on Basic ≤ ■1
Employees' State Insurance	ESI Act, 1948	0.75% of Gross Salary	3.25% of Gross Salary	Employees with gross monthly salary ≤ ■
Professional Tax	State-level legislation (varies)	Per state slab (max ■2,500/year)	Nil	All employees; applicable in Karnataka, T
Gratuity	Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972	None	4.81% of Basic (provisioned monthly)	Employees with 5+ years of continuous s
Statutory Bonus	Payment of Bonus Act, 1965	None	Minimum 8.33% of wage	Employees with wages ≤ ■21,000/month
Maternity Benefit	Maternity Benefit Act, 1961 (amended 2017)	None	Full salary during leave	Female employees meeting the Act's eligi

4.4.1 Employees' Provident Fund — Detailed Reference

The EPF scheme is India's primary mandatory retirement savings vehicle. Both the employee and the company contribute 12 percent of the employee's basic salary monthly, subject to the applicable statutory wage ceiling. The employee's 12 percent contribution is deducted from salary. The employer's 12 percent contribution is paid additionally by the company and does not reduce take-home pay. Both amounts are remitted to the EPFO by the 15th of the following month.

The employer's 12 percent is split between two sub-schemes: 3.67 percent is credited to the employee's individual EPF savings account, where it earns tax-free interest at the rate declared annually by the EPFO; and 8.33 percent is contributed to the Employees' Pension Scheme, which provides a defined monthly pension payable after retirement at age 58. The EPS component is not individually owned by the employee and cannot be withdrawn as a lump sum before retirement age, except in limited circumstances.

Every employee is assigned a Universal Account Number by the EPFO. The UAN is portable across all employers and allows PF accumulated across multiple employments to be consolidated. Employees must activate their UAN through the EPFO member portal at epfindia.gov.in and link their Aadhaar, PAN, and bank account details. HR assists new employees with UAN activation during the first thirty days of joining. Employees can view their PF balance, contribution history, and claim status through the EPFO portal at any time using

their UAN and password.

Voluntary PF contributions above the mandatory 12 percent are available to employees who wish to increase their retirement savings within the EPF structure. VPF contributions enjoy the same EEE (Exempt-Exempt-Exempt) tax treatment as mandatory EPF contributions — contributions are eligible for deduction under Section 80C, interest accrues tax-free, and qualifying withdrawals are tax-free. VPF elections must be submitted to the Payroll team at the beginning of the financial year.

4.4.2 Employees' State Insurance — Detailed Reference

ESI applies to all employees whose gross monthly salary is at or below ■21,000 per month. The scheme provides medical benefits, sickness cash benefits, maternity cash benefits, disability benefits, and dependant benefits through the ESIC hospital and dispensary network across India. ESI membership entitles the covered employee and their immediate family to cashless treatment at ESIC network facilities without any co-payment or deductible.

The sickness cash benefit under ESI provides approximately 70 percent of the employee's average daily wage for up to 91 days of certified sickness per benefit period. This is separate from the company's sick leave provision and is administered entirely by the ESIC. HR assists employees who need to file an ESI claim by providing the necessary employer certification and guidance on the ESIC claims process.

4.4.3 Gratuity — Calculation and Payment

Gratuity is a statutory terminal benefit payable under the Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972 to every employee who has completed five or more years of continuous service at the time of separation, regardless of the reason for separation (except forfeiture in the case of gross misconduct involving damage to the employer). The standard calculation formula is: **(Last drawn Basic Salary ÷ 26) × 15 × Number of completed years of service.** In this formula, 26 represents the number of working days in a month and 15 represents the days' salary accrued per year of service.

For the purposes of gratuity calculation, a partial year of service of six months or more is rounded up to a full year. For example, an employee with seven years and eight months of service receives gratuity computed on eight years. An employee with seven years and four months receives gratuity on seven years. The maximum gratuity amount exempt from income tax is ■20,00,000. Any gratuity payment in excess of this limit is taxable as salary income in the year of receipt.

Gratuity is processed as part of Full and Final Settlement and must be paid within 30 days of the employee's last working day. If the company fails to pay within 30 days without a reasonable cause, it becomes liable to pay simple interest at 10 percent per annum on the outstanding

amount for the period of delay. Employees must submit their gratuity nominee in Form F to HR within thirty days of joining. The nomination can be updated at any time through HR.

4.5 Group Health Insurance

All confirmed employees are enrolled in the company's Group Mediclaim (Health Insurance) policy from their date of confirmation. The policy is a family floater plan providing a sum insured of ■5,00,000 per family per policy year, covering the employee, their legally married spouse or registered domestic partner, and up to two dependent children below the age of 25. The annual insurance premium is entirely company-paid. No amount is deducted from the employee's salary for the standard coverage.

During the six-month probation period, employees are covered under a basic individual hospitalisation plan with a sum insured of ■2,00,000. This basic cover does not extend to the employee's family members. On confirmation, coverage automatically upgrades to the full family floater plan. The upgrade requires no action from the employee — HR notifies the insurer and the employee's benefits details in HRMS are updated accordingly within five working days of the confirmation date.

New dependants may be added to the policy within 30 days of a qualifying life event such as marriage, the birth of a child, or adoption. Additions outside this 30-day window are subject to the next annual policy renewal cycle. Employees may also add their parents or parents-in-law to the group policy as additional insured members, with the additional premium payable through monthly payroll deduction. They may additionally purchase top-up or super top-up coverage to increase their total protection above the base sum insured, again at their own cost through payroll deduction. Details of all enhancement options are communicated by HR at the beginning of each policy year in March.

The following table summarises the key coverage provisions under the standard group health insurance plan for FY 2024-25:

Coverage Item	Covered?	Limit or Conditions	Notes
In-patient hospitalisation	Yes	Up to ■5,00,000 sum insured per family per year	Minimum 24-hour admission required.
Pre-hospitalisation expenses	Yes	30 days before admission date	Must relate to the same illness or injury.
Post-hospitalisation expenses	Yes	60 days after discharge date	Must relate to the same illness or injury.
Day-care procedures	Yes	Listed schedule of 540+ procedures	Procedures not requiring 24-hour admission.
Domiciliary hospitalisation	Yes	Where hospital admission not feasible	Doctor's certificate of necessity required.
Maternity — normal delivery	Yes (9-month waiting period)	Up to ■50,000 per delivery	Spouse's maximum also covered.
Maternity — caesarean section	Yes (9-month waiting period)	Up to ■75,000 per delivery	Spouse's maximum also covered.
New-born baby	Yes — first 90 days	Under mother's sum insured	Must be added within 30 days of birth for continued
Pre-existing diseases	After 48-month continuous coverage	Subject to disclosure at enrolment	Must be declared honestly at enrolment.

Coverage Item	Covered?	Limit or Conditions	Notes
Cataract surgery	After 24-month waiting period	■20,000 per eye per year	Waiting period applies to new enrolments.
In-patient mental illness treatment	Yes	Subject to policy terms	Outpatient counselling not covered under standard
Organ transplant	Yes	Up to sum insured	Donor expenses also covered up to the sum insure
COVID-19 hospitalisation	Yes	Treated as any other hospitalisation	Home treatment: ■25,000 lump sum with positive
Ambulance charges	Yes	■3,000 per hospitalisation	Emergency ambulance only.
Spectacles and contact lenses	No	Not covered	Not included in the standard group plan.
Routine dental treatment	No	Not covered	Dental treatment requiring hospitalisation is covere
International hospitalisation	No	Not covered	Separate travel insurance is arranged for approved

Cashless hospitalisation is available at all hospitals in the insurer's network, which is published on the HR portal and updated quarterly. To use cashless treatment, the employee calls the insurer's 24/7 helpline (number printed on the insurance card available in HRMS under Benefits → My Benefits) at least 72 hours before a planned admission, or within 24 hours of an emergency admission. The insurer issues a pre-authorisation letter specifying the approved amount, which the employee presents at the hospital's insurance desk. The approved amount is then settled directly between the insurer and the hospital; the employee pays only for non-covered items.

For treatment at non-network hospitals, or where cashless approval has not been possible, the employee pays all bills directly and claims reimbursement from the insurer. Reimbursement claims must be submitted with original itemised bills, discharge summary, all prescriptions, and completed claim forms within 30 days of discharge for hospitalisation claims, and within 15 days of the end of the relevant period for pre and post-hospitalisation expenses. Claims submitted after these deadlines may be rejected by the insurer.

4.6 Group Term Life Insurance

All confirmed employees are covered under the company's Group Term Life Insurance policy with a sum assured of ■50,00,000 per employee. The annual premium is entirely company-paid. Coverage is effective from the date of confirmation and does not require a medical examination. In the event of an employee's death during employment — regardless of the cause, as long as it is not specifically excluded under the policy — the nominated beneficiary receives the full sum assured.

Employees must submit a beneficiary nomination form to HR within 30 days of joining. The nomination must specify the nominee's full legal name, date of birth, relationship to the employee, and residential address. The nomination can be updated at any time by submitting a revised form to HR. Employees are strongly advised to review and update their nominations following major life events such as marriage, the birth of a child, divorce, or the death of a previously nominated person.

Group term life insurance proceeds are generally exempt from income tax in the hands of the nominee under Section 10(10D) of the Income Tax Act, subject to applicable conditions. The nominee should consult an independent tax advisor for guidance specific to their circumstances. HR will provide the nominee with all necessary documentation to support the claim process as promptly as possible following the employee's death.

4.7 Personal Accident Insurance

All confirmed employees are covered under a Group Personal Accident Insurance policy providing a sum assured of ■10,00,000. The premium is entirely company-paid. The policy covers accidental death, permanent total disability resulting from an accident, and permanent partial disability, with the benefit payable as a percentage of the sum assured based on the nature and severity of the disability as specified in the policy schedule.

In the event of a covered accident, the employee or their family must notify HR on the same day as the incident to initiate the claims process. HR will provide the claim forms and coordinate with the insurer to facilitate prompt processing. The policy schedule and full terms and conditions, including all exclusions, are available on the HR portal under Benefits.

4.8 Provident Fund — Employee Guide

Since PF is a long-term savings scheme with complex mechanics, this section provides additional guidance beyond the statutory summary in Section 4.4. The key point that employees frequently misunderstand is that the employer's 12 percent PF contribution is split — only 3.67 percent is credited to the employee's individual EPF savings account. The remaining 8.33 percent goes to the EPS, which funds a pension payable from age 58. The EPS portion cannot be withdrawn as a lump sum on resignation, unlike the EPF portion.

On separation, employees have three options for their EPF savings balance. First, they can withdraw the full EPF balance by submitting Form 19 (for EPF withdrawal) and Form 10C (for EPS withdrawal or certificate of service) on the EPFO member portal. TDS applies on the employer's contribution and interest if total service is less than five years. Second, they can transfer the balance to the new employer's PF trust using Form 13, which preserves the tax-exempt status and continuity of service for gratuity and EPS purposes. Third, they can leave the balance in the existing account, where it continues to earn interest for up to 36 months after the last contribution before being classified as inoperative.

The company strongly recommends that employees transfer their PF balance to the new employer's trust rather than withdrawing it on resignation, particularly for employees with less than five years of service, since premature withdrawal attracts TDS and permanently reduces the long-term retirement corpus. HR will assist employees who need guidance on the transfer process.

PF-Related Action	How to Do It	Timeline	Key Notes
Activate UAN	Visit epfindia.gov.in → Member Portal → Activate UAN	Within 30 days of joining	Required before any PF service is available online
Link KYC (Aadhaar, PAN, bank)	EPFO portal → Member → KYC	Within 30 days of joining	Mandatory for claim processing and online transfe
Check PF balance	EPFO portal or UMANG mobile app	Anytime	Updated monthly after employer's remittance.
Transfer PF on new joining	EPFO portal → Online Services → One Member – One EPF Account (Transfer Request)	Within 90 days of joining	Previous employer must approve the reques
Withdraw PF on resignation	EPFO portal → Online Services → Claim (Form 19 / Form 10C)	After 2 months of unemployment	Withdrawal before 5 years of total service attracts
Check EPS pension eligibility	Contact HR or EPFO grievance portal	Retirement (age 58)	Minimum 10 years of EPS contribution required fo

4.9 Gratuity — Employee Guide

Beyond the statutory summary in Section 4.4, this section addresses the questions employees most commonly ask about gratuity. The five-year minimum service requirement is the most important threshold. Employees who resign just before completing five years receive no gratuity, while employees who complete exactly five years are fully entitled. Because of the cliff at the five-year mark, employees approaching this threshold should factor it carefully into any resignation timing decision.

The following worked example illustrates the calculation for a mid-career employee:

Variable	Value	Notes
Last drawn Basic Salary	■60,000/month	This is the Basic Salary component only — not total gross salary.
Years of service	8 years 7 months	Rounds up to 9 completed years (7 months > 6 months).
Calculation	(■60,000 ÷ 26) × 15 × 9	= ■2,307.69 × 15 × 9 = ■3,11,538
Tax treatment	Fully exempt (below ■20L cap)	Payable within 30 days of the last working day.

Gratuity forfeiture is permitted under the Act only in specific circumstances: where the employee's service has been terminated due to wilful omission or negligence that has caused financial loss or damage to the employer, or due to riotous, disorderly, or violent behaviour. Forfeiture must follow a prescribed legal process and cannot be applied unilaterally. Employees who separate voluntarily by resignation are always entitled to gratuity if the five-year threshold has been met.

4.10 Employee Stock Option Plan (ESOP)

Arjun Technologies maintains an Employee Stock Option Plan as a long-term incentive for senior contributors and identified high-potential employees. ESOPs are designed to align the interests of key individuals with the company's long-term growth objectives by allowing them to become financial participants in the company's equity appreciation.

ESOP grants are made annually at the discretion of the Compensation Committee, which comprises the CEO, CFO, and the two independent board directors. Grants are typically made in May, following the completion of the annual performance cycle. Employees at Band 4 and

above are generally eligible. Employees at Band 2 and 3 identified as high-potential through the annual performance process and recommended by their SVP may also receive grants. Receiving a grant in one year creates no entitlement or expectation of a grant in subsequent years.

The exercise price for each grant is set at the fair market value of the company's equity shares as determined by an independent valuer at the time of grant, using the discounted cash flow method. Options vest over a four-year period with a one-year cliff: no options vest during the first year, 25 percent vest at the end of year one, and the remaining 75 percent vest ratably on a monthly basis over years two through four.

Separation Scenario	Treatment of Vested Options	Treatment of Unvested Options
Voluntary resignation	May be exercised within 90 days of last working day	Lapse on the last working day.
Termination without cause	May be exercised within 90 days of last working day	Lapse on the last working day.
Termination for gross misconduct	Lapse immediately.	Lapse immediately.
Death during employment	All unvested options vest immediately and may be exercised by nominee or legal representative within	
Permanent disability	All unvested options vest immediately. Exercise window: 12 months.	Shadow vesting — all unvested vest.
Retirement at normal retirement age	May be exercised within 12 months of retirement date.	Unvested options lapse unless the Compensation Co

The full ESOP Scheme Document, covering exercise procedures, lock-up periods, company buyback rights, anti-dilution provisions, and the full tax treatment at each stage of grant, vesting, exercise, and sale, is available from Finance and Legal. Employees receiving an ESOP grant are strongly encouraged to seek independent tax advice before exercising options, as the perquisite tax (payable at exercise on the spread between FMV and exercise price) and subsequent capital gains tax (payable at sale) can be material and require careful planning.

4.11 Employee Assistance Programme (EAP)

Arjun Technologies provides a comprehensive Employee Assistance Programme to all employees — confirmed and probationary — and to their immediate family members. The EAP is delivered by an independent, specialist third-party service provider and offers confidential support for mental health, workplace stress, personal and family difficulties, financial concerns, and legal queries. The company has no visibility into individual usage of the EAP and no access to session content, notes, or outcomes at any individual level.

Under the programme, each employee is entitled to up to six structured counselling or advisory sessions per calendar year at no cost. Sessions are available in person at the EAP provider's offices in Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Pune, Chennai, and Mumbai; by video call; or by telephone, based on the employee's preference. A 24/7 telephonic helpline is also available for immediate support in crisis situations. The helpline number is available on the company intranet.

The EAP is accessible through eap.arjuntech.in, through the HR portal, or by calling the dedicated helpline. Employees access the service directly and are not required to notify HR or their manager before or after using the EAP. Family members of employees may contact the EAP provider directly without involving the company. The company encourages employees to treat the EAP as a routine preventive resource — for stress management, communication coaching, or financial planning — rather than only as an emergency resource.

All EAP interactions are protected by strict professional confidentiality. The service provider is contractually prohibited from disclosing any information about individual usage to Arjun Technologies, except where a counsellor is required by law or professional ethics to report a risk of serious harm to the employee or to another identified person. No use of the EAP will have any effect on an employee's performance records, employment status, promotion prospects, or any other aspect of their employment.

4.12 Flexible Benefit Plan (FBP)

The Flexible Benefit Plan provides each confirmed employee with ■18,000 per year to allocate across a defined menu of approved benefit categories. The election must be made at the beginning of the financial year — typically by 15 April — through the HRMS portal under Payroll → FBP. Once submitted, the election is irrevocable for that financial year. Employees who do not submit an election by the deadline will receive the full ■18,000 as taxable Special Allowance.

The FBP is designed to allow employees to optimise their compensation structure for their personal tax situation. Each category carries different tax treatment, and the tax benefit available to each employee depends on their individual circumstances — whether they pay rent, whether they have qualifying medical expenses, their use of a personal phone for work, and their NPS participation.

Category	Maximum Allocation	Tax Treatment	Proof Required	Key Conditions
Leave Travel Allowance	Full ■18,000	Exempt up to declared amount with proof	Original boarding passes or travel tickets	Covers 2 domestic journeys per 4-year LT
Medical Reimbursement	Up to ■15,000	Exempt with valid medical bills	Original bills from registered hospitals or pharmacies	Employee, spouse, and dependent children
Telephone / Internet Allowance	Up to ■12,000	Exempt with utility bills	Monthly bills in the employee's name	Mobile phone or home broadband bills on
NPS Contribution (Tier I)	Up to ■18,000	Exempt under Sec. 80CCD(2) — over and above the ■1.5 L cap	PRAN statement confirming contribution	Employer-matched additional NPS contribution ur
Unallocated balance	Any remaining amount	Fully taxable as Special Allowance	None	Default for employees who do not submit

Claims against the LTA and Medical Reimbursement categories must be submitted with supporting original documents through the HRMS expense module within 30 days of incurring the expense and no later than 31 March of the financial year. Claims submitted after 31 March of the year to which they relate cannot be processed and the allocated amount will be paid as taxable income. Original bills — not scanned copies or digital receipts — are required for all categories.

4.13 Employee Referral Programme

The Employee Referral Programme incentivises employees to refer qualified professionals from their networks for open permanent positions at Arjun Technologies. Employee referrals consistently produce candidates with higher offer acceptance rates, stronger cultural fit, and longer average tenure than candidates from other sourcing channels. The programme applies exclusively to positions that are actively listed as open on the HRMS internal job portal.

To be eligible for a referral bonus, the referring employee must register the referral through the HRMS Referral module — or by emailing the Talent Acquisition team with the candidate's details — before the candidate applies through any channel. A referral registered after the candidate has already applied independently is not eligible for the bonus. The referring employee must still be employed by the company on each payment date to receive the applicable payment tranche.

Role Band	Role Level	Total Bonus	Payment Structure	Conditions
Band 1–2	Associate / Engineer / Analyst	₹20,000	₹10,000 on joining + ₹10,000 on 90 days of employment	Referred employee must complete 90 days.
Band 3–4	Senior / Lead / Principal	₹40,000	₹20,000 on joining + ₹20,000 on 90 days	Same conditions as above.
Band 5	Manager / Associate Director	₹75,000	₹37,500 on joining + ₹37,500 on 90 days	Same conditions as above.
Band 6+	Director and above	₹1,00,000	₹50,000 on joining + ₹50,000 on 90 days	Same conditions as above.
Critical Skills	Any band — HR-designated	₹1,25,000	₹62,500 on joining + ₹62,500 on 90 days	Critical skill designation confirmed by HR at t

Referral bonuses are fully taxable in the hands of the referring employee and are subject to TDS at the applicable rate. The bonus is processed through payroll and reflected in the payslip for the payment month. Self-referrals are not eligible. Referrals of immediate family members — spouse, children, parents, or siblings — are not eligible. Referrals by a manager of a candidate for a direct report role in their own team are not eligible, as this creates a conflict of interest in the hiring process.

5. Leave Policy

The leave policy of Arjun Technologies is designed to provide employees with meaningful time for rest, personal responsibilities, health, and family while maintaining the operational continuity that our clients expect. Leave entitlements are generous relative to industry norms and reflect the company's genuine commitment to employee wellbeing.

The leave year runs from 1 April to 31 March, aligned with the Indian financial year. All leave must be applied for and approved through the HRMS portal. Leave taken without an approved HRMS application will be treated as Leave Without Pay regardless of any informal communication with the manager. Salary is deducted accordingly for all LWP periods.

The following principles apply to all leave categories unless a specific provision states otherwise: leave entitlements are personal and cannot be transferred to another employee; managers must respond to applications within two working days; applications not actioned within five working days are automatically approved by HRMS; leave running concurrently with a public holiday does not consume leave credit for the public holiday date; and employees who fall ill during an approved EL period may convert the sick days to Sick Leave on submission of a medical certificate.

5.1 Leave Summary Reference

The following table provides a consolidated summary of all leave types available at Arjun Technologies. Detailed provisions for each type follow in the subsections below.

Leave Type	Annual Entitlement	Accrual Basis	Carry Forward	Max Balance	Encashable	Probation Eligib
Earned Leave (EL)	18 days	1.5 days per month from confirmation date	Yes	45 days	Yes — 2x per year, max 10 days each	No
Casual Leave (CL)	8 days	Full credit on 1 April	No	Forfeited 31 Mar	No	Yes
Sick Leave (SL)	12 days	Full credit on 1 April	Yes	30 days cumulative	No	Yes
Maternity Leave	Per entitlement schedule	N/A	N/A	N/A	No	Statutory minimum c
Paternity Leave	10 working days	N/A	No (use within 90 days)	N/A	No	Yes
Bereavement Leave	2 to 5 days by relation	N/A	No	N/A	No	Yes
Marriage Leave	3 days — once per career	N/A	No	N/A	No	No (min. 6 months s
Study / Exam Leave	5 days per year	N/A	No	N/A	No	No
Sabbatical Leave	1–3 months (unpaid)	N/A	N/A	N/A	No	No (min. 5 years ser
Compensatory Off	Per public holiday worked	N/A	Yes — within 45 days	N/A	Yes — if not availed	Yes
Voting Leave	Half day per election	N/A	No	N/A	No	Yes
Leave Without Pay	As approved	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	Limited

5.2 Earned Leave — Detailed Provisions

Earned Leave is the primary paid vacation entitlement and represents the most significant leave benefit in terms of days available and financial value. Confirmed employees accrue EL at 1.5 days per completed calendar month of service from the confirmation date, totalling 18 days per full leave year. For an employee confirmed on 1 April, they will have a full 18-day balance by the following 31 March. For an employee confirmed on 1 October, they will accrue nine days of EL by 31 March of the same leave year.

EL does not accrue during the probationary period, during any period of Leave Without Pay, during any period of unauthorised or unexplained absence that has not been converted to an approved leave category, or during any period of suspension pending a disciplinary investigation. EL continues to accrue normally during all periods of approved paid leave, including maternity leave and sick leave, so that employees are not penalised for absences covered by other provisions.

Planned EL applications must be submitted through HRMS with advance notice as follows: a minimum of five working days' notice for leave of up to five consecutive working days; and a minimum of ten working days' notice for leave exceeding five consecutive days. These notice requirements exist to allow operational coverage planning, not as barriers to taking leave. Where the work context allows shorter notice, managers are encouraged to be flexible. Emergency EL applications with less than 24 hours' notice require manager approval and a brief explanation in the HRMS application.

Managers must respond to EL applications within two working days. Applications not actioned within five working days are automatically approved by HRMS. A manager may defer — but not deny — EL where the requested timing creates a genuine operational conflict such as a client go-live, a critical delivery milestone, or a coverage gap that cannot be resolved. A deferral must be communicated in writing through HRMS, must state the specific reason, and must offer an alternative period within the same quarter.

Unused EL may be carried forward to the next leave year up to a maximum balance of 45 days. Any balance above 45 days as of 31 March is forfeited unless the employee has exercised the encashment option. EL encashment is permitted twice per year during Finance-published windows in April and October. A maximum of 10 days may be encashed per event. The encashment calculation is: (Annual Basic Salary ÷ 12 ÷ 26) × number of days to be encashed. Encashment proceeds are subject to TDS and are processed with the payroll for the relevant month.

On separation for any reason — resignation, retirement, redundancy, termination, or death — all accrued EL standing to the employee's credit on the last working day is encashed in full as part of the Full and Final Settlement. There is no cap on the EL encashment amount at separation. The calculation uses the employee's basic salary rate on the last working day.

5.3 Casual Leave — Detailed Provisions

Casual Leave is for short, unplanned, or low-notice absences arising from personal or domestic circumstances that do not constitute illness. Eight days are credited in full on 1 April each year. Employees joining during the financial year receive a pro-rated credit based on the remaining complete months in the leave year from their joining month.

CL may not be taken for more than three consecutive working days in a single application. If an employee requires more than three consecutive days of absence that does not qualify as sick leave, Earned Leave should be used. CL may not be combined with EL to create an unbroken absence exceeding five working days without the specific written approval of the manager and HR Business Partner.

For unplanned CL, the employee must inform their line manager by 9:30 AM on the day of absence, by phone or the designated messaging channel. The HRMS application must be submitted on the day the employee returns to work. Failure to notify the manager on the day of absence, or failure to submit the HRMS application on return, results in the absence being classified as Leave Without Pay regardless of whether CL balance is available.

Unused CL is forfeited on 31 March each year without exception. It cannot be carried forward, converted to EL or any other leave type, or encashed under any circumstances. Employees who consistently accumulate a large CL balance at year-end are encouraged to plan their use of CL throughout the year rather than concentrating it in the final weeks, which creates operational planning difficulties for teams.

5.4 Sick Leave — Detailed Provisions

Sick Leave covers absences arising from the employee's own illness, injury, medical procedure, or medical appointment. Twelve days are credited in full on 1 April each year. Unused SL carries forward to a maximum cumulative balance of 30 days. SL is not encashable and is not paid out on separation for any reason.

A self-declaration is sufficient for SL of up to three consecutive working days. For SL exceeding three consecutive working days, the employee must submit a medical certificate from a registered medical practitioner (MBBS or above) to HR within two working days of returning to work. The certificate must state: the date(s) of consultation; the nature of illness or that details are confidential at the patient's request; the period of incapacity certified; and the doctor's full name, qualification, and registration number.

For SL likely to extend beyond five working days, the employee must proactively inform their line manager and HR Business Partner by the third day of absence to allow coverage arrangements to be made. Where an employee's illness may require extended leave that will exhaust their SL balance, HR will discuss options with the employee including conversion of the excess to EL,

Leave Without Pay, or — where applicable — support under the group health insurance or ESI scheme.

The company supports employees experiencing chronic illness, mental health conditions, or serious medical treatment. Employees dealing with such conditions are encouraged to speak with HR confidentially to explore all available support options, including flexible working adjustments, a phased return-to-work plan, or EAP counselling, well before leave balances are exhausted.

5.5 Maternity Leave

Maternity leave is provided in full compliance with the Maternity Benefit (Amendment) Act, 2017 and in some respects exceeds the statutory minimum. The leave is fully paid at the employee's last drawn gross salary for the entire entitlement period. The company's commitment is to support employees through childbirth and early parenthood without financial penalty.

Circumstance	Entitlement	Payment	Advance Notice Required
First or second live birth	26 weeks (182 calendar days)	Fully paid at last drawn gross salary	8 weeks before expected delivery date (where p
Third or subsequent live birth	12 weeks (84 calendar days)	Fully paid	8 weeks before expected delivery date
Adoption of a child below 3 months of age	12 weeks from adoption date	Fully paid	As early as possible after the adoption decision
Commissioning mother (surrogacy)	12 weeks from date of birth	Fully paid	As early as possible after the surrogacy arrange
Miscarriage or medical termination	6 weeks from the date of the event	Fully paid	Medical certificate required
Tubectomy or sterilisation procedure	2 weeks from the date of the procedure	Fully paid	Medical certificate required
Premature birth or NICU admission	Up to 4 additional weeks with HR approval	Fully paid for approved extension	NICU admission documentation required

Maternity leave counts as continuous service for all purposes — including EL accrual, gratuity calculation, and performance assessment. An employee on maternity leave receives an annual performance rating for the year based on the portion of the year during which she was working; the leave period itself neither positively nor negatively affects the rating.

Upon return from maternity leave, the employee is entitled to return to the same role, at the same level and compensation, with the same reporting structure that existed before the leave commenced. If the specific role has been eliminated during the leave period for legitimate business reasons, an equivalent role at the same level and compensation must be offered. The company will not make a role redundant specifically because the role-holder is on maternity leave.

Two paid nursing breaks of 15 minutes each are provided per working day for six months following return from maternity leave, as required by the Maternity Benefit Act. These breaks are in addition to the standard one-hour lunch break. A dedicated nursing room is available at the Bengaluru, Hyderabad, and Pune offices. At Chennai and Mumbai, employees should contact HR to arrange suitable accommodation.

5.6 Paternity Leave

Male employees and same-sex partners are entitled to 10 working days of fully paid paternity leave per birth or adoption event. The leave must be availed within 90 calendar days of the date of birth or the legal date of adoption. It may be split into a maximum of two separate periods, with each period comprising not fewer than three consecutive working days. It cannot be carried forward beyond the 90-day window, converted to any other leave type, or encashed.

The paternity leave entitlement is per birth or adoption event and renews on each occasion. It is not a one-time lifetime entitlement. Same-sex partners and adoptive parents must provide HR with documentation confirming the birth or the legal date of adoption. The company does not discriminate in the application of this benefit on the basis of the gender composition of the employee's family.

5.7 Bereavement Leave

Arjun Technologies provides paid bereavement leave to allow employees to attend to the immediate practical and emotional demands of loss without having to use their vacation entitlement. The table below sets out the entitlements by relationship:

Relationship	Entitlement	Additional EL Available on Request	Documentation
Spouse or registered domestic partner	5 working days	Up to 5 additional EL days	Death certificate within 10 working days of return.
Child (biological, adopted, or step-child)	5 working days	Up to 5 additional EL days	Death certificate within 10 working days of return.
Parent or step-parent	5 working days	Up to 3 additional EL days	Death certificate on request.
Parent-in-law or step parent-in-law	3 working days	Up to 2 additional EL days	None required.
Sibling (biological or adopted)	3 working days	EL as needed	None required.
Grandparent	2 working days	EL as needed	None required.
Close personal friend or extended relative	Up to 1 day — manager's discretion	CL or EL as needed	None required.

Managers are expected to approach all bereavement matters with genuine sensitivity and human compassion. The entitlements in the table above are the guaranteed minimums — they are not ceilings. Where an employee needs additional time and has leave available, managers should approve its use generously. Grief does not follow a predictable schedule, and the company's response to bereavement should reflect this.

5.8 Public Holidays

Arjun Technologies observes a minimum of 10 mandatory public holidays per year across all office locations, plus two optional restricted holidays that each employee selects from a list published annually by HR. The holiday calendar for each financial year is published on the HRMS portal by 15 January. Restricted holiday applications must be submitted through HRMS at least two working days in advance and are subject to manager approval.

#	Holiday	FY 2024-25 Date	Category	BLR	HYD	PNE	CHN	MUM
1	Ugadi / Gudi Padwa	9 April 2024	Mandatory — State	✓	✓	✓	—	✓
2	Good Friday	29 March / 18 Apr	Mandatory — National	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
3	May Day	1 May 2024	Mandatory — National	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
4	Independence Day	15 August 2024	Mandatory — National	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
5	Ganesh Chaturthi	7 September 2024	Mandatory — State	—	—	✓	—	✓
6	Gandhi Jayanti	2 October 2024	Mandatory — National	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
7	Dussehra	12 October 2024	Mandatory — National	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
8	Diwali	1 November 2024	Mandatory — National	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
9	Christmas Day	25 December 2024	Mandatory — National	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
10	Republic Day	26 January 2025	Mandatory — National	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
11	Holi	14 March 2025	Mandatory — National	✓	✓	✓	—	✓
R1	Eid-ul-Fitr	Per lunar calendar	Restricted (Optional)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R2	Eid-ul-Adha	Per lunar calendar	Restricted (Optional)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R3	Milad-un-Nabi	Per lunar calendar	Restricted (Optional)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R4	Guru Nanak Jayanti	Per lunar calendar	Restricted (Optional)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R5	Muharram	Per lunar calendar	Restricted (Optional)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R6	Baisakhi	Per lunar calendar	Restricted (Optional)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R7	Christmas Eve	24 December 2024	Restricted (Optional)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R8	Maha Shivratri	Per lunar calendar	Restricted (Optional)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R9	Onam	Per lunar calendar	Restricted (Optional)	—	—	✓	—	—
R10	Navratri (one day)	Per lunar calendar	Restricted (Optional)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

5.9 Compensatory Off

An employee who is required by their manager to work on a declared public holiday is entitled to a Compensatory Off day. The Comp-Off must be availed within 45 calendar days of the date on which the holiday was worked. If the Comp-Off cannot be availed within 45 days due to operational requirements confirmed in writing by the manager, the employee may opt for encashment at the basic salary daily rate (Basic Salary ÷ 26) in lieu. Working on a public holiday must be pre-approved by the manager before the holiday and recorded in HRMS.

Comp-Off does not accrue automatically for routine late-evening work or occasional weekend effort to meet a project deadline. Comp-Off is specifically for working a full eight-hour day on a designated public holiday with explicit manager approval. Employees who work on weekends as a routine part of a shift schedule have separate rotational off-day arrangements managed through their team calendar, not through the Comp-Off mechanism.

5.10 Marriage Leave

Employees are entitled to three working days of fully paid marriage leave for their own wedding. This is a once-in-a-career entitlement — it does not renew on remarriage. To be eligible, the employee must have a minimum of six months of continuous service at the time the leave is availed. Marriage leave must be applied through HRMS at least two weeks in advance, and documentation confirming the marriage (a marriage certificate or invitation) may be requested by HR after the event.

Marriage leave may be combined with Earned Leave or Casual Leave to extend the period of absence, subject to manager approval and available leave balance. Marriage leave cannot be carried forward, converted to any other leave type, or encashed if not availed.

5.11 Study and Examination Leave

Employees who are enrolled in a part-time degree programme or a professional certification course that is relevant to their role may apply for up to five working days per year to attend formal examinations. The leave is paid. It does not apply to self-paced online courses without proctored examinations. The application must be submitted through HRMS with the examination schedule from the institution or examining body at least ten working days before the examination date.

HR approval is required and will be granted only where the course or certification is demonstrably relevant to the employee's current role or their documented development goals in their IDP. Study leave does not carry forward, cannot be converted to other leave types, and cannot be encashed if not availed in the year it is allocated.

5.12 Sabbatical Leave

Employees who have completed at least five years of continuous service may apply for a sabbatical of between one and three months. Sabbatical leave is unpaid. It may be taken for purposes including extended self-directed education, a structured academic programme, full-time voluntary service with a recognised not-for-profit organisation, or a significant personal development objective. Sabbaticals are not approved for commercial activities, secondary employment, or purposes that are incompatible with the employee's obligations to the company.

Applications require a minimum of three months' advance notice and must be submitted to the HR Business Partner with a description of the intended purpose and duration. Approval requires endorsement from the line manager, the business unit head, and the VP-HR. The business unit head may decline a sabbatical application where operational circumstances make the employee's absence impractical at the requested time, in which case an alternative timing may be proposed.

The company will make reasonable efforts to hold the employee's role or an equivalent role open during the sabbatical, but cannot guarantee the same position upon return where organisational changes occur during the leave period. Benefits continue for the duration of a sabbatical of up to 30 days. For sabbaticals exceeding 30 days, the employee is required to pay the employer's share of insurance premiums to maintain coverage during the unpaid period.

5.13 Leave Without Pay

Leave Without Pay may be approved when an employee has exhausted all applicable paid leave balances and requires additional time away from work. It is not a mechanism for extending vacation entitlement — it is a provision for genuine circumstances where no paid leave remains. LWP does not count toward continuous service for gratuity purposes, and EL does not accrue during periods of LWP.

LWP of up to five consecutive working days requires line manager approval with HRBP acknowledgement. LWP of six to thirty consecutive days requires HRBP approval. LWP exceeding thirty consecutive days requires VP-HR approval and business unit head endorsement. Group health insurance coverage continues during LWP of up to thirty days at no cost to the employee. For LWP exceeding thirty days, the employee must pay the employer's share of the insurance premium to maintain coverage.

LWP periods of more than 30 working days in a single leave year may affect the employee's annual performance rating for that year, since a material portion of the assessment period will not have generated observable performance data. HR will discuss the approach to rating with the manager and the employee in such cases to ensure fairness.

5.14 Voting and Civic Leave

Employees are entitled to a paid half-day of leave to vote in national or state elections, provided that the polling station to which the employee is assigned is not within one kilometre of their office location. The employee must inform their manager in advance and may be asked to show their voter identity card. Leave applications for voting are processed through HRMS and must be submitted at least two working days before the election date.

Attendance at jury or court duty that is legally mandated is fully paid for the duration required by the relevant court order. The employee must provide the court summons or duty notice to HR as soon as it is received, and must provide a copy of the court attendance certificate on return. Employees are expected to return to work on any day during a legally required court attendance on which they are not required to be present at court.

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EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

Segment 3 of 5 — Performance, Development & Employee Relations

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This segment covers Section 6 (Performance and Development) and Section 7 (Employee Relations) of the Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd. Employee Handbook. It is classified as Internal Use Only. The current version of all segments is available on the HRMS portal under Policies and Documents.

6. Performance and Development

The Performance Management Framework at Arjun Technologies is the primary mechanism through which the organisation aligns individual effort with strategic objectives, recognises and rewards strong contribution, supports professional development, and addresses underperformance in a structured and fair manner. It is built on the conviction that people perform best when they understand clearly what is expected of them, receive honest and timely feedback on how they are doing, and are actively supported in growing their capabilities.

The framework rests on three principles that are non-negotiable in their application. Clarity: every employee knows, before the year begins, what success in their role looks like for that year — not in general terms, but in specific, measurable terms that both the employee and manager can refer to unambiguously throughout the year. Continuity: performance conversations happen throughout the year in a structured cadence, not only at the annual review — because feedback given in October is actionable, whereas feedback given in March is merely retrospective. Consequence: performance outcomes are meaningfully connected to compensation, career progression, and — where necessary — remediation, so that the framework drives real behaviour and real decisions rather than serving as an administrative formality.

This section describes the full annual performance cycle, the goal-setting methodology, the rating scale, the compensation consequences of each rating, and the support structures available to employees at every performance level. Section 6.9 addresses the Performance Improvement Plan process for employees who are not meeting expectations. Section 6.10 through 6.12 address the development and growth dimensions of the framework.

6.1 The Annual Performance Cycle

The performance year runs from 1 April to 31 March, aligned with the financial year. The cycle has seven defined phases, each with specific activities, accountabilities, and HRMS deadlines. All phases are mandatory and their completion is tracked by HR. Managers who do not meet their phase obligations without a documented reason are escalated to the relevant business unit head.

Phase	Timing	Key Activities	HRMS Deadline	Accountable Party
1. Goal Setting	April, Weeks 1–4	Employee drafts OKRs. Manager reviews, challenges, and agrees. Goals are entered and locked in H	30 April	Employee + Manager
2. Quarterly Pulse	July, October, January	Informal 20-minute progress check. No formal documentation required unless concerns arise.	None	Manager
3. Mid-Year Review	October	Structured progress conversation. Goal revision if warranted. Feedback entered in HRMS.	31 October	Employee + Manager
4. Self-Assessment	February	Employee completes written self-assessment in HRMS against each OKR, with supporting evidenc	28 February	Employee
5. Manager Assessment	March, Weeks 1–2	Manager completes independent assessment. Calibration session held across all managers in the	14 March	Manager + HR
6. Appraisal Conversation	March, Weeks 3–4	Manager communicates rating with written narrative. Development plan reviewed and updated.	31 March	Manager
7. Merit & Variable Pay	April	Increment letters issued through HRMS. Variable pay disbursed with April salary.	15 April	HR + Finance

The sequence of these phases is deliberate. Goal setting comes first so that the entire year operates against agreed, documented standards — not against retrospective expectations. The mid-year review comes at exactly the halfway point so that, where performance is off track, there is an equal amount of year remaining to course-correct. The self-assessment comes before the manager assessment so that the manager must read and consider the employee's perspective before finalising their own view — not after.

6.2 Goal Setting Using the OKR Framework

Goals at Arjun Technologies are set using the OKR (Objectives and Key Results) framework. The framework distinguishes between Objectives — what the employee intends to achieve — and Key Results — the specific, measurable evidence that the Objective has been achieved. Each employee sets between three and five Objectives per year. Each Objective has between two and four Key Results. Goals must be submitted in HRMS and agreed with the manager by 30 April.

An Objective is a qualitative, directional statement of intent. It should answer the question: what significant outcome will I deliver this year that creates real value for my team, my clients, or the business? A good Objective is ambitious but achievable, meaningful to the employee and the organisation, and expressible in a single clear sentence without numbers. A bad Objective reads like a job description ('deliver quality software') rather than a statement of intent for the year ('make our payment service the most reliable in the platform').

A Key Result is a quantitative, time-bound, and binary measure of success against an Objective. It should answer the question: how will I know — objectively and unambiguously — whether I have achieved this Objective? A good Key Result is specific, uses a clear metric, has a defined target value, and is either achieved or not at year-end — there should be no room for debate about whether it was met. A bad Key Result is vague ('improve code quality'), unmeasurable ('do better'), or trivially achievable ('complete all assigned tasks').

Role	Example Objective	Example Key Results
Senior Engineer	Make the payment service the most reliable API in the platform	1. Reduce P1 incidents from 12 to fewer than 4 per quarter. 2. Achieve sustained 99.95% uptime on the payment endpoint. 3. Implement automated regression testing coverage above 90% for all payment flows
HR Business Partner	Build a consistently high-quality engineering talent pipeline	1. Reduce average time-to-hire for Band 3+ roles from 65 to under 45 days. 2. Maintain offer acceptance rate at or above 80%. 3. Achieve 90-day onboarding satisfaction score of 4.2 out of 5 or above.
Product Manager	Launch the mobile application with strong initial user adoption	1. Achieve 10,000 active users within 30 days of public launch. 2. Maintain App Store rating at or above 4.4 through the first full quarter. 3. Deliver launch with zero critical-severity defects in the first two weeks post-release.
DevOps Engineer	Eliminate all manual steps from the production deployment process	1. Reduce deployment time from 45 minutes to under 10 minutes. 2. Achieve 100% automated production deployments with no manual intervention. 3. Reduce deployment failure rate from 8% to below 2%.

Role	Example Objective	Example Key Results
Account Manager	Deepen relationships and expand revenue within our Tier 1 accounts	1. Grow annual Tier 1 revenue from Tier 1 clients by 20% year-on-year. 2. Achieve Net Promoter Score of 50 or above across all Tier 1 accounts. 3. Successfully introduce at least one new service line to each of the top five accounts

The most common OKR writing mistakes are: setting activities as Key Results rather than outcomes ('conduct 10 client calls per month' instead of 'achieve client satisfaction score above 4.5'); setting too many Objectives and spreading effort too thin; writing Key Results that are not actually measurable; and setting targets that are so comfortable that a rating of 3 would require essentially no stretch. A good rule of thumb is that a Key Result should feel slightly uncomfortable when written — if the employee is certain they will achieve it, it is not ambitious enough.

Goals may be revised during the year — but only in response to a genuine material change in business direction, team structure, or external circumstances, not simply because the original target has become difficult to achieve. Goal revisions require documentation in HRMS and the agreement of both the manager and the employee. The mid-year review in October is the natural checkpoint for assessing whether any goals require revision. Revisions outside the mid-year window require a documented business justification.

6.3 Mid-Year Review

The October mid-year review is a structured, documented conversation between the employee and manager. No rating is assigned at this stage — the purpose is to provide substantive, actionable feedback at the midpoint of the year, when the employee still has six months to act on it. Research on performance management consistently shows that the mid-year review, when conducted with genuine care and specificity, is a more powerful driver of year-end performance than the annual appraisal itself.

The recommended agenda for the mid-year conversation is structured to cover five areas: a progress review against each OKR with specific evidence (30 minutes); an acknowledgement of specific strengths and contributions observed during the first half of the year (15 minutes); a focused discussion of one or two development areas where improvement in the second half would make the most difference (15 minutes); a goal revision discussion where circumstances have genuinely changed (15 minutes if needed); and a discussion of what the employee needs from the manager or the organisation to succeed in the second half (15 minutes).

The manager must document the key points of the mid-year conversation in the HRMS Performance module by 31 October. The documentation does not need to be extensive — a clear paragraph summarising the progress assessment, the strengths noted, and the development priorities for the second half is sufficient. The documentation creates a record that prevents both the employee and manager from later characterising the year-end assessment as

a surprise, and provides useful continuity context for the year-end assessment.

6.4 Year-End Assessment and Ratings

The year-end assessment culminates in a formal performance rating that drives all compensation and career decisions for the following year. The rating reflects the employee's performance against their agreed OKRs, their demonstration of the required competencies for their band, and their conduct in relation to the company's values throughout the year. It is a holistic assessment, not a mechanical arithmetic calculation from OKR scores.

The self-assessment, submitted by the employee by 28 February, is the employee's own structured account of the year — their evidence for each goal, their reflection on what went well and what they would do differently, and their own view of where they sit on the rating scale. Managers are required to read the self-assessment carefully before completing their own assessment. A manager who consistently ignores or dismisses self-assessments without engagement is not applying the framework correctly.

The manager completes their assessment independently in HRMS by 14 March, prior to the calibration session. The assessment must include a written narrative for each major area of the employee's work — specific, evidence-based, and honest. Generic narratives ('performed well throughout the year') are not acceptable and will be returned by HR for revision. The narrative is the record that the employee receives and retains; it should be written with the care that a professional communication of this significance deserves.

Rating	Label	Expected Distribution	Typical Merit Range	Variable Pay Range	Mandatory Management Action
5	Exceptional	5% – 10% of employees	18% – 25%	110% – 130% of target	Retention conversation initiated within 2 weeks.
4	Exceeds Expectations	15% – 20%	12% – 18%	100% – 115% of target	Development plan updated. Formal promotion e
3	Meets Expectations	55% – 65%	6% – 12%	90% – 100% of target	Development plan updated. Standard career pr
2	Needs Improvement	10% – 15%	0% – 6%	50% – 80% of target	Performance Improvement Plan initiated within
1	Unsatisfactory	1% – 5%	0%	0%	PIP initiated immediately. Employment is at risk

A Rating 3 — Meets Expectations — is the expected outcome for a solid, effective, fully contributing employee. It is not a negative result. An employee who consistently receives Rating 3 is performing at the level the company needs and expects. The label 'Meets Expectations' is precise: the expectations are high, and meeting them is a meaningful achievement. Managers must communicate this clearly during appraisal conversations so that employees do not feel deflated by a rating that is actually a positive assessment.

The distribution percentages in the table above are indicative guidance, not enforced quotas. A team that has genuinely performed exceptionally well in a given year may have a higher-than-average proportion of Rating 4 and Rating 5 outcomes. Calibration is used to ensure consistency in how ratings are applied across different teams — not to force the

distribution into a fixed shape regardless of actual performance.

6.5 Calibration

The calibration session takes place in the second week of March, after all managers in a business unit have completed their individual assessments. The session is facilitated by the HR Business Partner and typically lasts two to three hours. Its purpose is to ensure that the same rating label means the same thing across all teams within the business unit — that a Rating 4 in the payments engineering team reflects the same standard as a Rating 4 in the data analytics team.

In the calibration session, each manager presents their proposed ratings for each direct report and the key evidence supporting each rating. The group reviews the overall distribution and discusses cases where a proposed rating appears inconsistent with the described performance — either because the evidence does not support the rating, or because the same standard would attract a different rating in another team. The session is not a negotiation where managers trade ratings for political reasons. It is a quality assurance process designed to produce fair and defensible assessments.

The following calibration principles are applied consistently:

1. Ratings must be based on specific, observable evidence — not on the manager's general impression of the employee's personality, attitude, or likability. If the manager cannot cite a specific example or data point to support a proposed rating, that is a signal that the rating needs more grounding.

2. The question in calibration is not 'is this a good person?' or 'do I like working with this person?' It is: 'did this person meet, exceed, or fall short of the specific goals and behavioural standards we agreed at the beginning of the year?'

3. Managers must be willing to advocate for their proposed ratings with specific evidence. Ratings that cannot be defended with concrete examples should be reconsidered, not defended on the basis of seniority or certainty.

4. Calibration is not an exercise in reducing high ratings to fit a predetermined distribution curve. If a team has genuinely had an exceptional year, calibration should confirm that — not artificially suppress it.

5. All discussions in the calibration session are strictly confidential. Managers must not share details of another manager's ratings, the distribution for the team, or the content of calibration discussions with their team members or with others outside the process.

6. The HR Business Partner has the authority to flag a proposed rating as requiring further discussion where it appears clearly inconsistent with the described performance, and in

exceptional circumstances to recommend an adjustment. Such adjustments are rare and are always discussed with the relevant manager before being applied.

6.6 Appraisal Conversation

The appraisal conversation is one of the most important professional conversations a manager has each year. Done well, it leaves the employee feeling accurately assessed, fully heard, clear about their path forward, and motivated for the year ahead. Done poorly, it erodes trust, creates resentment, and in some cases prompts an employee to begin looking for another role.

The most common mistake in appraisal conversations is communicating the rating first, before any review of the year. When an employee hears their rating, a significant portion of their cognitive focus in the minutes that follow is consumed by processing that information and comparing it to their own expectation. If the rating is lower than expected — even by one level — the employee may disengage from the substantive feedback that follows. Leading with a thoughtful review of the year, acknowledging specific achievements and discussing areas for growth, before communicating the rating, produces a significantly more productive and constructive conversation.

The appraisal conversation should cover the following areas in sequence: a review of the year by Objective, with specific acknowledgement of what went well and honest discussion of what fell short; communication of the rating with specific written rationale that the employee can refer to afterwards; genuine space for the employee's response, including the right to disagree — the manager should listen rather than defend; and a forward-looking discussion of the employee's development priorities, career goals, and the support the company will provide in the year ahead.

Employees who disagree with their rating after the appraisal conversation have the right to submit a formal written appeal through the HR Business Partner within ten working days of the rating being communicated. The appeal process is described in the Performance Management Framework standalone document available on the HR portal. An appeal does not delay the processing of merit increases or variable pay unless the outcome of the appeal could affect those amounts.

6.7 Merit Increases and Variable Pay

Merit increases are effective from 1 April and are reflected in the April payroll. Increment letters are issued through the HRMS portal in the first two weeks of April. The merit increase for each employee is determined by two inputs: the employee's performance rating and the employee's current position within the compensation band for their level. The intersection of these two inputs in the merit matrix determines the range from which the actual increment is drawn.

Band Position	Rating 1 (Unsat	Rating 2 (Needs Impro	Rating 3 (Meets)	Rating 4 (Exceeds)	Rating 5 (Excep
Below Band Midpoint	0%	2% – 4%	7% – 10%	12% – 16%	18% – 22%
At Band Midpoint	0%	1% – 3%	5% – 8%	10% – 14%	16% – 20%
Above Band Midpoint	0%	0% – 2%	3% – 6%	8% – 12%	14% – 18%
At Band Maximum	0%	0%	0% – 3%	4% – 8%	8% – 12%

The specific increment within the applicable range is determined by the line manager and HR, taking into account the quality and strength of the performance within the rating category, any market adjustments required to maintain the employee's competitiveness relative to the external market, and internal equity considerations within the team. Employees on a PIP at the time of the appraisal cycle receive a deferred merit decision pending the outcome of the PIP.

Variable pay is disbursed with the April salary. The final variable pay amount is calculated as the target variable percentage for the employee's band, multiplied by the individual performance multiplier corresponding to their rating, multiplied by the company financial performance factor approved by the Board based on the company's achievement against its financial targets for the year. In years where the company does not meet its minimum financial performance threshold, the company performance factor may reduce variable pay below the target, including to zero in exceptional circumstances.

Rating	Individual Performance Multiplier	Illustrative Variable Pay (target 12%, CTC ■20L)
5	1.15 – 1.30	■2,76,000 – ■3,12,000 (before company factor)
4	1.00 – 1.15	■2,40,000 – ■2,76,000 (before company factor)
3	0.90 – 1.00	■2,16,000 – ■2,40,000 (before company factor)
2	0.50 – 0.80	■1,20,000 – ■1,92,000 (before company factor)
1	0.00	■0

6.8 Promotions

A promotion is an increase in an employee's band level, accompanied by a change in role title, an increase in scope and responsibility, and a compensation adjustment to position the employee within the new band's market range. Promotions are not automatic on tenure, and they do not occur simply because an employee has performed well at their current level for several years. A promotion is a recognition that an employee is already performing at the next level — not a reward for strong performance at the current level.

The following criteria must all be met for a promotion to be approved. First, the employee must have been in their current band for a minimum of 18 months at the time of the promotion decision. Exceptions for shorter tenure require written approval from the VP-HR. Second, the employee must have received a rating of 4 or 5 in their most recent annual appraisal, or must have a demonstrable track record of strong performance over multiple consecutive years if a

rating of 3 is the most recent result. Third, the manager must be able to provide specific, concrete examples of the employee already performing at the responsibilities and impact level of the next band — not just at the upper end of the current band. Fourth, there must be a genuine business need for the employee to operate at the next band level; a promotion that is purely honorary or ceremonial, without a corresponding increase in the scope and accountability of the role, is not consistent with the framework. Fifth, the promotion must be endorsed in writing by both the line manager and the business unit head, and validated by HR to confirm it is consistent with the band framework, compensation structures, and internal equity within the team.

Promotions are processed as part of the annual performance cycle, effective 1 April. Off-cycle promotions are possible but require Finance approval for the mid-year compensation adjustment and are reserved for cases where there is an immediate, documented business need that cannot wait for the annual cycle — such as a significant increase in the scope of a role following a team restructure.

6.9 Performance Improvement Plans

A Performance Improvement Plan is a formal, time-bound document that sets specific and measurable improvement targets for an employee who is not meeting the performance expectations for their role and band. A PIP is not a disciplinary instrument — it is a structured support mechanism intended to give the employee the clarity, direction, and support needed to succeed. It is also, however, a formal record that the company has identified a performance gap, communicated it clearly, provided support, and set defined targets with consequences for non-achievement.

A PIP must be initiated within 30 days of a Rating 2 being communicated to the employee, and immediately upon a Rating 1. It is prepared by the line manager with the mandatory involvement of the HR Business Partner and must be reviewed and approved by the HRBP before it is shared with the employee. Under no circumstances should a manager present a PIP to an employee without HR having reviewed and approved the document first.

A well-constructed PIP contains the following six components:

1. **Section 1 — Performance Gap Description:** A specific, factual, and evidence-based description of the performance shortfall. This section must cite concrete examples with dates and observable behaviours. It must not contain opinions about the employee's character, attitude, or motivation. The standard is: would a reasonable, neutral third party reading this section understand exactly what the problem is and what evidence supports the assessment?

2. Section 2 — Required Improvement: The specific, measurable targets that the employee must achieve during the PIP period. Each target must have a clear metric and a clear threshold — the target is either met or not at the end of the PIP, with no ambiguity. Where possible, the same OKR structure used in the annual performance cycle should be applied.

3. Section 3 — Support and Resources: A description of the coaching, training, process changes, or additional resources the company will provide to support the employee in achieving the targets. A PIP that contains only demands and consequences, with no corresponding commitment of support from the company, is not a genuine improvement plan.

4. Section 4 — Review Schedule: A schedule of fortnightly check-in meetings between the manager, the HRBP, and the employee. Each check-in reviews progress against each specific target. The outcome of every check-in must be documented in HRMS within two working days.

5. Section 5 — Duration and Consequences: The standard PIP duration is 60 days for a Rating 2 and 90 days for a Rating 1. The PIP may be extended once by up to 30 days where genuine progress is evident but completion has not been fully achieved. The section must state clearly that failure to meet the improvement targets by the end of the PIP period may result in a change of role or the initiation of a separation process.

6. Section 6 — Employee Acknowledgement: The employee's signature confirming receipt and understanding of the PIP. Signing the PIP is not an agreement with its contents — it is confirmation of receipt. The employee may provide a written response to the PIP, which is attached to the document on file.

At the end of the PIP period, there are three possible outcomes. First, the PIP is completed successfully: all targets have been met and the employee returns to the standard performance management process. The PIP is recorded on file but does not automatically determine the employee's next annual rating. Second, the PIP is extended: meaningful progress is evident but completion has not been fully achieved, and one 30-day extension is approved by HR. Third, the PIP is not completed: the employee has not met the required targets by the PIP end date and no extension is warranted. HR will initiate a review of available options, which may include reassignment to a different role, voluntary resignation, or a managed separation process with appropriate notice.

6.10 Learning and Development

Every confirmed employee at Arjun Technologies receives an annual Learning and Development budget of ■25,000, available from the confirmation date and valid through 31

March of the financial year. The budget may be used for role-relevant online courses and learning platforms, professional certification examination fees, relevant technical or professional books and reference materials, industry conference registration fees, and professional association memberships. Reimbursement is processed through the HRMS expense module after manager approval and submission of original receipts.

The company's broader L&D; philosophy is grounded in the 70-20-10 model of professional development: 70 percent of the most durable learning occurs through on-the-job challenge and stretch assignments; 20 percent through coaching, mentoring, and peer collaboration; and 10 percent through structured formal training programmes, certifications, and courses. The annual L&D; budget supports the 10 percent formal component. The company's commitment to the 70 percent is expressed through stretch project assignments, cross-functional opportunities, and meaningful manager coaching. The 20 percent is supported through the internal learning programmes, the mentoring scheme, and team knowledge-sharing practices.

Structured internal learning programmes run throughout the year and include the following recurring formats: monthly TechTalks, which are 60-minute internal knowledge-sharing presentations by employees for employees on technical topics of broad interest; the Leadership Essentials Programme, a six-module cohort-based programme for employees becoming people managers for the first time; quarterly Engineering Excellence workshops covering system design, code quality, and emerging technology practice; and the annual L&D; Showcase, a half-day company-wide event where teams present the most impactful learning they have applied during the year.

6.11 Individual Development Plans

Every employee maintains an Individual Development Plan in the HRMS Performance module. The IDP is reviewed and updated annually as part of the performance cycle — typically at the appraisal conversation — and may be updated at any time during the year when the employee's goals or circumstances change. The IDP is not a bureaucratic form; it is the primary instrument through which the employee and manager sustain a shared understanding of where the employee is going in their career and what is needed to get there.

A complete IDP captures the following: the employee's career aspiration over the next two to three years; the current skill gaps between the employee's present capabilities and the capabilities required for that aspiration; the specific learning goals for the current year, tied wherever possible to concrete actions, courses, or project experiences; and the support the manager has committed to provide — coaching, introductions, project assignments, or other development-oriented actions.

IDP content informs several important decisions: the allocation of the employee's annual L&D; budget toward the most impactful development activities; the identification of stretch

assignments and internal mobility opportunities aligned to the employee's goals; and the company's medium-term succession and capability planning. Employees who do not maintain an active IDP are not eligible for priority consideration in internal mobility processes.

6.12 Internal Mobility

Arjun Technologies treats internal mobility as the primary mechanism for filling open positions with experienced talent and as a central pillar of the company's career development offer. All open permanent positions are posted on the HRMS internal job portal before or simultaneously with external posting, and internal candidates who meet the eligibility criteria receive priority consideration.

To apply for an internal position, the employee must have been in their current role for a minimum of 18 months and must have received a performance rating of 3 or above in their most recent annual appraisal. Employees currently on a PIP are not eligible for internal applications. Internal applications are treated confidentially. The employee is not required to inform their current manager before applying, though the company encourages transparency where the relationship permits it.

If an internal candidate is selected for a new role, HR coordinates a structured handover period of four to six weeks, during which the employee completes key in-progress work and transfers knowledge to their successor or manager. The employee's current manager is expected to support the transition constructively. Blocking or impeding an employee's internal move, or creating a hostile environment in response to an application, is a management conduct matter that HR will escalate.

7. Employee Relations

Arjun Technologies is committed to maintaining workplace relationships that are fair, respectful, transparent, and constructive at every level. This section describes the formal mechanisms available to employees who need to raise concerns, seek redress, or report misconduct — and the protections that exist for those who use them. The availability and quality of these mechanisms is itself a reflection of the kind of organisation the company aspires to be.

7.1 Grievance Redressal

The grievance redressal process provides employees with a structured, fair, and confidential mechanism for raising and resolving workplace concerns that have not been resolved through informal means. The process is designed on the principle that concerns should be resolved at the lowest appropriate level — informally if possible, formally when necessary, and with escalation available when earlier steps have not produced a satisfactory outcome.

The three-tier structure of the grievance process is as follows:

Tier	Process	Timeline	Who Handles It
Tier 1 — Informal	The employee raises the concern directly with their line manager in a private conversation. The concern is discussed openly and an attempt is made to resolve it	10 working days	Line manager
Tier 2 — Formal	If the concern has not been satisfactorily resolved at Tier 1, the employee submits a written grievance to the HR Business Partner	15 working days	HR Business Partner
Tier 3 — Escalation	If the employee is not satisfied with the Tier 2 determination, they may escalate the matter to the Head of HR within 5 working	10 working days	Head of HR

The timelines in the table above are the maximum permitted durations at each tier. Where a concern is straightforward, earlier resolution is expected. Where a concern involves complex factual questions or multiple parties, the timeline may be extended with the knowledge and agreement of the employee raising the concern. The employee will be informed of any extension and given a revised expected date for the determination.

All grievance proceedings are treated as confidential. Information about the substance of a grievance is shared only with those directly involved in resolving it. Managers or colleagues who are informed of a grievance through the process must not share that information with others or act against the employee raising the concern. Any person found to have breached grievance confidentiality will themselves be subject to disciplinary action.

An employee who raises a grievance in good faith is fully protected from any form of retaliation. The company treats retaliation — including exclusion from meetings, unfavourable work assignments, negative performance commentary, or any other adverse treatment connected to the grievance — as a serious disciplinary matter for the person responsible for the retaliation, regardless of the outcome of the grievance itself.

7.2 Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH)

Arjun Technologies is unconditionally committed to providing and maintaining a workplace that is entirely free from sexual harassment. Sexual harassment in any form — verbal, non-verbal, physical, visual, or digital — is strictly prohibited and will result in serious disciplinary action. This commitment is not merely a legal compliance position. It reflects the company's understanding that the right to a safe and respectful workplace is fundamental, and that organisations that fail to protect that right cause real and lasting harm to individuals.

The company complies fully with the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013. An Internal Complaints Committee has been constituted as mandated by the Act. The ICC comprises a senior woman employee as Presiding Officer, two employee members committed to women's welfare, and one external member from an NGO or organisation involved in women's welfare issues. The ICC's composition, contact details, and meeting schedule are published on the company intranet and updated annually.

Sexual harassment as defined under the POSH Act includes any of the following when directed by one person at another in the context of their working relationship: physical contact or advances of a sexual nature; demands or requests for sexual favours; sexually coloured remarks; showing pornographic or other sexually explicit material; and any other unwelcome physical, verbal, or non-verbal conduct of a sexual nature. The definition is not limited to contact between a senior and junior employee — it applies regardless of the relative seniority of the parties involved.

The following mandatory provisions apply to all employees:

1. All employees must complete the mandatory POSH awareness training module within 30 days of joining and annually thereafter during the December training cycle. Completion is tracked by HR and non-completion is escalated to the relevant manager.

2. Any employee who believes they have been subjected to sexual harassment may file a written complaint with the ICC at any time within three months of the date of the incident, or within three months of the last incident in a series of incidents. The ICC may condone a delay beyond three months where the complainant demonstrates sufficient cause.

3. The ICC will acknowledge receipt of a complaint within five working days and will complete its inquiry and submit its findings and recommendations to the relevant authority within 90 days of receiving the complaint.

4. The identity of the complainant, the respondent, and all witnesses is kept strictly confidential throughout the inquiry and cannot be disclosed to the press or public. Any person found to have disclosed confidential POSH information will face separate disciplinary action.

5. Retaliation against a complainant — including any action that adversely affects their employment conditions, creates a hostile work environment, or intimidates or humiliates them for having filed a complaint — is itself a serious offence under the Act and under this policy.

6. Managers have a specific obligation to take action — including reporting to the ICC — when they become aware of behaviour in their team that may constitute sexual harassment, even in the absence of a formal complaint by the affected employee.

Any employee who is uncertain about whether a specific behaviour constitutes sexual harassment under the Act, or who wishes to discuss a concern confidentially before deciding whether to file a formal complaint, may contact the ICC Presiding Officer or the HR Business Partner in confidence. The company will not treat an initial confidential enquiry as a formal complaint unless the employee explicitly requests that it be treated as such.

7.3 Anti-Discrimination and Equal Opportunity Policy

Arjun Technologies is an equal opportunity employer in the fullest sense of that commitment. The company prohibits discrimination — direct or indirect, intentional or unintentional — in any employment-related decision or workplace interaction on the basis of any of the following characteristics: gender (including gender identity and gender expression); religion or religious belief; caste, tribe, or ethnic origin; race or colour; national origin or nationality; age; disability (physical, sensory, cognitive, or mental); marital status; pregnancy or maternity; sexual orientation; or any other characteristic protected by applicable Indian law or by the company's stated values.

Discrimination is defined broadly for the purposes of this policy. It includes not only direct unfavourable treatment on a protected ground ('I will not hire this person because they are pregnant') but also indirect discrimination, where a neutral rule or practice has a disproportionate adverse impact on a group sharing a protected characteristic, and where there is no objective justification for that rule. It also includes harassment on any of the protected grounds — conduct that creates a hostile, degrading, humiliating, or offensive environment related to a person's protected characteristic.

Employees who believe they have been discriminated against — in a recruitment decision, a compensation decision, a performance assessment, a promotion decision, an assignment, or any other employment-related context — should raise the matter through the Tier 1 or Tier 2 grievance process described in Section 7.1, or by contacting the HR Business Partner directly. Where the concern involves the HR Business Partner themselves, the complaint should be directed to the VP-HR.

The company makes reasonable adjustments for employees with disabilities or chronic health conditions to enable them to perform the essential functions of their role effectively. Employees who require adjustments should contact HR in confidence to discuss what adjustments may be appropriate and practicable. Requests for reasonable adjustment are assessed individually based on the nature of the condition, the requirements of the role, and the cost and practicability of the adjustment. The company will not treat a request for reasonable adjustment as evidence of inability to perform the role.

7.4 Whistleblower Policy

Arjun Technologies maintains a Whistleblower Policy that enables every employee — at every level — to report suspected violations of applicable law, company policy, regulatory requirements, or ethical standards without fear of retaliation, identification, or adverse consequence. The existence of this policy reflects the company's recognition that the most serious problems in organisations are often known to frontline employees well before they are known to senior management, and that creating a safe channel for those employees to speak up is a governance and integrity imperative.

Reports may be submitted through the following channels, all of which are available at all times and all of which can be used anonymously:

Channel	Contact Details	Anonymity Available	Operating Hours
Whistleblower Telephone Hotline	1800-XXX-XXXX (toll-free)	Yes — calls not recorded; caller ID not captured	24 hours, 7 days
Whistleblower Email	ethics@arjuntech.in	Yes — submit without identifying information	Monitored on business days
Whistleblower Web Portal	ethics.arjuntech.in	Yes — no login required for anonymous submission	Available 24/7
Direct to General Counsel	sandeep.iyer@arjuntech.in	No	Business hours
Direct to VP-HR	priya.menon@arjuntech.in	No	Business hours

All reports submitted in good faith — including reports that turn out on investigation to be incorrect or unsubstantiated — are investigated with strict confidentiality and without adverse consequence to the reporting employee. A report is made in good faith where the employee has a genuine and reasonable belief that the concern they are reporting may be true, even if they cannot prove it. Good faith does not require certainty; it requires honest intent.

The following categories of concern are appropriate for reporting through the Whistleblower mechanism: fraud, financial misconduct, or theft by any employee; violations of applicable Indian law or regulation; breaches of the Code of Conduct; client contract violations or misrepresentations; misuse of company assets; data security breaches or deliberate exposure of confidential information; health or safety violations; and any conduct that the employee reasonably believes exposes the company or its clients to material legal or regulatory risk.

Anonymous reports are investigated to the extent that the available information permits. Where an anonymous report does not contain sufficient detail for investigation, HR will document the report and monitor for additional information that may corroborate or develop the concern. Employees are encouraged — though never required — to identify themselves when making a report, as this typically enables a more thorough and effective investigation.

Retaliation against a whistleblower — in any form, by any person, at any level of the organisation — is a serious disciplinary matter that will be investigated and addressed promptly. Proven retaliation will result in disciplinary action up to and including termination, and in appropriate cases may also be referred to legal authorities.

7.5 Disciplinary Procedures

Arjun Technologies applies a progressive disciplinary process for addressing misconduct and conduct that falls below the standards required by this handbook and the Code of Conduct. The process is designed to be fair, proportionate, consistently applied, and clearly communicated. Every employee subject to a disciplinary process is entitled to know the specific allegation against them, to have a reasonable opportunity to prepare and present their response, and to be accompanied by a colleague of their choice at formal disciplinary meetings.

The standard progressive process has four steps, applied in sequence for most categories of misconduct. Gross misconduct bypasses the progressive steps and may result in immediate suspension and summary termination following a fair investigation. The following table describes the four steps, the typical circumstances in which each applies, and the key process requirements:

Step	Action	Applies When	Duration Active	Key Records Requirements
Step 1	Verbal Warning	A minor first offence. The behaviour is below standard but not serious enough for a formal warning.	6 months	Manager-led conversation. The employee is told the concern, the expectation, and the consequence of further issues. No formal HR involvement required.
Step 2	Written Warning	A repeated minor offence after a verbal warning, or a single more serious offence.	12 months	HR is notified and issues a formal written warning letter. The employee acknowledges receipt. A copy is placed on the employee's file.
Step 3	Final Written Warning	A repeated offence after a written warning; or a single serious offence that does not yet justify dismissal.	12 months	HR-led meeting with the employee, their manager, and a colleague or union representative if they wish. The employee is informed that dismissal will result from any further misconduct during the warning period.
Step 4	Termination	Continued non-improvement after a Final Written Warning, or conduct that has irretrievably damaged the employment relationship.	N/A	Decision made by HR and the relevant senior manager, based on the full investigation record. The employee is invited to a termination meeting and informed in writing of the decision, the last day of employment, and any entitlements.
Summary Termination	Immediate Dismissal	Gross misconduct: theft, fraud, violence, possession of illegal substances, serious breach of confidentiality, or conduct that destroys trust in the employment relationship.	N/A	Suspension (with pay) pending investigation. The decision to dismiss is made only after a thorough investigation and a fair hearing. The employee is informed in writing and given the opportunity to appeal.

The following offence classification provides guidance on the level of disciplinary response typically appropriate for the most common categories of misconduct. This classification is guidance, not a fixed formula — the appropriate response in any specific case depends on all the relevant facts and circumstances, the employee's length of service and history, the impact of the conduct, and whether any mitigating factors apply.

Offence Category	Examples	Typical First Response	Typical Repeat Response
Minor Misconduct	Unauthorised lateness; occasional missed deadlines without escalation; failure to follow minor procedural requirements; inappropriate but non-offensive conversation; failure to wear required PPE.	Informal conversation, recorded by the manager. No formal HR involvement.	Verbal Warning, then Written Warning if the behaviour continues.
Moderate Misconduct	Repeated unauthorised absence; failure to comply with a reasonable instruction; minor breach of security procedures; inappropriate use of company resources; dishonesty of a minor nature.	Written Warning, recorded on the employee's file.	Final Written Warning, or termination if the conduct is

Offence Category	Examples	Typical First Response	Typical Repeat Resp
Serious Misconduct	Persistent underperformance after a PIP; serious breach of policy; inappropriate sharing of Confidential data; ne	Final Written Warning	Termination
Gross Misconduct	Theft; fraud; physical violence; sexual harassment; deliberate falsification of records; serious breach of data protection law	Suspension pending investigation, then Dismissal (no prior warning required)	Not applicable — first offence is usually dismissal

A disciplinary sanction that has been active on record for its full duration without any further instance of the same or related misconduct is considered spent. A spent sanction may not be cited in any future disciplinary process relating to unrelated misconduct. HR maintains a complete and accurate disciplinary record for each employee and ensures that spent sanctions are correctly noted. Employees may request a copy of their disciplinary record from HR at any time.

Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd.
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EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

Segment 4 of 5 — Separation, Exit, IT Conduct & Acknowledgement

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HR Contact	hr@arjuntech.in	**Department**	Human Resources
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This segment covers Section 8 (Separation and Exit), Section 9 (IT and Digital Conduct), and Section 10 (Employee Acknowledgement) of the Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd. Employee Handbook. Classified Internal Use Only. Current versions of all segments are available on the HRMS portal.

8. Separation and Exit

Employment at Arjun Technologies may end through voluntary resignation, the natural expiry of a fixed-term contract, retirement, redundancy or retrenchment, termination by the company, or the death of the employee. Each type of separation carries distinct obligations and entitlements, and each is governed by a specific process. This section describes those processes in full. How a separation is managed — on both sides — has a lasting effect on the individual, on the team, and on the company's reputation in the talent market. The company is committed to managing every separation with professionalism, fairness, and genuine respect for the departing employee's contribution.

8.1 Types of Separation

The following table summarises the types of separation recognised at Arjun Technologies, the notice requirements applicable to each, and the financial entitlements that arise:

Type of Separation	Definition	Notice Required	FnF Entitlements
Voluntary Resignation	The employee initiates termination of employment voluntarily.	Per applicable notice period (see Section 8.3).	Full FnF (see Section 8.3).
Fixed-Term Contract Expiry	The employment contract reaches its stated end date and is not renewed.	None. Contract expires by its own terms.	Full FnF. Gratuity if 5+ years of continu
Retirement	Employee reaches the normal retirement age of 60 and elects to retire.	Per applicable notice period.	Full FnF including gratuity (if 5+ years) and PF settlemen
Redundancy / Retrenchment	The company eliminates the employee's role due to genuine business reasons.	As prescribed by the applicable labour law.	Full FnF plus statutory retrenchment compensation.
Termination with Notice	The company terminates employment for sustained underperformance or loss of trust.	One month's notice or payment in lieu.	Full FnF. Salary to last working day.
Summary Termination	Immediate dismissal following a disciplinary investigation.	None.	Salary up to last working day. Gratuity may be forfeited in w
Death During Employment	The employee passes away while employed.	Not applicable.	Full FnF paid to nominee or legal heir. Group term life in

8.2 Resignation Process

An employee wishing to resign must submit a formal written resignation to their line manager with a simultaneous copy to HR. Resignation must be submitted through the HRMS Separation module and confirmed by email. Verbal resignations — regardless of what may have been said in a conversation — are not accepted as the formal initiation of the resignation process. The HRMS submission is the definitive act that starts the notice period clock.

The manager must acknowledge receipt of the resignation in writing within two working days. The acknowledgement does not constitute acceptance of any specific last working date. HR will issue a formal acknowledgement of the resignation, confirm the applicable notice period and the resulting last working date based on the standard notice period, and share the exit checklist and offboarding schedule with the employee within three working days.

Employees are expected to work fully and professionally throughout the notice period. The notice period is not a waiting room — it carries all the same performance, conduct, and attendance obligations as any other period of employment. Employees who do not maintain

normal work standards during the notice period expose themselves to the risk that their Full and Final Settlement is affected by any salary deduction that becomes applicable. The manager is responsible for planning and managing a structured knowledge transfer and handover during the notice period, beginning from day one.

The company has the right, in its discretion, to place a resigning employee on garden leave — meaning the employee remains on payroll and continues to receive full benefits but is not required to come to the office and is not provided access to company systems. Garden leave is typically exercised for senior roles where continued access to confidential information, client relationships, or strategic plans during the notice period creates an elevated competitive risk. The decision to offer garden leave is made by the relevant SVP in consultation with HR and Legal.

8.3 Notice Periods

The notice period applicable to an employee depends on their employment band at the time of separation. The following notice periods apply to confirmed employees of each band:

Band	Role Level	Notice Period — Employee Resignation	Notice Period — Company Termination
Band 1	Associate / Junior Analyst	1 calendar month	1 calendar month
Band 2	Engineer / Senior Analyst	1 calendar month	1 calendar month
Band 3	Senior Engineer / Lead	2 calendar months	2 calendar months
Band 4	Principal / Engineering Manager	2 calendar months	2 calendar months
Band 5	Associate Director / Senior Manager	3 calendar months	3 calendar months
Band 6	Director	3 calendar months	3 calendar months
Band 7+	Vice President and above	3 calendar months	3 calendar months
Probation (any band)	N/A	2 calendar weeks	2 calendar weeks

Notice periods are calculated in calendar months, not working days. A resignation submitted on 12 October by an employee subject to a two-month notice period results in a last working date of 11 December, regardless of the number of working days in that period. Public holidays and approved leave during the notice period do not extend the notice period.

Notice periods may be shortened by mutual written agreement between the employee, the manager, and HR. Both parties must agree in writing. A shortened notice period does not alter the FnF entitlements — the employee receives all accrued entitlements as at the shortened last working date.

Notice buyout is available as an alternative to serving the full notice period. Under a notice buyout, the employee pays to the company an amount equal to the basic salary for the remaining notice days that will not be served, calculated as (Basic Salary ÷ 26) × remaining working days. The amount is typically deducted from the Full and Final Settlement rather than

requiring a separate payment. Notice buyout requires written approval from the line manager and HR Business Partner.

8.4 Full and Final Settlement

Full and Final Settlement is the financial reconciliation between the company and the departing employee that is processed following the employee's last working day. FnF is initiated by HR once the exit checklist has been completed in full and all company assets have been verified as returned by IT and Administration. FnF is processed within 45 days of the last working day, subject to the timely completion of the exit checklist. Delays caused by the employee's failure to return assets or complete checklist items extend the FnF timeline accordingly.

FnF Component	Included?	Calculation Basis	Tax Treatment	Notes
Salary to last working day	Always	(Gross salary ÷ 26) × working days in final month	Taxable as salary	Pro-rated for the partial month.
Earned Leave encashment	Always	(Basic Salary ÷ 26) × full EL balance as on last day	Taxable as salary	Capped on encashment amount at separatio
Performance Variable Pay	Pro-rated if eligible	Target variable × pro-rata months worked ÷ 12	Taxable as salary	Payable only if company achieves minimum
Gratuity	If 5+ years service	(Basic Salary ÷ 26) × 15 × completed years of service	Exempt up to ₹20	Rounded up if final year has 6+ months. Pa
Expense reimbursements	If approved claims pending	Approved claim amounts	Not taxable	Only approved, submitted claims. Claims m
Notice period shortfall deduction	If applicable	(Basic Salary ÷ 26) × unserved notice days	N/A — deduction	Applied where the employee does not serve
Asset recovery deduction	If applicable	Replacement value of unreturned company assets	N/A — deduction	Laptops, phones, access cards, and other e
Outstanding salary advance	If applicable	Full outstanding advance balance	N/A — deduction	Finance confirms the outstanding balance.

The employee receives a draft FnF statement from Finance for review and sign-off before payment is processed. The statement itemises every credit and deduction. Employees who dispute any item must raise the concern in writing to the HR Business Partner and Finance within five working days of receiving the draft statement. Once the employee signs the FnF statement, it is treated as a final settlement and the company's FnF liability is discharged.

The FnF payment is made by direct transfer to the employee's registered bank account. The employee must ensure that their HRMS bank details are current on or before their last working day. If a direct transfer fails due to incorrect details, Finance will retry once the employee provides corrected information. The company is not liable for delays caused by the employee's failure to maintain current bank details.

Form 16 for the relevant financial year will be issued to the departing employee by the statutory deadline, even after separation. Ex-employees can access their historical payslips and Form 16 through the HRMS portal for up to three years following their separation date. After this period, payslip access is deactivated, but Form 16 documents remain available through Finance on written request.

8.5 Exit Interview

All departing employees are invited to participate in a confidential exit interview conducted by an HR representative — not the line manager. The exit interview is the company's primary mechanism for obtaining honest feedback about the employee's experience, the reasons for their departure, and what the company could do differently. Participation is voluntary, but employees are strongly encouraged to take part. The insights gathered through exit interviews are among the most candid and useful data the company receives about its culture, management quality, and competitive position as an employer.

The exit interview covers the following areas: the primary reasons for leaving; the employee's overall experience of working at the company; specific aspects of the role, team, or management that were particularly positive or negative; observations about the company's culture, values, and the gap between stated and actual behaviour; and any suggestions the employee would make if they were in a position to change something about the company. Individual responses are never shared with the employee's line manager or business unit head without the employee's explicit consent. Aggregated, anonymised insights from exit interviews are reviewed quarterly by the VP-HR and presented to the leadership team as part of the attrition analysis.

8.6 Termination for Cause

Arjun Technologies reserves the right to terminate employment without notice — or with immediate effect following a suspension pending investigation — where an employee has committed gross misconduct. Gross misconduct is conduct so serious that it fundamentally undermines the employment relationship and makes continued employment impossible or inappropriate. The categories of gross misconduct are described in Section 7.5 of this handbook.

Before any decision to terminate for cause is made, the company will conduct a fair investigation in which the employee is given a full and proper opportunity to respond to the allegations against them. The investigation is conducted by HR and, in serious cases, Legal. The employee has the right to be accompanied by a colleague at any formal meeting held as part of the investigation. A decision to terminate will be communicated in writing with the specific reasons stated. The employee has the right to appeal a termination decision through HR within ten working days of receiving the termination letter.

The Full and Final Settlement for a termination for cause covers salary to the last working day and any accrued EL encashment. Gratuity may be forfeited in whole or in part in cases involving wilful omission, negligence causing financial damage to the company, or violent or riotous conduct, but only where the specific conditions and processes prescribed by the Payment of Gratuity Act are followed. Gratuity forfeiture requires Legal team approval and cannot be applied unilaterally by the business.

8.7 Post-Employment Obligations

Certain obligations survive the termination of employment and continue to bind the former employee for the periods specified in the employment contract. Employees are required to be aware of and comply with these obligations, which are legally enforceable.

Post-Employment Obligation	Duration After Last Working Day	Scope and Key Provisions
Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA)	2 years	The former employee must not disclose, use, or allow any third party to use any Conf
Non-Solicitation — Employees	1 year	The former employee must not directly or indirectly solicit, recruit, or attempt to induce
Non-Solicitation — Clients	1 year	The former employee must not directly or indirectly solicit or attempt to obtain busines
Non-Solicitation — Suppliers	1 year	The former employee must not solicit or interfere with the company's relationships wit
IP Assignment	Permanent	All intellectual property created during the course of employment remains the property
Return of Property	On or before last working day	All company property — equipment, documents, access devices, and any data stored

The NDA and non-solicitation provisions do not prevent the former employee from working in the technology industry or from joining a competitor. Arjun Technologies does not impose non-compete restrictions beyond what is permissible under Section 27 of the Indian Contract Act, 1872, which renders broad non-compete clauses unenforceable in India. The company's post-employment obligations are targeted at protecting legitimate interests — confidential information and client and employee relationships — not at restricting the former employee's ability to earn a livelihood.

9. IT and Digital Conduct

All technology resources provided by Arjun Technologies — laptops, mobile devices, email accounts, software licences, cloud services, and network infrastructure — are company property, made available to employees primarily for the purpose of conducting the company's business. This section summarises the key obligations of all employees in relation to information technology, data security, digital communications, and AI tool usage. The detailed and complete IT Security Policy is a standalone document available on the HR portal and should be read in full by all employees within 30 days of joining.

Compliance with the IT Security Policy is mandatory for all employees and contractors. Violations are treated as disciplinary matters and are referred to Legal where they constitute a potential criminal offence or where they have resulted in actual or probable loss to the company or a client. The company's Chief Technology Officer and Information Security Manager are responsible for the overall information security programme, which is reviewed and updated on an annual basis.

9.1 Information Classification

All information created, received, processed, or stored by or on behalf of Arjun Technologies is classified according to the following four-level scheme. The classification determines the handling controls that apply to the information at every stage of its lifecycle — creation, storage, transmission, sharing, and disposal. Where the appropriate classification for a piece of information is uncertain, the higher sensitivity level should be assumed until clarification is obtained from the Legal and Compliance team.

Classification Level	Definition	Examples	Minimum Handling Requirements
Public	Information approved for unrestricted external publication	Press releases, published documentation, compliance certificates	No special controls. Confirm content approval before publish
Internal Use Only	Information intended for internal business use; unauthorised disclosure would cause minor inconvenience	Internal policies, meeting minutes, org charts, non-sensitive project plans	Do not share externally without manager approval. Store on
Confidential	Sensitive information whose disclosure could cause significant harm to the company, clients, or individuals	Client data, financial records, employee personal data, contracts, source code, unreleased product plans	Encrypt in transit and at rest. Share only on a need-to-know basis under NDA. Store
Restricted	Most sensitive information with severe consequences if disclosed or compromised	Encryption keys, PII subject to GDPR, authentication credentials, unreleased financial results	Access restricted to named individuals. Multi-factor authentication required. AES-256 encryption

9.2 Acceptable Use of Company Technology

Company technology resources are provided for business purposes. Incidental personal use — brief personal browsing, personal messaging during breaks — is tolerated in moderation provided it does not impair performance, consume significant network resources, or violate any policy or law. The following uses are prohibited under all circumstances and are treated as disciplinary matters when identified:

1. Accessing, downloading, storing, or transmitting illegal content of any kind, including content that infringes copyright, contains malware, depicts child sexual abuse, or promotes

terrorism or extremism.

2. Installing any software, browser extension, utility, plugin, or application on any company device without prior approval from the IT team. This includes all consumer AI tools, browser-integrated AI assistants, and productivity extensions, unless they appear on the IT Security approved software register.

3. Attempting to bypass, disable, circumvent, or test any security control, firewall, access restriction, endpoint protection tool, or monitoring system — regardless of the reason.

4. Accessing another employee's email account, files, calendar, or systems-based information without that employee's explicit permission and a documented business justification reviewed by IT Security.

5. Using company systems, network, or equipment for cryptocurrency mining, personal commercial activities, secondary employment, or any revenue-generating activity for the employee's personal benefit.

6. Storing, transmitting, or processing Confidential or Restricted company data through personal cloud storage services, personal email accounts, personal messaging applications, or any channel not approved for that classification level.

7. Using company equipment or network bandwidth for personal video streaming, online gaming, or large personal file downloads during core working hours.

8. Leaving a workstation unlocked and unattended when it contains or has recently displayed Confidential or Restricted information, or when it is accessible to persons who are not authorised to view the open information.

9.3 Password and Authentication Standards

Strong authentication is the first line of defence against unauthorised access to company systems and data. The following standards apply to all employee-managed accounts on company systems and services:

Requirement	Standard	Notes
Minimum password length	12 characters	Passphrases of four or more unrelated words are an acceptable and ef
Complexity	Must include uppercase, lowercase, number, and special character from each	Applies to all categories.
Password age	Maximum 90 days before mandatory change	System-enforced where technically feasible.
Password history	Cannot reuse any of the last 12 passwords	System-enforced where technically feasible.
Prohibited content	No dictionary words, personal names, dates, or company-related identifiers	Verified by password strength checker at creation.
Storage	Company-approved password manager only	Storing passwords in browser-integrated managers, plain text files, spr
Sharing	Strictly prohibited under all circumstances	Account sharing is a conduct matter. Emergency access to shared acc
Default passwords	Must be changed on first use of any new device or account	Applies to all company-issued devices, software, and service accounts

Requirement	Standard	Notes
Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)	Mandatory for all remote access, email, and cloud services	Authenticator app or hardware key preferred. SMS OTP accepted only

9.4 Data Security and Confidentiality

Employees who access Confidential or Restricted information as part of their role — including client data, source code, financial records, and personnel information — carry a serious responsibility for protecting that information. The obligation to protect Confidential and Restricted company data applies at all times and in all locations: in the office, at home, at client sites, and in any other context. It continues for two years after the employee's last working day, as stated in the employment contract.

The following security requirements apply to all employees handling Confidential or Restricted data:

1. All remote access to company systems must be conducted through the company-approved and company-managed VPN. Accessing any company system, application, or Confidential data over a public, guest, or unmanaged Wi-Fi network without an active VPN connection is strictly prohibited. This applies equally to hotel Wi-Fi, conference venue Wi-Fi, café Wi-Fi, and personal mobile hotspots from non-company SIM cards.

2. Company laptops must have full-disk encryption enabled at all times — BitLocker on Windows and FileVault on macOS. Employees must not disable, pause, or bypass full-disk encryption under any circumstances. Company-issued mobile devices must have screen lock with a PIN or biometric enabled.

3. Printed copies of Confidential or Restricted documents must be collected from shared printers immediately after printing. They must be stored in locked drawers when not in active use and must be cross-cut shredded using the office's confidential waste service when no longer required. Printed Confidential documents must not be disposed of in standard waste bins.

4. Electronic disposal of Confidential or Restricted data must use an approved secure deletion tool or involve the physical destruction of the storage medium. Standard deletion, emptying the recycling bin, or reformatting a drive is not sufficient — data can be recovered from drives disposed of in this manner.

5. Any actual or suspected security incident — including a lost or stolen device, an unauthorised access event, a phishing email that has been clicked, a misconfigured cloud resource, or an accidental disclosure of Confidential data — must be reported to the IT Security team at security@arjuntech.in within one hour of discovery. The company's incident response obligations to clients and regulators depend on prompt internal

reporting.

9.5 Remote Work and Device Security

Employees working remotely carry specific additional security responsibilities. Company equipment must be physically secured at all times when not in use — laptops must be locked in a dedicated space and must not be left in vehicles, in publicly visible locations, or in situations where theft is a foreseeable risk. If a company device is lost or stolen, the employee must contact IT Security immediately, regardless of the time. Remote wipe capabilities are deployed on all managed company devices and will be activated for lost or stolen equipment.

Employees must not allow any person who is not an authorised Arjun Technologies employee — including family members, household visitors, or third-party IT support personnel not engaged by the company — to use, access, or interact with company equipment. This restriction applies to casual use ('just using it to look something up') and to technical assistance ('fixing a laptop problem'). All technical assistance for company equipment must be provided exclusively by the company's IT team.

Where an employee uses a personal device to access company email or calendar under an approved BYOD arrangement, the company's MDM profile is installed on the personal device. This profile manages only the company applications and data on the device — it does not access personal photos, applications, or other personal content. The MDM profile can be removed by the employee at any time, which simultaneously removes all company data from the device. The company will require MDM profile removal as part of the exit process for all employees who have enrolled personal devices.

9.6 Social Media Policy

Employees are personally responsible for all content they post on social media that relates to their professional life or that identifies them — or could lead a reasonable person to identify them — as an employee of Arjun Technologies. This applies to all platforms including LinkedIn, X (formerly Twitter), Instagram, Facebook, YouTube, personal blogs, professional forums, and any other publicly accessible digital channel.

The following requirements apply to all employee social media activity in a professional or work-adjacent context:

1. Do not post, share, forward, or transmit any information that is classified as Confidential or Restricted under the company's information classification scheme, including client names or project details, financial figures, source code or system architecture, and personnel or compensation information.

2. Do not make any statement that could reasonably be interpreted as an official or authoritative statement on behalf of Arjun Technologies without prior written authorisation from the Communications team. This applies to opinions about the company's strategy, technology decisions, financial position, or market standing.

3. Do not defame, disparage, or make statements about the company, its leadership, its clients, its competitors, or any colleague that are false, misleading, or likely to cause reputational harm. Critical views expressed privately are different from public statements — the company asks only that employees exercise professional judgement in what they post publicly.

4. Do not post content that harasses, bullies, intimidates, or targets any individual, including colleagues, clients, or former colleagues, regardless of the platform through which it is expressed.

5. Do not post content that is discriminatory, offensive, or unlawful under applicable Indian law or under the company's conduct policies as described in Section 3.

6. When expressing personal professional views that touch on the company, its industry, or its clients, include a clear statement that the views expressed are personal and do not represent the position of the company.

The company does not monitor the personal social media activity of employees as a routine practice. Social media content may be reviewed in connection with a specific concern or complaint. Employees should bear in mind that content posted publicly may be seen by current and future clients, colleagues, and employers. The standard the company applies is whether a reasonable, senior professional would consider the post appropriate if they knew its author was an Arjun Technologies employee.

9.7 AI Tool Usage Guidelines

The rapid adoption of AI tools across the technology industry has created significant productivity opportunities for individual employees and for the company's service delivery. It has also introduced new risks — particularly the risk of inadvertent disclosure of sensitive information to AI systems that process data outside company-controlled infrastructure. Arjun Technologies's approach is to enable responsible, productive use of AI tools while preventing data security breaches through clear guidelines and an approved tool register.

The IT Security team maintains the Approved AI Tools Register, which lists all AI tools approved for use with company data. The register distinguishes between tools approved for use with Internal Use Only data, tools approved for Confidential data, and tools approved for Restricted data. Before using any AI tool for work purposes, employees must check whether it appears on the register and confirm the classification level for which it is approved. If a tool does not appear

on the register, employees must submit an assessment request to IT Security before using it for any company work.

The following prohibitions apply to all AI tool usage regardless of whether a tool is on the approved register:

1. Confidential and Restricted data — including client names, client systems, source code, financial records, personnel information, and any data subject to a non-disclosure obligation or the DPDP Act — must not be entered into any AI tool that processes data outside company-controlled infrastructure, regardless of whether the tool claims to be 'private', 'enterprise', or 'does not retain inputs'. The data security risk arises from transmission and inference, not only from storage.

2. AI-generated code must be reviewed, tested, and security-scanned by the employee to the same standard as any other code before it is submitted for review or included in a company product. The existence of AI-generated content in a codebase does not reduce or transfer the employee's responsibility for the quality, security, and correctness of that code.

3. AI tools must not be used to make or to draft final employment-related decisions, including performance assessments, disciplinary decisions, or compensation recommendations, without a human author reviewing and owning the output. AI-assisted drafting is acceptable; AI-authored decisions are not.

4. The use of AI tools to generate content that impersonates another individual — whether a colleague, a client, a manager, or any other person — is prohibited.

The AI landscape is evolving rapidly. The company's guidelines for AI tool usage are reviewed quarterly by IT Security and updated as the risk landscape changes. Employees should check the current version of the Approved AI Tools Register and the accompanying usage guidelines on the IT Security intranet page before beginning any new use case. Questions about whether a specific use case is within the guidelines should be directed to IT Security at itsecurity@arjuntech.in.

9.8 Cloud Service Usage and Shadow IT

Only cloud services that have been assessed, approved, and listed in the Approved Cloud Services Register maintained by IT Security may be used for company data. The register is available on the IT Security intranet page and includes the approved classification level for each service. Using unapproved cloud services — commonly referred to as shadow IT — to store, process, or share company data is a policy violation regardless of the convenience or perceived security of the service concerned.

If an employee identifies a cloud service that would be useful for a legitimate business purpose but is not on the approved register, they should submit an assessment request to IT Security with a description of the intended use case and the data classification involved. IT Security will conduct an assessment and communicate an approval decision within ten working days. The company's review process is designed to be expedient — the intention is to enable productive use of cloud services, not to create unnecessary bureaucratic friction.

All cloud infrastructure used for Arjun Technologies workloads must be provisioned and managed through approved Infrastructure-as-Code templates. Manual, console-based provisioning is permitted for initial exploration but must be replaced with IaC-managed resources before any workload is promoted to production. Public access on cloud storage resources must be disabled by default. All cloud production accounts must have audit logging, threat detection, and anomaly alerting enabled at all times.

9.9 IT Security Incident Reporting

Every employee who discovers, suspects, or is notified of a security incident must report it to the IT Security team at security@arjuntech.in within one hour of discovery — 24 hours a day, seven days a week. The one-hour requirement is not bureaucratic excess. Many of the company's contractual obligations to clients specify breach notification timelines of 24 hours from the company becoming aware of the incident. Meeting those obligations requires prompt internal reporting.

Security incidents that must be reported immediately include, but are not limited to: any actual or suspected unauthorised access to company systems, data, or accounts; any lost or stolen company device; any phishing email that has been clicked or credentials that have been entered in response to a phishing attempt; any ransomware, malware, or suspicious software behaviour on a company device; any misconfigured cloud resource that may have exposed company or client data; and any conversation, email, or communication in which an employee believes they may have inadvertently disclosed Confidential or Restricted information to an unauthorised party.

Employees who report a security incident promptly and in good faith will not face disciplinary consequences for the incident itself, provided that the incident was not the result of a deliberate or grossly negligent act. The company treats prompt reporting as a positive act of corporate responsibility. Concealing a security incident, or delaying its reporting in the hope that it will not be discovered, is a conduct matter that will be treated more seriously than the incident itself.

10. Employee Acknowledgement

By completing and signing this acknowledgement, the employee confirms that they have received a copy of the Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd. Employee Handbook, that they have read and understood its contents in full, and that they agree to comply with all policies, standards, and requirements described within it.

The employee further acknowledges and understands the following: this handbook is not a contract of employment and does not create any contractual right to continued employment; Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd. reserves the right to amend, update, supplement, or withdraw any policy described in this handbook at any time with reasonable advance notice to employees; the most current version of this handbook is always available on the HRMS portal; and compliance with the policies in this handbook is a condition of continued employment at Arjun Technologies.

This signed acknowledgement must be submitted to HR within five working days of the employee's date of joining. Submission may be completed physically — by printing, signing, and returning this page to the HR team — or digitally through the HRMS portal under HR Services → Acknowledgements, where the electronic signature is legally equivalent to a handwritten signature for the purposes of this document.

Full Legal Name (Print clearly)	
Employee ID Number	
Job Title	
Department	
Office Location	
Date of Joining	
Date of Acknowledgement	
Employee Signature	
Manager Full Name (Print clearly)	
Manager Signature	
HR Representative Name	
HR Representative Signature	

Completed acknowledgements should be returned to the HR team at hr@arjuntech.in or submitted through the HRMS portal within five working days of the date of joining. The HR team will confirm receipt and retain the signed acknowledgement in the employee's permanent HR file. If you have any questions about the contents of this handbook before signing, please contact your HR Business Partner.

Handbook Completion Summary — Segment 4 of 5

Segment	Content	Pages	Status
Segment 1	Introduction · Employment Policies · Workplace Standards	1–50	✓ Published
Segment 2	Compensation & Benefits · Leave Policy	51–100	✓ Published
Segment 3	Performance & Development · Employee Relations	101–150	✓ Published
Segment 4	Separation & Exit · IT Conduct · Acknowledgement	151–200	✓ This Document
Segment 5	Appendices A through O (Glossary, FAQs, Forms, Manager Guide, etc.)	201–250	Forthcoming

The complete handbook across all five segments constitutes the definitive statement of employment policy at Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd. as of 01 April 2024. All segments are available on the HRMS portal under Policies and Documents. For queries about any provision, contact hr@arjuntech.in or your HR Business Partner.

Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd.
Bengaluru, Karnataka — 560 001
CIN: U72200KA2008PTC044521 | www.arjuntech.in

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

Segment 5 of 5 — Appendices A through O

Version	5.2	**Effective Date**	01 April 2024
Review Date	31 March 2025	**Classification**	Internal Use Only
Approved By	Mr. Rajesh Arjun	**Document Owner**	Ms. Priya Menon
HR Contact	hr@arjuntech.in	**Department**	Human Resources
Document Ref.	HR-POL-001-v5.2	**Segment**	5 of 5 (Pages 201–250)

Appendices in this Segment:

Appendix	Title
Appendix A	Compensation Band Structure and Variable Pay Targets
Appendix B	Leave Summary Reference Table
Appendix C	Public Holiday Calendar FY 2024-25
Appendix D	HRMS User Guide — All Modules
Appendix E	HR Department Directory
Appendix F	Glossary of HR Terms
Appendix G	Employee Frequently Asked Questions (20 Questions)
Appendix H	Manager HR Reference Guide
Appendix I	Disciplinary Offence Classification Table
Appendix J	Exit Checklist
Appendix K	HR Forms Catalogue
Appendix L	Employment Law Reference
Appendix M	Compensation Deep-Dive with Worked Examples

Appendix	Title
Appendix N	Manager FAQ — 15 Workplace Scenarios
Appendix O	Policy Rationale Notes

This segment completes the Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd. Employee Handbook. All appendices should be read as part of the complete handbook. Current versions of all segments are available on the HRMS portal under Policies and Documents.

Appendix A: Compensation Band Structure and Variable Pay Targets

The following table defines the compensation band structure at Arjun Technologies as of 01 April 2024. The CTC ranges shown represent the full market range for each band based on the FY 2024-25 benchmarking exercise. Individual placement within a band is determined by experience, skills, performance history, and market benchmarking at the time of hire or the most recent salary revision. Placement at any point within the range is appropriate and does not indicate underperformance.

Band	Title Examples	Experience Guide	CTC Range (■ LPA)	Variable Pay Target	Team Size Managed
1	Junior Engineer, Associate Analyst	0–2 years	3.5 – 6.0	10% of CTC	Individual Contributor
2	Engineer, Analyst, Senior Associate	2–4 years	6.0 – 12.0	10% of CTC	Individual Contributor
3	Senior Engineer, Lead Analyst, Team Lead	4–7 years	12.0 – 20.0	12% of CTC	2–5 team members
4	Principal Engineer, Engineering Manager	7–12 years	20.0 – 35.0	15% of CTC	5–15 team members
5	Associate Director, Senior Manager	12–18 years	35.0 – 55.0	18% of CTC	15–50 team members
6	Director	18+ years	55.0 – 85.0	20% of CTC	50–150 team members
7	Vice President	20+ years	85.0 – 1,50.0	22% of CTC	Division-level
8	Senior Vice President, C-Suite	25+ years	Above 1,50.0	25% of CTC	Company-level

Variable pay targets are percentages of annual CTC. The actual payout is the target percentage multiplied by the individual performance multiplier (which ranges from 0 for Rating 1 to 1.15–1.30 for Rating 5) and the company financial performance factor (approved by the Board based on the company's achievement against its annual financial targets). In years of strong company performance, variable pay for high performers can meaningfully exceed the target percentage shown above.

Band progression requires a minimum of 18 months in the current band, a performance rating of 4 or 5 in the most recent appraisal, demonstrated performance at the next level, a genuine business need, and endorsement from the line manager, business unit head, and VP-HR. Off-cycle promotions require Finance approval and are reserved for cases where business urgency cannot wait for the annual cycle. No promotion is automatic — all promotions represent a deliberate and substantiated decision.

Appendix B: Leave Summary Reference Table

The following table provides a consolidated single-page reference for all leave types. For full provisions governing each type, refer to Section 5 of Segment 2.

Leave Type	Annual Credit	Accrual	Max Balance	Carry Fwd	Encashable	Probation
Earned Leave (EL)	18 days	1.5 days/month from confirmation	45 days	Yes	Yes — 2x/year, 10 days max	No
Casual Leave (CL)	8 days (1 Apr)	Full credit on 1 April	Forfeited 31 Mar	No	No	Yes
Sick Leave (SL)	12 days (1 Apr)	Full credit on 1 April	30 days cumulative	Yes	No	Yes
Maternity Leave	Per entitlement schedule	N/A	N/A	N/A	No	Statutory min.
Paternity Leave	10 working days	N/A	Within 90 days	No	No	Yes
Bereavement	2–5 days by relation	N/A	N/A	No	No	Yes
Marriage Leave	3 days (once per career)	N/A	N/A	No	No	No (6+ months)
Study/Exam Leave	5 days per year	N/A	N/A	No	No	No
Sabbatical	1–3 months (unpaid)	N/A	N/A	N/A	No	No (5+ years)
Comp-Off	Per public holiday worked	N/A	Within 45 days	Yes	Yes — if not availed	Yes
Voting Leave	Half day per election	N/A	N/A	No	No	Yes
Leave Without Pay	As approved	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	Limited

Appendix C: Public Holiday Calendar FY 2024-25

Ten mandatory holidays apply across all offices. Each employee selects two optional restricted holidays from the restricted list by applying through HRMS at least two working days in advance. The complete updated calendar for each financial year is published on the HRMS portal by 15 January.

#	Holiday	Date	Type	BLR	HYD	PNE	CHN	MUM
1	Ugadi / Gudi Padwa	9 April 2024	Mandatory — State	✓	✓	✓	—	✓
2	Good Friday	18 April 2025	Mandatory — National	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
3	May Day	1 May 2024	Mandatory — National	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
4	Independence Day	15 August 2024	Mandatory — National	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
5	Ganesh Chaturthi	7 September 2024	State (Mandatory)	—	—	✓	—	✓
6	Gandhi Jayanti	2 October 2024	Mandatory — National	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
7	Dussehra	12 October 2024	Mandatory — National	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
8	Diwali (Lakshmi Puja)	1 November 2024	Mandatory — National	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
9	Christmas Day	25 December 2024	Mandatory — National	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
10	Republic Day	26 January 2025	Mandatory — National	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
11	Holi	14 March 2025	Mandatory — National	✓	✓	✓	—	✓
R1	Eid-ul-Fitr	Per lunar calendar	Restricted (Optional)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R2	Eid-ul-Adha	Per lunar calendar	Restricted (Optional)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R3	Milad-un-Nabi	Per lunar calendar	Restricted (Optional)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R4	Guru Nanak Jayanti	Per lunar calendar	Restricted (Optional)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R5	Muharram	Per lunar calendar	Restricted (Optional)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R6	Baisakhi	Per lunar calendar	Restricted (Optional)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R7	Christmas Eve	24 December 2024	Restricted (Optional)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R8	Maha Shivratri	Per lunar calendar	Restricted (Optional)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R9	Onam	Per lunar calendar	Restricted (Optional)	—	—	—	✓	—
R10	Navratri (one day)	Per lunar calendar	Restricted (Optional)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

Appendix D: HRMS User Guide — All Modules

The HRMS (Human Resources Management System) at Arjun Technologies is the single system of record for all HR processes. It is accessible at hrms.arjuntech.in via any modern web browser and through the HRMS mobile application on Android and iOS. For technical issues, contact itsupport@arjuntech.in. For HR process queries, contact hr@arjuntech.in or your HR Business Partner.

Module	Function	HRMS Path	Key Notes
My Profile	View and update personal details, emergency contacts, bank account	Home → My Profile	Name changes require HR verification with original legal do
Leave Management	Apply for leave, check balance, track status, view history	HR Services → Leave	Manager must approve within 2 working days. Auto-approve
Attendance	Mark daily attendance (remote), view monthly attendance summary	HR Services → Attendance	Corrections must be raised within 5 working days of the rele
Payroll	Download payslips, view TDS summary, access Form 16	Payroll → Payslips	Available from month of joining. Form 16 published by 31 M
Investment Declaration	Submit Form 12BB for TDS computation	Payroll → Tax → Declaration	Submit by Finance deadline each January. Without this, ma
FBP Allocation	Select Flexible Benefit Plan categories for the year	Payroll → FBP	Annual election. Irrevocable once submitted. Default: full an
Performance	Set OKRs, complete self-assessment, view ratings	Performance → Goals	Active only during cycle windows. Review Section 6 for dea
L&D Budget	Submit L&D reimbursement requests, track annual budget utilisation	Learning → Budget	Manager approval and original receipt required. Submit with
Expense Claims	Submit travel and other expense claims with receipts	Finance → Expenses	Submit within 30 days of incurring the expense. Claims olde
IT Requests	Raise IT support tickets, request software access	IT Services → Raise Ticket	SLA: 4 hours for critical issues; 1 business day for standard
Benefits	View insurance policy details, download benefit certificates	Benefits → My Benefits	Updated on enrolment and at annual renewal. Insurance ca
Separation	Initiate resignation, access exit checklist, track exit process	HR Services → Separation	Triggers notice period and handover workflows. FnF is initia
Policies	Access all current HR policy documents and circulars	Policies & Documents	Always reflects the current approved version. Supersedes a
Org Chart	View live organisation hierarchy and reporting structure	Organisation → Org Chart	Updated in real time as structural changes are processed.
Internal Jobs	Browse and apply for internal vacancies	Careers → Internal Jobs	Eligibility: 18 months in current role, performance rating of 3
Recognition	Send and receive peer recognition, view Spotlight Awards	Culture → Recognise	Tied to quarterly Spotlight Awards programme. Recognition
Referral Programme	Register employee referrals for open positions	Careers → Refer a Candidate	Referral must be registered before the candidate applies thr

Appendix E: HR Department Directory

The following directory lists the primary HR contacts at Arjun Technologies as of April 2024. For general queries, hr@arjuntech.in is the best first point of contact. For urgent matters, contact your HR Business Partner directly by phone.

Role	Name	Email	Direct Phone
Vice President — Human Resources	Ms. Priya Menon	priya.menon@arjuntech.in	+91-80-4455-0100
HRBP — Engineering & Delivery	Mr. Arjun Shetty	arjun.shetty@arjuntech.in	+91-80-4455-0101
HRBP — Product & Innovation	Mr. Kiran Nambiar	kiran.nambiar@arjuntech.in	+91-80-4455-0102
HRBP — Sales & Client Relations	Ms. Meena Pillai	meena.pillai@arjuntech.in	+91-80-4455-0103
HRBP — Hyderabad Office	Ms. Lalitha Sharma	lalitha.sharma@arjuntech.in	+91-40-6677-0101
HRBP — Pune Office	Mr. Rohit Joshi	rohit.joshi@arjuntech.in	+91-20-7788-0101
HRBP — Chennai Office	Ms. Kavitha Rajan	kavitha.rajan@arjuntech.in	+91-44-5566-0101
HRBP — Mumbai Office	Mr. Sanjay Mehta	sanjay.mehta@arjuntech.in	+91-22-4433-0101
Payroll Manager	Mr. Ravi Kumar	payroll@arjuntech.in	+91-80-4455-0104
Benefits and Insurance	Ms. Anita Bose	benefits@arjuntech.in	+91-80-4455-0105
Learning & Development Manager	Ms. Sneha Gupta	sneha.gupta@arjuntech.in	+91-80-4455-0106
Talent Acquisition Head	Ms. Divya Rao	divya.rao@arjuntech.in	+91-80-4455-0107
ICC Presiding Officer (POSH)	Ms. Deepa Rao	icc@arjuntech.in	+91-80-4455-0108
IT Security Manager	Mr. Ashwin Kumar	itsecurity@arjuntech.in	+91-80-4455-0201
IT Helpdesk	—	itsupport@arjuntech.in	+91-80-4455-0200
Employee Assistance Programme	—	eap@arjuntech.in	See intranet for 24/7 helpline
Whistleblower Hotline (Anonymous)	—	ethics@arjuntech.in	1800-XXX-XXXX (24/7)
General HR Enquiries	—	hr@arjuntech.in	+91-80-4455-0100

Appendix F: Glossary of HR Terms

The following definitions apply to terms used throughout this handbook and in related HR documentation at Arjun Technologies.

Term	Definition
Accrual	The process by which a leave entitlement accumulates over time. Earned Leave accrues at 1.5 days per c
Attrition	The rate at which employees leave the organisation over a defined period, expressed as a percentage of t
Background Verification (BGV)	The pre-employment process of verifying a candidate's identity, educational qualifications, employment his
Band	The compensation and seniority grade assigned to a role, used to determine pay ranges, benefits, and car
Calibration	The cross-manager review process conducted each March to ensure that performance ratings are applied
Confirmation	The formal conversion of a probationary employee to permanent employment status, communicated by a v
Continuous Service	Uninterrupted employment with the organisation from the date of joining, used to determine gratuity eligibili
Cost-to-Company (CTC)	The total annual cost incurred by the company in employing an individual, including all salary components,
DPDP Act	The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 — India's primary legislation governing the collection, proce
EAP	Employee Assistance Programme — the free, confidential counselling and support service available to all e
EPFO	Employees' Provident Fund Organisation — the government body that administers the EPF, EPS, and EDL
EPS	Employees' Pension Scheme — the pension component of the PF system to which the employer contribute
ESOP	Employee Stock Option Plan — a scheme through which eligible employees are granted the right to purcha
FBP	Flexible Benefit Plan — the annual allocation of ■18,000 that each confirmed employee allocates across a
FnF	Full and Final Settlement — the complete financial reconciliation between the company and the departing e
Garden Leave	A period during the notice period in which the company directs the employee to remain at home while conti
Gratuity	A statutory lump-sum benefit payable under the Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972 to employees who have co
HRBP	HR Business Partner — an HR professional aligned to a specific business unit who provides strategic and
HRMS	Human Resources Management System — the digital platform that is the single system of record for all HR
ICC	Internal Complaints Committee — the body constituted under the POSH Act, 2013 to receive and investiga
IDP	Individual Development Plan — a document in HRMS capturing the employee's career aspirations, current
KPI	Key Performance Indicator — a quantitative metric used to measure progress against a specific business o
L&D	Learning and Development — the organisational function responsible for building employee capability throu
LWP	Leave Without Pay — unpaid leave approved for situations where the employee has no paid leave balance
Merit Increase	An annual salary increment, effective from 1 April, determined by the intersection of the employee's perfor
Notice Buyout	The arrangement under which an employee pays the company an amount equivalent to the unserved porti
Notice Period	The period of continued employment following a resignation or company-initiated termination, during which
OKR	Objectives and Key Results — the goal-setting framework used at Arjun Technologies, comprising qualitati
PIP	Performance Improvement Plan — a formal, time-bound document setting specific improvement targets for
POSH	Prevention of Sexual Harassment — refers to the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention
Probation	A defined evaluation period at the commencement of employment, typically six months, during which fit be
Skip-Level Manager	The manager of an employee's direct manager — one level above the immediate reporting manager in the
TDS	Tax Deducted at Source — income tax deducted from salary at the time of payment and remitted to the go

Term	Definition
UAN	Universal Account Number — the unique identifier assigned by the EPFO to each PF member, used to acc
Variable Pay	The performance-linked annual cash component of total compensation, calculated as the target variable pe
VPF	Voluntary Provident Fund — additional EPF contributions made by the employee above the mandatory 12%

Appendix G: Employee Frequently Asked Questions

The following questions represent the most common employee queries received by the HR team at Arjun Technologies. Where a question has a fuller answer in a specific handbook section, a cross-reference is provided.

Q1. When does my Earned Leave start accruing?

EL accrues from your confirmation date — the date on which your probation is formally completed. During probation you are entitled to CL and SL only. There is no retroactive accrual for the probation period. See Section 5.2 for full EL provisions.

Q2. What happens to unused Casual Leave at year-end?

Unused CL is forfeited on 31 March each year without exception. It cannot be carried forward, converted to EL, or encashed. The intent is for CL to be used throughout the year for its intended purpose — short, unplanned personal absences.

Q3. My probation period has ended but I have not received a confirmation letter. What should I do?

Contact your HR Business Partner immediately. If your manager has concerns about your performance, they are required to communicate them in writing before the probation end date — not after. If there are no concerns, HR must issue the confirmation letter within five working days. The absence of a letter does not constitute automatic confirmation.

Q4. Can I encash Earned Leave while I am still employed?

Yes. EL can be encashed twice per year — during the April and October windows published by Finance. A maximum of 10 days per event. The encashment calculation is (Annual Basic ÷ 12 ÷ 26) × days. Subject to TDS. See Section 5.2.

Q5. Can I work for another company part-time while employed here?

Not without prior written HR approval. You must disclose any proposed secondary professional activity and receive written approval before commencing. Approval will not be granted for work that competes with the company, uses company resources, creates a conflict of interest, or would affect your performance or availability. See Section 2.9.

Q6. How is my performance rating determined?

Your rating reflects your manager's assessment of your performance against your agreed OKRs and the behavioural standards for your band, reviewed through the calibration process. A Rating 3 (Meets Expectations) is the expected outcome for a fully contributing employee — it is not a negative result. See Section 6.4.

Q7. I need to extend my maternity leave beyond the statutory entitlement. Is this possible?

Yes. You may apply for up to four additional weeks of Leave Without Pay after exhausting your statutory maternity leave entitlement, with HR approval. Contact your HRBP at least two weeks before your scheduled return date to discuss options including a phased return.

Q8. What mental health support is available to me?

All employees have access to the Employee Assistance Programme — up to six free, confidential counselling sessions per year. Accessible through eap.arjuntech.in or the intranet helpline. The company has no visibility into individual usage. Family members may also access the service directly. See Section 4.11.

Q9. Can I take Earned Leave during my notice period?

Leave during the notice period requires manager approval and is subject to operational requirements. The company may decline requests where coverage cannot be arranged, but must do so reasonably. Accrued EL is encashed in full in FnF regardless of whether any leave was taken during the notice period.

Q10. What is the difference between a grievance and a POSH complaint?

A grievance covers any workplace concern other than sexual harassment — disputes with a manager, policy application concerns, compensation queries. A POSH complaint is specifically about sexual harassment as defined in the POSH Act and is handled exclusively by the ICC through the legally mandated process. See Sections 7.1 and 7.2.

Q11. How do I access my Form 16?

Form 16 is available on the HRMS portal under Payroll → Tax Documents, published by 31 May each year. If you cannot access it, contact payroll@arjuntech.in. Form 16 is required for filing your annual income tax return.

Q12. What are my obligations after I leave the company?

The NDA continues for two years post-separation. Non-solicitation of clients, employees, and suppliers applies for one year. You must return all company property and delete all company data from personal devices on your last working day. There is no non-compete restriction. See Section 8.7.

Q13. Can I work remotely from another country for a period?

Working from outside India — even briefly — requires prior approval from HR and Finance. Cross-border working triggers complex issues of tax residency, employment law jurisdiction, and data sovereignty. Do not assume your standard hybrid arrangement permits cross-border remote work.

Q14. What happens to my ESOP if I resign before all options have vested?

Unvested options lapse on your last working day. Vested options may typically be exercised within 90 days of your last working day, per the ESOP Scheme Document. Seek independent tax advice before exercising, as there are tax implications at exercise and at sale. See Section 4.10.

Q15. Am I entitled to an experience letter when I leave?

Yes. All employees who leave in good standing are entitled to an experience letter confirming their period of service, role, and designation. It is available via HRMS within 15 working days of the last working day and on written request from HR thereafter.

Q16. How do I update my PF nominee?

Log into the EPFO member portal at epfindia.gov.in using your UAN and update your nominee under E-Nomination. Keeping your nominee current is important — update it following any major life event such as marriage, the birth of a child, or bereavement.

Q17. What is the Garden Leave policy?

Garden leave may be offered at the company's discretion for Band 5 and above roles. The employee remains on payroll with full benefits but does not attend the office or access company systems during the notice period. The decision is made by the SVP in consultation with HR and Legal. See Section 8.2.

Q18. How do I raise a concern about my compensation?

Payroll errors must be raised through HRMS within five working days of salary credit. Concerns about the structure or market alignment of your compensation should be raised with your HR Business Partner during the annual performance and compensation review cycle, supported by any market data you have available.

Q19. Can I apply for an internal position while on probation?

No. Internal job applications require a minimum of 18 months in the current role and a confirmed performance rating. Employees on probation are not eligible. See Section 6.12.

Q20. What support is available if I am experiencing a mental health difficulty?

Contact the Employee Assistance Programme (eap.arjuntech.in) for free, confidential support. Speak with your manager or HRBP if you need a temporary working adjustment. The company makes reasonable adjustments for mental health conditions in the same way as for physical health conditions. You are not required to disclose a diagnosis to access support.

Appendix H: Manager HR Reference Guide

This appendix consolidates the key HR obligations and recommended practices for all people managers at Arjun Technologies. Being a manager here is one of the organisation's most consequential roles. Research consistently shows that the quality of the direct manager is the single greatest determinant of an employee's experience, performance, and decision to stay. The following reference covers the manager's responsibilities across the full employment lifecycle.

H.1 Before Your New Hire Joins

Your onboarding involvement begins when the offer is accepted, not on the joining date. Before your new hire's first day: submit the IT provisioning request in HRMS at least five working days before joining; nominate a buddy who has been at the company for at least one year and has agreed to the role; inform your team of the new colleague's name, role, and start date; ensure the workstation is clean and ready; block your calendar for a day-one introduction meeting, daily check-ins in week one, a 30-day goal-setting conversation, and the formal 30-day review. Preparation signals to the new employee that they were expected and valued — its absence signals the opposite.

The most important thing you can do before the employee joins is think clearly about what a successful first 30 days looks like. What should they know? Who should they have met? What should they have produced? Having this clarity enables you to give meaningful direction on day one instead of spending the first two weeks trying to figure out what to do with your new team member.

H.2 Giving Effective Feedback

Feedback is the most powerful development tool available to a manager and it costs nothing. The SBI model — Situation, Behaviour, Impact — provides a straightforward structure. Describe the specific context (Situation), describe the observable action rather than your interpretation of it (Behaviour), and describe the effect on the work, the team, or the client (Impact). Apply it consistently for both positive and developmental feedback.

The most common feedback errors are: saving developmental feedback for the annual appraisal; couching criticism so gently that the message is not received; attributing conduct to character ('you are disorganised') rather than to specific behaviour ('this deliverable was submitted two days late without prior notice'); and not following up to check whether the feedback has been acted upon. Effective feedback is specific, timely, behavioural, and followed through.

H.3 Managing Underperformance

The threshold for having a performance conversation is not 'this person is at risk of termination.' It is: 'this person is not meeting the expectations we agreed, and they may not know it.' Most underperformance situations resolve through a direct, honest, early conversation. The cost of avoidance is far higher than the cost of the conversation.

1. Define the gap specifically with evidence and dates before speaking. Vague concerns ('I feel you are not engaged') are unactionable. Specific observations with dates and examples are actionable.

2. Rule out systemic causes — unclear requirements, missing resources, team dependency failures — before attributing the gap to the individual.

3. Have the conversation promptly. Do not wait for the mid-year review. Name the gap directly, ask for the employee's perspective, listen genuinely, and agree on what changes by when.

4. Document the conversation by email after it concludes — a brief summary of what was discussed and what was agreed. This is not punitive; it ensures alignment and provides continuity.

5. Involve your HRBP if the informal approach does not produce improvement within four to six weeks. Do not initiate a formal PIP without HR involvement.

6. Follow through on every commitment you made in the conversation — check-ins, access to training, process changes. Inconsistency destroys trust and signals that the stated expectations were not real.

H.4 The Appraisal Conversation

The most common appraisal mistake is communicating the rating first. Lead with a review of the year — what went well, what was challenging, what you observed — before naming the rating. This produces a more receptive, more engaged, and more productive conversation. When you do communicate the rating, state it clearly with specific rationale. Do not soften a Rating 2 so much that the employee leaves thinking they received a 3.

Close every appraisal conversation with a forward-looking development discussion: where does the employee want to go in their career, what would need to be true for them to get there, and what will you commit to providing in support. An appraisal conversation that ends with a sense of shared direction is far more valuable than one that ends with a sense of judgment.

H.5 Manager Obligations Quick Reference

HR Process	Key Manager Actions	Timeline	HR Support Requ
New Hire Onboarding	IT access request; buddy nomination; day-one schedule; welcome	Before joining date	Yes — HR coordinates induction.

HR Process	Key Manager Actions	Timeline	HR Support Requ
Probation	Goals by day 30; 3-month review; 6-month assessment; confirmation or extension.	Days 30, 90, 180	Yes — HR issues all letters.
Leave Management	Respond within 2 working days; maintain team leave calendar.	Per application	Not required for standard approvals.
Goal Setting (OKRs)	Review, challenge, and agree OKRs in HRMS by 30 April.	April	HR sends templates and reminders.
Mid-Year Review	Conduct structured conversation; document in HRMS by 31 October.	October	Minimal.
Year-End Appraisal	Complete assessment by 14 March; calibration; appraisal conversation by 31 March.	February–March	Yes — HR facilitates calibration.
Performance Concerns	Informal coaching first; involve HRBP after 4–6 weeks; consider PIP.	As needed	Mandatory for formal PIP.
Resignation	Acknowledge in 2 days; plan handover from day one; support exit interview.	As received	Yes — HR processes FnF.
POSH Concern	Do not investigate. Direct employee to ICC. Contact HRBP immediately.	Immediately	Mandatory — no exceptions.
Disciplinary Action	Document informally first. Involve HRBP before any formal step.	As issues arise	Mandatory for all formal steps.
Promotion	Submit written business case to HRBP by March 1. Deadline: March 7.	February–March	Yes — HR validates and processes.

Appendix I: Disciplinary Offence Classification Table

The following table provides guidance on the appropriate disciplinary response for the most common categories of misconduct. It is guidance, not a mandatory formula — the appropriate response in any specific case depends on the full facts, the employee's service history, the impact of the conduct, and whether mitigating circumstances apply. HR must be consulted before any formal disciplinary step is taken.

Category	Examples	Typical First Response	Repeat or Escalated Res
Minor Misconduct	Unauthorised lateness; occasional missed deadline without reasonable explanation; failure to follow minor administrative process	Informal conversation; recorded verbal warning	Written Warning
Moderate Misconduct	Repeated unauthorised absence; persistent failure to comply with IT security procedures; unauthorised disclosure of non-confidential information	Written Warning	Final Written Warning
Serious Misconduct	Persistent underperformance after a completed PIP; abusive or threatening behaviour; inappropriate disclosure of Confidential Information	PIP; Written Warning	Termination
Gross Misconduct	Theft, fraud, or financial dishonesty; deliberate disclosure of Restricted data; physical violence; serious breach of health and safety	Suspension Pending Investigation; Summary Termination	Not applicable

Active disciplinary sanctions: a verbal warning remains on the HR record for six months. A written warning and a final written warning each remain active for twelve months. After the respective period, a spent sanction may not be cited in any future unrelated disciplinary proceedings. An employee's full disciplinary record is available to them on written request to HR at any time.

Appendix J: Exit Checklist

All items on this checklist must be completed and signed off before the last working day. Full and Final Settlement will not be initiated until the checklist is fully complete and all company assets have been verified as returned. Submit the completed checklist to hr@arjuntech.in or in person to the HR office.

#	Action Item	Responsible	Sign-Off By	Done?
1	Submit formal written resignation through HRMS and email to manager.	Employee	HR	☐
2	Confirm last working day with manager and HR.	Employee + HR	HR	☐
3	Complete structured handover document for all ongoing work and projects.	Employee	Line Manager	☐
4	Transfer file ownership, repository access, and shared credentials.	Employee	Line Manager	☐
5	Return company laptop and charger in original working condition.	Employee	IT	☐
6	Return company mobile phone (if issued).	Employee	IT	☐
7	Return office access card, building keys, and security tokens.	Employee	Administration	☐
8	Return all other company assets (monitors, headsets, peripherals, etc.).	Employee	IT / Admin	☐
9	Clear all personal belongings from the workstation.	Employee	Administration	☐
10	Delete all company data from personal devices enrolled in MDM; confirm with IT.	Employee	IT	☐
11	Submit all outstanding expense claims through HRMS.	Employee	Finance	☐
12	Confirm no outstanding salary advance balance with Finance.	Finance	Finance	☐
13	Participate in exit interview with HR.	Employee	HR	☐
14	Verify bank details in HRMS are current for FnF transfer.	Employee	HR	☐
15	Confirm PF withdrawal or transfer preference on EPFO employer portal.	Employee	Finance (reference)	☐
16	Receive and confirm experience letter from HR.	HR	Employee	☐
17	Review draft FnF settlement statement and raise any queries within 5 working days.	Employee	Finance + HR	☐
18	Sign FnF settlement statement confirming all items.	Employee	Finance + HR	☐

Appendix K: HR Forms Catalogue

All HR forms are available in their current version on the HRMS portal under Policies and Documents. Always download from HRMS to ensure you are using the current version. Do not rely on printed copies from a previous period.

Form ID	Form Name	Purpose	Who Completes	Where to Submit
HR-001	New Employee Joining Form	Captures details for HRMS setup, payroll, and benefit enrolment.	New employee	HR Coordinator on day one.
HR-002	PF Nomination Form (Form 2)	Declares EPF and EPS nominee.	New employee	HR — remitted to EPFO.
HR-003	Insurance Nomination Form	Declares group term life insurance beneficiary.	New employee	HR — retained on file.
HR-004	Investment Declaration (Form 12BB)	Annual declaration of tax-saving investments for TDS computation.	Employee	HRMS by Finance deadline (January).
HR-005	Gratuity Nomination (Form F)	Designates gratuity nominee.	New employee within 30 days	HR — retained on file.
HR-006	Attendance Correction Request	Requests correction of erroneous HRMS attendance entry.	Employee	HRMS; manager approval required.
HR-007	Salary Advance Request	Request for advance of up to one month's net salary.	Confirmed employee (1+ year)	HR and Finance for approval.
HR-008	Internal Transfer Request	Formal request to transfer to a different team or location.	Employee	HR Business Partner.
HR-009	Grievance Form	Formal Tier 2 grievance submission.	Employee	HR Business Partner.
HR-010	Exit Interview Questionnaire	Structured feedback form for departing employees.	Departing employee	HR Coordinator.
HR-011	Performance Improvement Plan	Formal time-bound improvement plan for underperformance.	Manager (with HRBP support)	HRBP; copy issued to employee.
HR-012	Conflict of Interest Disclosure	Mandatory disclosure of an actual or potential conflict.	Employee	HR Business Partner and line manager.
HR-013	FBP Election Form	Annual election of FBP category allocations.	Employee	HRMS by start of financial year.
HR-014	L&D Reimbursement Claim	Claim for reimbursement of L&D expenditure.	Employee	HRMS Expenses module; manager appr
HR-015	Employee Referral Submission	Registers a candidate referral under the ERP.	Referring employee	HRMS or Talent Acquisition team.
HR-016	Probation Assessment Form	Formal end-of-probation assessment by manager.	Line Manager	HRMS Performance module; HR review.
HR-017	Work from Home Agreement	Documents terms of approved hybrid working arrangement.	Employee and line manager	HR for file.
HR-018	Maternity Leave Application	Formal maternity leave application with expected dates.	Employee	HR with 8 weeks' advance notice.
HR-019	Sabbatical Leave Application	Formal application for a sabbatical of 1–3 months.	Employee	HRBP; BU head approval required.
HR-020	Full and Final Settlement Statement	Itemised FnF statement for employee leaving and HR sign-off.	Finance and HR	Provided to employee for signature.

Appendix L: Employment Law Reference

This appendix provides an overview of the key Indian employment laws that govern Arjun Technologies's employment practices. It is an informational summary, not legal advice. For specific legal questions, consult the Legal team at Mr. Sandeep Iyer's office.

Legislation	Key Employment Provisions	Company's Primary Obligation
Industrial Disputes Act, 1947	Governs resolution of employer-employee disputes; prescribes procedures for retrenchment, layoff, and closure	Follow prescribed process for any workforce reduction; pay compensation as mandated
Payment of Wages Act, 1936	Requires timely wage payment; restricts unauthorised deductions; specifies permissible modes of payment	Pay all employees on the last working day of the month; provi
Minimum Wages Act, 1948	Mandates state-specific minimum wages for scheduled employments; revised periodically by state governments	Ensure all employees receive at least the applicable minimum
EPF & Miscellaneous Provisions Act, 1952	Mandates PF, EPS, and EDLI contributions; governs EPFO administration; requires UAN for all employees	Deduct and remit contributions by the 15th of the following mo
Employees' State Insurance Act, 1948	Mandates ESI contributions for eligible employees (gross wages ≤ ₹21,000/month); provides medical, sickness, ESI ca	Register eligible employees, deduct and remit ESI contributions, issue ESI ca
Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972	Mandates gratuity to employees with 5+ years of service; defines calculation formula and maximum limits	Maintain gratuity fund or insurance; pay within 30 days of se
Payment of Bonus Act, 1965	Mandates annual bonus to eligible employees (wages ≤ ₹21,000/month); minimum 8.33% of wages	Identify eligible employees, calculate and pay bonus within th
Maternity Benefit Act, 1961 (Amended 2017)	Mandates 26 weeks paid maternity leave; nursing breaks; prohibits dismissal during leave; work from home option	Provide full pay, protect employees during leave, and allow nursing bre
POSH Act, 2013	Mandates ICC constitution; defines sexual harassment; requires annual reporting	Constitute and maintain ICC, display Act provisions, conduct
Shops and Establishments Act (State-level)	Governs working hours, leave, and employment conditions in commercial establishments; varies by state	Register with the applicable state authority, comply with state
Information Technology Act, 2000	Governs electronic transactions; defines cyber security practices; mandates reasonable security practices	Implement and maintain ISO 27001-aligned security controls, comply with SPDI Rule
DPDP Act, 2023	Establishes framework for processing personal data; defines Data Fiduciary obligations; creates rights for data	Obtain valid consent, implement security safeguards, appoint a Data
Companies Act, 2013	Governs corporate structure, governance, and CSR; requires maintenance of statutory registers	Comply with CSR obligations (Section 135), maintain registers

Appendix M: Compensation Deep-Dive with Worked Examples

M.1 CTC to Take-Home — Worked Example

The following example illustrates how an annual CTC of ■8,00,000 translates into monthly take-home salary for a Band 2 employee based in Bengaluru, assuming the employee is paying ■15,000 per month in rent and has declared tax-saving investments of ■1,50,000 under Section 80C.

Component	Annual (■)	Monthly (■)	Calculation	In Hand?
Basic Salary	3,20,000	26,667	40% of CTC	Yes — taxable
House Rent Allowance	1,60,000	13,333	50% of Basic (metro)	Partially exempt — Sec. 10(13A)
Special Allowance	1,22,000	10,167	Balance of CTC	Yes — taxable
FBP (if fully allocated)	18,000	1,500	Fixed annual allocation	Per chosen category
Performance Variable	80,000	Annual pmt.	10% of CTC target	Yes — paid post-appraisal
Employer PF Contribution	21,600	1,800	12% of ■15,000 ceiling	Not in hand — to PF account
Gratuity Provision	15,397	1,283	4.81% of Basic	Not in hand — payable at separatio
Health Insurance Premium	18,000	1,500	Company-paid (family floater)	Benefit in kind
Life Insurance Premium	5,000	417	Company-paid	Benefit in kind
Accident Insurance	3,000	250	Company-paid	Benefit in kind
Total CTC	8,00,000	66,667		

Monthly deductions from gross fixed pay of ■51,667: Employee PF ■1,800 (12% of ■15,000); Professional Tax ≈■200 (Karnataka slab); TDS (variable — approximately ■4,500–■6,000 depending on investment declarations and the tax regime chosen). Approximate take-home after all deductions: ■43,000–■46,000 per month. The precise take-home varies materially based on investment declarations. Employees who maximise Section 80C (■1,50,000), claim HRA exemption, and make NPS contributions through the FBP can reduce TDS meaningfully.

M.2 HRA Exemption — How It Works

The HRA exemption under Section 10(13A) is the minimum of three amounts: (1) the actual HRA received; (2) 50% of Basic Salary for metro cities; and (3) actual rent paid minus 10% of Basic Salary. For our example employee: Amount 1 = ■1,60,000; Amount 2 = ■1,60,000; Amount 3 = ■1,80,000 – ■32,000 = ■1,48,000. The exemption is the minimum: ■1,48,000. The remaining ■12,000 of HRA is taxable. HRA exemption requires rent receipts or a rental agreement. Rent payments above ■1,00,000 per year require the landlord's PAN.

M.3 Gratuity — Three Worked Examples

Scenario	Basic Salary	Years of Service	Calculation	Gratuity Payable
Example 1	■30,000/month	5 years 2 months (= 5 years)	(■30,000÷26)×15×5 = ■1,153.85×15×5	■86,538

Scenario	Basic Salary	Years of Service	Calculation	Gratuity Payable
Example 2	■60,000/month	8 years 7 months (= 9 years)	(■60,000÷26)×15×9 = ■2,307.69×15×9	■3,11,538
Example 3	■1,20,000/month	25 years 0 months (= 25 years)	(■1,20,000÷26)×15×25 = ■4,615.38×15×25	■17,30,769 (exempt — bel

M.4 Variable Pay — Worked Example

An employee with CTC of ■20,00,000 at Band 4 (target variable 15%) who receives a Rating 4 (multiplier 1.00–1.15) in a year where the company achieves 105% of its financial target (company performance factor 1.05):

Target variable = ■20,00,000 × 15% = ■3,00,000. With Rating 4 multiplier of 1.08 (mid-point of the 1.00–1.15 range) and company factor of 1.05: Payout = ■3,00,000 × 1.08 × 1.05 = ■3,40,200. In a year where the company achieves only 85% of target (company factor 0.85) and the same employee receives a Rating 3 (multiplier 0.95): Payout = ■3,00,000 × 0.95 × 0.85 = ■2,41,875.

Appendix N: Manager FAQ — 15 Workplace Scenarios

The following questions address the situations most commonly raised by people managers at Arjun Technologies when seeking guidance from the HR team.

MQ1. A team member has disclosed a sexual harassment concern to me informally. What do I do?

Do not investigate, mediate, or advise the employee on whether they 'have a case.' Direct them to the Internal Complaints Committee immediately. The ICC's contact details are on the intranet. Contact your HRBP to inform them a concern has been raised. Maintain strict confidentiality. Your role ends at directing the employee to the correct channel — it does not extend to attempting to resolve the matter informally.

MQ2. My team member's sick leave forms a pattern — always Mondays and Fridays. Can I refuse to approve it?

No. Approve the application based on available balance and documentation requirements. You cannot refuse sick leave solely on suspicion of misuse. If you believe there is a genuine pattern of misuse, raise it confidentially with your HRBP. HR will advise on the appropriate next step, which is typically a supportive conversation — not leave refusal.

MQ3. I want to promote a team member but they have only been in their current role for 12 months. Can I proceed?

The standard requirement is 18 months. An exception requires VP-HR approval in addition to the standard endorsement process. You must provide a compelling, evidence-based case demonstrating that the employee is already clearly performing at the next level. Tenure waivers are granted for approximately 5–10% of promotions.

MQ4. A team member told me they are pregnant. What are my obligations?

Congratulate them appropriately. Do not make any employment decision — assignment, performance rating, project allocation — that is influenced by the pregnancy. Direct them to HR to discuss their maternity entitlements. Ensure their workstation and working conditions are safe and comfortable as the pregnancy progresses. Plan coverage well in advance, not reactively. Discrimination against a pregnant employee is both illegal and a serious values breach.

MQ5. An employee on my team has resigned during their PIP. What happens?

The PIP process stops at the point of resignation. Process the resignation normally. The employee is entitled to serve their notice period and receive full FnF entitlements. The PIP is not a basis for withholding notice, adjusting FnF, or adding deductions. Close the PIP formally in HRMS.

MQ6. I need to restructure my team and eliminate a role. What is the process?

Contact your HRBP before communicating anything to the affected employee. Role elimination is a statutory process governed by the Industrial Disputes Act and must be managed through HR and Legal. The company may have obligations including exploring alternative roles, providing statutory notice, and paying retrenchment compensation. Do not proceed unilaterally.

MQ7. Can I offer a spot bonus to a high performer outside the normal annual cycle?

Yes, subject to approval from your SVP and HR. The request must include a clear business justification and the proposed amount. Finance must approve the budget. Spot bonuses are taxable and processed through payroll. Contact your HRBP to initiate the process.

MQ8. I suspect a team member is sharing confidential data externally. What should I do?

Do not confront the employee or conduct your own investigation. Contact IT Security at security@arjuntech.in and your HRBP immediately. IT Security will assess the situation and may restrict the employee's access during the investigation. This situation requires specialist handling — managing it independently could compromise the investigation.

MQ9. A team member says a colleague is consistently taking credit for their work. How do I handle it?

Have separate private conversations with both individuals to understand each perspective. Where contribution attribution is genuinely unclear, establish clearer team norms for how contributions are documented and communicated. If the pattern appears deliberate and continues after your initial intervention, treat it as a conduct matter and involve HR.

MQ10. An employee is asking about their promotion prospects this year. What should I tell them?

Be honest. If they are on track for a promotion recommendation, say so clearly while noting that calibration and BU head endorsement are required. If they are not on track due to tenure, performance, or absence of a business need, be direct about that — with specific guidance on what needs to change for the picture to be different next year. Vague encouragement that leads to appraisal disappointment is more damaging to trust than an honest 'not this year, for these specific reasons.'

MQ11. A team member has told me they are experiencing a mental health difficulty. What is my role?

Express genuine care and direct them to the Employee Assistance Programme (eap.arjuntech.in). Ask what, if any, working adjustments would be helpful and explore what is operationally feasible. Manage any performance impact through a supportive lens — involve your HRBP before having any performance conversation with an employee who has disclosed a health condition. You do not need to provide counselling; you need to connect them to it and create conditions in which they can recover and perform.

MQ12. My team member is going through a difficult personal situation and it is affecting their work quality. How should I balance support with accountability?

Hold both dimensions simultaneously, rather than choosing between them. Acknowledge the difficulty and express genuine support. Then, separately, be direct about the specific work impact and what needs to be maintained or improved — framing it as something you want to help them achieve, not as a judgment. Involve your HRBP early in this kind of situation for guidance on how to navigate it well.

MQ13. A resigning employee is being unproductive and disengaged during their notice period. What can I do?

Have a direct conversation. Remind the employee of their obligations during the notice period and what the specific expectations are for the remainder of their time. A sustained and documented failure to meet notice period work standards can affect the FnF settlement. If the situation does not improve, contact your HRBP. Do not simply accept low-quality notice period performance as unavoidable.

MQ14. Can I ask a team member to return to the office on a scheduled remote working day?

Yes. The hybrid working policy is explicit that the manager may require the employee to attend the office on a scheduled remote day for a legitimate business reason, with reasonable advance notice of at least 24 hours. The employee is expected to comply. This right should be exercised judiciously and with a genuine business reason — not as a way of penalising an employee for other reasons.

MQ15. I have a strong external candidate who would require a salary at the top of the Band 3 range, but my existing Band 3 employees earn significantly less. How do I handle the internal equity concern?

This is a legitimate internal equity issue that should be discussed with your HRBP before making the external offer. Hiring an external candidate at the top of the range while existing employees are materially below it creates a real risk of pay resentment and attrition. The HRBP can model whether any existing employees need a market adjustment and can advise on the right sequencing of decisions. Do not make the external offer without this conversation.

Appendix O: Policy Rationale Notes

This appendix explains the reasoning behind several policy decisions that employees and managers most commonly question or find counterintuitive. Understanding why a policy exists — not just what it requires — helps everyone apply it with better judgement in situations that the policy text does not explicitly address.

Why is the probation period six months rather than three?

A three-month probation is common in the industry but often insufficient for roles with significant complexity or context-dependence. In a technology services company, three months is typically just enough time to complete onboarding, understand the codebase or service, and begin making initial contributions. It does not provide adequate evidence to assess whether the person is the right long-term fit. Six months allows both parties to observe performance across a complete project or delivery cycle, experience multiple client interactions, and observe conduct in a wider range of situations. The cost of a probation extension or non-confirmation is lower than the cost of confirming someone who is not the right fit and then managing underperformance for another twelve to eighteen months.

Why do we use OKRs rather than KRAs?

Arjun Technologies moved from Key Responsibility Areas to the OKR framework because KRAs describe what a person's job is rather than what they are trying to achieve in a given year. An engineer's KRA of 'ensure code quality' tells you about the role; it does not tell you what the person will accomplish this year. OKRs force specificity. They require the employee to state the intended achievement and the quantitative measure that will confirm it was reached. This specificity benefits everyone: the employee has clarity about expectations, the manager has an unambiguous assessment basis, the calibration process has a shared vocabulary, and performance conversations focus on outcomes rather than activities.

Why is Casual Leave not encashable?

CL is a short-notice absence entitlement designed to be used throughout the year for personal and domestic circumstances. Making it encashable would create a financial incentive to not use it — meaning employees who genuinely need short-notice days off would hesitate to take them. The purpose of CL is wellbeing and personal flexibility, not an additional financial entitlement. Encashment is appropriate for Earned Leave because that is a vacation entitlement that can genuinely accumulate over time and has a direct financial equivalent.

Why is the EL carry-forward capped at 45 days?

The 45-day cap prevents the accumulation of very large leave balances that create both a significant organisational liability and a signal that the employee has not been taking adequate rest. Large unexercised balances often indicate that an employee is working without appropriate recovery time — which is neither sustainable nor in the company's long-term interest. The twice-yearly encashment option provides a financial outlet for employees who prefer to convert excess leave to cash, ensuring the cap does not result in forced forfeiture for employees who are genuinely committed to their work.

Why does hybrid work require manager approval rather than being a universal entitlement?

Hybrid work is assessed at the role and team level because its impact on work quality, team cohesion, and client service varies significantly by context. An engineer working independently on a defined feature can often be as effective remotely as in the office. A new employee in their first 30 days, an employee running a team of fifteen, or a client-facing manager during a complex engagement negotiation may need to be in the office more consistently. A conditional model allows the decision to be made with the appropriate context and business sensitivity, rather than applying a uniform rule that serves neither the company nor all employees well.

Why is variable pay paid annually rather than quarterly?

Annual payment aligns precisely with the annual performance cycle, making the link between performance and reward explicit and comprehensible. Quarterly payments would require quarterly performance assessments, adding significant administrative overhead without proportionate benefit to the quality of feedback or the accuracy of performance differentiation. Annual variable pay also creates a meaningful retention effect: employees who leave before the April payment date forgo their variable pay, which encourages stability through the company's critical Q4 delivery period.

Why do post-employment NDA and non-solicitation obligations apply but non-compete restrictions do not?

Indian contract law, specifically Section 27 of the Contract Act, 1872, renders broad post-employment non-compete clauses unenforceable as restraints of trade. Arjun Technologies does not attempt to impose non-compete restrictions that would prevent former employees from working in the technology industry or joining competitors — such restrictions would be legally unenforceable and would unfairly impede the careers of people who have worked hard to build their skills. The NDA and non-solicitation provisions, by contrast, protect legitimate and identifiable business interests: the confidentiality of proprietary information and the integrity of client and employee relationships. These are targeted, proportionate, and legally defensible.

Why does the handbook specify that a Rating 3 is a positive outcome?

Because in most performance management frameworks, 'Meets Expectations' is experienced by employees as a barely-acceptable result — something to be apologised for rather than acknowledged as a genuine achievement. This handbook explicitly states that a Rating 3 is the expected outcome for a solid, fully contributing employee, because the expectations themselves are high and meeting them consistently over a full year is a real and meaningful achievement. The alternative — treating Rating 3 as a quasi-negative — creates pressure on managers to inflate ratings, erodes the differentiating power of higher ratings, and demoralises employees who are genuinely performing well.

End of Employee Handbook — All Five Segments

This concludes the Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd. Employee Handbook, Version 5.2, effective 01 April 2024. The complete handbook — Segments 1 through 5 — is available on the HRMS portal under Policies and Documents. All employees are required to read the handbook in full and to submit the signed acknowledgement in Segment 4, Section 10, within five working days of their date of joining. For any queries, contact hr@arjuntech.in.